

CONDUCT YOUR OWN AWARENESS SESSIONS

CHRISTOPHER HILLS and ROBERT B. STONE

Step-by-step instructions for 80 game-like group evenings
that will change your life!



FIRST TIME IN PRINT—THE AMAZING NEW *SENSITIVITY TECHNIQUES* THAT ARE
MAKING HAPPINESS A *REALITY* FOR THOUSANDS!

GAMES PEOPLE



SHOULD PLAY...

Awareness Sessions. Simple, enjoyable group activities with revolutionary results. Easy-to-understand "games" designed to bring people closer together and increase sensitivity, creativity and awareness in *positive* and *permanent* ways! By playing these simple "games," people all over the world have found the happiness and fulfillment of understanding themselves and others.

This is NOT a book of essays. It is NOT philosophy. It is a carefully-planned, detailed *program of action* that you and your friends can begin *immediately*, with practical and far-reaching rewards!

YOU BEGIN with such basic awareness “games” as

FULL-LENGTH MIRROR

BODY MAGIC

I TOUCH YOU, YOU TOUCH ME

YOU PROGRESS to the more advanced techniques of

LOVE AND AFFECTION

THE POWER OF TOUCH

PERSONALITY RADAR

YOU FIND yourself becoming more “alive” and effective through

MEMORY EXPANSION

PERSONAL MAGNETISM

APPLIED AWARENESS

AWARENESS WORKS! It is not magic or mysticism. Designed to fulfill actual human needs and desires, it is the modern, *practical* path to a fuller life for you and your friends. It can be your path to fulfillment *now*—without special training or study. You can begin tonight, with your own leaders, in your own home. The time is now. The choice is yours.

Conduct your own awareness sessions

CHRISTOPHER HILLS
and
ROBERT B. STONE



A SIGNET BOOK from
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Part I of this book provides a starting point for everybody. Twenty group exercises are described in detail. Performed one-a-week, they can lead men and women to a higher level of existence as well as create a strong desire to pursue the transformation further.

Some people may want to continue along a psychological path to greater sensitivity, intuitiveness and awareness; others, along a sensory and extrasensory path; and again others, along a metaphysical one. Parts II, III and IV provide twenty group exercises in each of these directions.

For those who are ready to turn evenings of social talk into power-packed growth sessions and have fun doing it, this book gives basic step-by-step procedures. The rewards—self-revelation, a quickening of consciousness, and a more creative, fulfilled life—await the discoverers.

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PART I

Basic Games

Introduction: *How to Use This Book*

Men and women everywhere are seeking more out of life.

The journey from womb to tomb is short. Yet man's world is expanding at an astonishing rate. In one lifetime man has gone from the steam age, to the electronic age, to the atomic age, to the space age.

Is man's scientific progress outdistancing his evolutionary progress? Has he the wisdom to use the powers he harnesses in the expanded world?

Men and women who are gathered at bars, chatting at coffee breaks, mingling at parties, watching athletic events or television, attending church or enjoying any of the many facets of social intercourse are turning more and more to matters that seemed only yesterday to be of little concern. Where they were once content to look at the surface of things and limit their interest to basic needs and desires, they now feel a hunger to get more out of existence, to add a new dimension to life.

From teen-agers to college students, from the jet set to the diaper set, from the settled set to the golden agers, a new enthusiasm is growing for self-discovery, for new achievements in life and for higher levels of personal fulfillment.

Leaders of business and industry see this need, on the part of their personnel, for a psychological income over and above monetary income, and they are responding by involving people more in profit sharing and decision making. Government and school officials see this need, in their communities, in the form of demands for a greater voice in policy making and in shaping their own civic and educational destinies. Church leaders see this need, among their parishoners, in increasing apathy to rite, ritual and

dogma and in irrepressible demands that the churches take an active interest in the issues of the day.

A new quest for the grail has begun. There is no mistaking it. One can see it in current, dizzying social changes, in the revolt of youth and in the resurgence of spiritual—rather than religious—interest among many.

It is a quest for meaning and purpose in life. And it is a quest for the means to attain that purpose. Many seekers have found themselves on the dead-end streets of hallucinatory drugs and synthetic psychodelia, and are returning to seek in other directions. Many others have taken off for the solitude of the wilderness, or the retreats of the Far East, to restudy their life styles and to learn techniques for reaching into the unknown.

Still others are finding vast new horizons in human potential right here at home. They are meeting in groups, either at philosophical, psychological or spiritual centers, or informally at home, and expanding their consciousness through the melting of blocks and barriers and the development of sensitivity and awareness. They are finding the keys to happiness right in their own back yards.

Many of these people have made astounding progress in revitalization, under the leadership of capable professional teachers. However, a number of professionals are now realizing that equally astounding progress can be made by leaderless groups.

Awareness and sensitivity sessions are now falling into the laymen's domain, where indeed they have always really belonged. Individuals and lay groups have asserted their right to the pursuit of personal fulfillment by whatever path they choose.

The authors have led countless groups and will continue to do so. But they are convinced that no one should delay his or her quest for want of a leader.

The way is open. And we believe it is all here, and in you. Form a group of your neighbors and begin. Expect immediate results. In just a few meetings you should begin to see important changes. Each meeting ought to be an exhilarating experience which will leave you looking forward to the next.

Every person attracted to the group you form can move in the direction of:

- An increased awakening of the senses;
- Richer appreciation of life's experiences;
- Deeper insight into human behavior;

Better understanding of family and friends;
 Improved personal effectiveness;
 A higher level of health and well-being;
 A greater degree of efficiency and creativity;
 A firmer kinship with all life;
 A spiritual resurgence;
 Enhanced extrasensory perception;
 A fuller flow of intuition and inspiration;
 Greater self-mastery;
 New physical and mental skills;
 The ability to attract desired events and people;
 More happiness and peace of mind;
 And further wisdom regarding universal truths and
 the conduct of life.

All who *read* this book may well experience a quickening. But those who *live* this book should be able to experience its fullest promise. To live this book means to participate in the Evenings it describes, enjoying its activities with friends, relations or colleagues.

The recommended minimum group should consist of four people. An ideal size for a group is from six to eight people. However, groups of up to twenty people will benefit just as well in fun and fulfillment. Larger groups will find it to their advantage to meet in two or three sections in order to get the most out of the experience.

Forming a Group

Nothing is required to be eligible as a member of a group except a desire to get more out of life. Group members need not have any particular skills or any special level of education. They can be boys and girls, or men and women. They can be married or single. They can be strangers or friends. They can be your neighbors, your relatives, your business colleagues or just people you have met.

The more they have in common, the quicker the group will find that they "hit it off," but this is not at all essential. In fact, after a few meetings strangers can be the best of friends through their sharing of enjoyable and enlightening evenings together.

How to Invite Participants

If you have frequent contact with the people you expect will participate, you need only talk about the purpose

and promise of the meetings to arouse curiosity, interest and appetite. There is no commitment to remain in a group for any length of time. People can try it out to see if it is their "cup of tea."

Others can be invited to a philosophical evening, a discussion session, or just a plain social evening, with this book as the purpose.

Those who want you to "explain further" can read the first section of Part I. It takes about three minutes.

Your interest in forming a group can be introduced at any party or meeting, and discussed. You can put an ad in a personal column for others seeking to form a group, or put notices up on bulletin boards in town halls, offices or schools. "Are you interested in awareness sessions?" is a good gambit to introduce someone to the idea of the group you are forming.

It is not advisable to invite anyone who has been undergoing treatment for serious emotional or medical problems, unless he has the consent of the professional under whose care he has been.

Ages of Participants

As mentioned before, there is no requirement about the age of participants. However, the greater the age difference the less likely it is that there can be the fullest mutual cooperation in all activities. Teen-agers relate better to people under 30 than they do to their parents' peers. And the parents relate better to others of their own generation than they do to either the older or younger generations. Of course there are exceptions. So there is no set recommendation to refuse somebody because of age. There are "adult" teen-agers and there are "30-year-old" octogenarians.

How to Begin

Begin by setting a time and place and phoning all participants and prospective participants. Each session described in the book is termed an Evening. However, these can just as easily be morning or afternoon sessions. You will be the host or hostess for this first meeting. The group will then decide whether the location of the get-togethers should rotate, with each participant taking a turn, or whether some other plan will be followed. If there is to be one location, certainly participants should take turns bringing refreshments or other materials

needed. Start with Evening No. 1 in Part I. Each Evening is based on previous evenings to a large extent.

Refreshments

There is a point in each session where the procedure calls for refreshments to be served. Sometimes the timing has a purpose in the experiences, other times it is timed to afford a "break" in the activities or a time for informal discussion. No elaborate fare is envisioned. It could be coffee and cookies or beer and potato chips. It can change from time to time in accordance with the preferences of the participants or the graciousness of the hosts.

Materials Needed

Usually all that is needed is a comfortable room with chairs arranged casually around it. If special materials are needed at a particular session, notice of this is given in the instructions for the previous session. It is always assumed, however, that pencils and paper are available for each participant and that some drawing paper and sketching pencils or watercolors are readily accessible. It is also assumed that records or tapes with various musical selections are on hand. It would be well for the host of each session to check the instructions ahead of time. One session, for instance (Evening No. 19, Part III) calls for graph paper, playing cards, and checkers or chess sets.

The Leader

Each session is led by a participant. It can be the host or some other person. The group should try rotating the leadership so that all can obtain the benefits of this experience. At a point later in the sessions, when a cohesive rapport has been established, there is no leader. Meanwhile, the duties of the leader consist largely of reading the introduction to that Evening, and then following through by reading the instructions for each step. (On occasion, the leader is taken into the confidence of the authors in order not to reveal some aspect of an event until the appropriate time.)

Sometimes a participant can be emotionally upset or "hopped up" by an event. This is almost always temporary, and all participants will usually recognize it and accept it as a healthful release. The leader can help by pausing at such a time so that such a person can regain composure as other participants lend comfort and support. This is not necessarily to be expected, but the authors feel that

leaders should be informed of the possibility so that they can maintain calm and orderly sessions. (In the event that a participant is more than temporarily disturbed, he has doubtless needed professional help for some time.)

Confrontation techniques used by psychologists in therapy, and other techniques such as psychodrama, fantasy and hypnosis, are the domain of professionals. Where "games" used in this book are based on these techniques, the play aspect is emphasized and the technique suggested should prove harmless. The general reaction of participants in these exercises will be one of joy and exhilaration. The leader may receive compliments for his efforts; so may the host. Both should resist the temptation to "take credit" and should instead credit the entire group for the fun and value of the experiences.

The leader's main responsibilities can be said to be to keep the Evening moving according to procedure, and to keep discussions centered on the subject at hand.

Time Required for Each Session

Since many of the Evenings entail one or more periods of discussion, it is difficult to estimate the exact elapsed time required for each session. However, a good average estimate is one-and-a-half to two hours. If for some reason the elapsed time is less, the group may want to repeat an event (there are usually three or more in an Evening) or to try some adaptation or version of it. On the other hand, if the Evening is running long, the group may want to cut down on one event by having only a few of the participants enjoy it, or by reducing the length of discussions.

How the Instructions are Written

Each Evening contains an introduction before the Procedure section. This should be read to the group by the host or leader. The Procedure is divided into Steps: Step 1 should be read aloud also unless there are instructions in it to the contrary; do not read Step 2 until Step 1 has been completed (unless otherwise instructed). Always complete one Step before reading or doing the next.

No distinction is made in the instructions between male or female participants. Since it is awkward to refer always to "he or she," the text usually says merely "he." It should be understood that either a man or a woman is meant by this.

Newcomers or Guests

Ideally speaking, the group should consist of the same people each meeting. More and more in the way of exciting progress and accelerated unfolding of each participant comes with experiencing together the many unusual and effective events. A newcomer is bound to feel strange and "left out." This is not to say that the group is closed once it starts. It is within the province of each participant to propose a new participant and it is the prerogative of the group to accept. In one instance, Part III, Evening 9, guests are invited as part of a planned experience.

Significance of Part I through Part IV

There is something for everybody in Part I of this book. It is a "getting to know you," and a systems approach to expanded consciousness. That is to say, it provides experiences for the growth of awareness and sensitivity in all three "divisions" of consciousness—the subconscious, the conscious and the superconscious. We know these sometimes by the terms psychological, sensory and intuitive. Part I gives the group a chance to reach for new horizons in all three areas.

In the final evening of Part I, the group reviews the fun and excitement it has had in the past and decides by its reaction to these experiments in which direction it will go next. If the psychological explorations are more attractive, then Part II comes next in the sequence. If sensory and extrasensory awareness "games" are preferred, then Part II is temporarily skipped and Part III is next. Or, if the potentials of the superconscious are named for top priority, then Part IV is next.

Once the group has completed the Part that it was most attracted to in this second phase, it will probably want to go on to the other two Parts and sound out the total human experience in accelerating the evolution of consciousness.

Part IV provides the serious seekers with the most powerful experience of all. Here are twenty Evenings that transcend everyday events and take participants into a world in which science and religion hesitate to tread, today's no-man's-land, but tomorrow's land of infinite promise.

Types of "Games"

The word "game" applies in many cases, but some of

the events scheduled for these Evenings might be more appropriately described as "exercises" or "experiences." Yet all have the fun and joy of a game plus the exhilaration that comes from *being oneself*.

The activities include many that occur at the average social get-together—with the exception of "small talk." However, instead of going off in different directions, as activities are likely to do at a strictly social evening, these are focused and cooperative.

The magnitude and potentials of people here are given ways to express themselves through the media of conversation, art, music, physical activities and person-to-person relationships. There are periods of relaxation and silence, so necessary and yet so rare in today's world.

These activities are not to be considered "intellectual" in the narrow sense. Rather they are of the intellect but not totally in it. They touch the senses, the personality and the psyche. They involve the whole person in a way that stimulates interest, enthusiasm, and participation. Most Evenings contain diversified types of activities so that there is moving around as well as sitting, doing as well as talking.

Your Group's Contribution to Other Groups

There are several Evenings wherein the participants are invited to create their own activities or variations of those they have enjoyed. They are invited to test them, with the group's concurrence, and to send these successful "originals" or variations to the authors in London.* There they can be further tested and shared with other groups through available channels. It would be valuable to include the location of your group in your suggested title to the "game" so that its future users may know of its origins, as for instance: "The Rye, New York, Game of I See You, I See You Not" or "The Charleston, West Virginia, Psychic Reactor."

A Note: If you are reading this book in advance, try not to read the instructions qualified as for hosts or leaders only—so as not to spoil a game.

Improvements and Changes for Which to Watch

What actually *happens* as a result of these Evenings?

*C/o Christopher Hills, Centre House, 10A Airlie Gardens, Kensington, London W8, England.

Besides being more fulfilling than the average social get-together, these Evenings cause both seen and unseen effects. Seen are the smiles, the cordiality, the radiance and an unmistakable added attractiveness and enthusiasm. Not seen, but very strongly felt, are warmth, dependability, strength, oneness and maturity.

It is hard to put your finger on just what evidence there is of increased awareness in another person. It is easier to see the effects in yourself. People who have been burdened with anxieties and troubles, plagued with insomnia and nervousness, saddled with chronic pains, headaches or other ailments with no apparent physical cause often find that these quite miraculously disappear as new strength, new self-confidence and new optimism take over. The great teachers of mankind have all said that the whole universe consists of two states: the potential and the manifested. Each state is the manifestation of its previous state and, at the same time, it is the potential of its next state. The aim of all these awareness techniques is to transform your potential state into a dynamic state and, by helping you to transcend both, to enable you to reach ultimately that consciousness at the center of being which is *one* with all your manifested states. This state can be called union.

The fortunate people without many problems, and those without unwanted hang-ups or habits, will probably derive immense benefits from these shared experiences as they too rise to new heights of capability and effectiveness. They should have more of the self-fulfillment which comes with the feeling of well-being, of closeness to other people, of attunement with their surroundings.

Many participants may develop precognition (the ability to see events before they arrive), the gift of psychometry (the ability to pick up information from an object), and other "unexplainable" manifestations of increased sensory perception and extrasensory perception.

A few will probably develop a spiritual resurgence that will bring a bliss and peace of mind and universal love that transcends verbal description.

For all participants these Evenings should constitute a step up on the ladder of life. Participants may make more money or more friends. Or they may enjoy every taste, sight, touch and sound more intensely. Certainly, they should gain the capacity to make crisis decisions and

more sound intuitive judgments. They will probably all enjoy every day more fully.

And there may be more days to enjoy.

Evening No. 1

“What I Believe”

There is no better way for a group of people to get to know each other intimately than for each, on the spur of the moment, to express his or her fundamental belief about life. This is a “must” for Awareness Evening No. 1. It breaks the personal ice and digs below the social superficiality we all unconsciously use to protect our identity.

Some groups in depth psychology attempt to facilitate the baring of the personality by nude sessions. This is good shock treatment, but the reason it fails more often than not is that it still leaves the most vital part of a person totally cloaked in mystery.

When a woman expresses her deepest conviction about the nature of the universe and the purpose of life, she is baring more than her anatomy. When a man talks about his ethics and his innermost aspirations, he is exposing essential aspects of himself, more than hair and muscle.

“What I Believe” also sets the stage for what lies ahead. It does this by creating a new climate. Call it the climate of reality if you will. The moment you start groping for the words that describe your basic belief, the Dow-Jones Industrial Index fades; the big garbage bag you forgot to take out becomes microscopic; the gripe you have against your husband, wife or boss seems irrelevant.

All that counts is that you get your friends to understand your philosophy. All that counts is that you find the right words to do justice to your understanding of life.

Why “spur of the moment”?

If a person is told days, or even hours, in advance that he will be asked for his basic belief, he will create one rather than express what already exists within him. It is

natural to "prepare" for a test or a project; if we have only a few loosely knit ideas, we try to add what we think will complete the intellectual "look" of the structure. We may be honest about it; or we may sincerely think we are being honest when actually we are doing a little personal image-building. (Even in the few moments that it takes to make the rounds of the group, those at the end of the line will begin to borrow from what they have heard. You will hear words and ideas repeated. In fact, there is at least one in any group who will prefer to protect his most secret belief from himself or others and "steal" a philosophy lock, stock and barrel, by saying, "I believe very much the way Alice does.")

However, most members of the group should find these spontaneous expressions of personal philosophy an exhilarating experience. They will probably feel:

An instant broadening of horizons;

An instant closeness with all present beyond anything that years of social friendship can provide;

An instant change of vibrations in a room used to smaller talk;

An instant elevation of all present to a step higher in the level of awareness and stature.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is chosen to read the above introduction. He then designates himself as first to express his own philosophy about life and the universe. He indicates the direction that the conversation will proceed around the room.

Step 2 His discourse takes about one or two minutes. He may or may not say whether he believes in a deity or a creator. If he does, he should try to project to others just how he "sees" God, or the infinite or the source, or whatever he feels most comfortable with. If he doesn't, then he should try to project his view of an ordered or chaotic universe. In either case, he might try to explain whether or not he feels there is a purpose to the universe or a goal to life. He may then want to close with a personal goal or code.

Step 3 Each person follows in order. If any person hesitates or is not ready, he or she is asked if more time is needed and is then skipped and asked to speak later.

Step 4 After all who can have expressed their credo, the leader asks if anybody wishes to pose a question on some

point expressed that was not clear. He makes it abundantly clear himself that there may be no pointed questions that challenge, no argumentative questions.

Step 5 At the close of questions, the experience itself—of expressing beliefs—is discussed, but not the philosophies. Some of the lines that might be pursued are:

How many found this to be the first time in their lives they had ever had to put their belief into words?

How many of these first-time people had to dig to even know what they really believed?

How many were surprized or shocked at what someone else believed? Why?

How many now feel the desire to challenge one or more of these basic beliefs? Do they think they could change them tonight?

How many feel now the desire to expound their belief in more detail to the others? Do any feel they can convert others to their belief?

Step 6 The leader explains that each person in the group must feel trust and confidence in all present. Nobody is here to be changed by the others, only by his own free will and automatically by his own growth in consciousness, if at all. To help build this confidence, an exercise will now be performed as follows:

The group forms a circle. One person takes a position in the center of the circle and is blindfolded. He or she then turns slowly once or twice, stops, and falls gently backwards.* The group prevents the fall by catching or supporting the person who is falling. This may be repeated more than once, if desired. The next person then takes a position at the center of the circle and the procedure is repeated. And so on. The group should be divided into circles of not more than eight persons.

Step 7 Refreshments are served. The evening is discussed in twos and threes.

*It should be noted that falling backwards is difficult to do, as very few people can trust others sufficiently to "let go" completely. The legs should be stiff and straight and the fall should be one that rocks you on your heels in a way which forces people to your aid to save you from hitting the ground. "Learning to trust" is an important foundation for the next game.

Evening No. 2

“A Psychological Strip-Tease”

Hostility and suspicion lurk in us as we contend with job, family and friends. These are negative attitudes that stifle growth and awareness. Carry-overs from prehistoric man's fight to survive, they are defensive mechanisms which we use to protect our inner identity—that sort of “privacy of the personality.”

At the first Evening get-together, the group bared its collective philosophy and found that there was a climate of group tolerance and acceptance. Nobody squared off with anyone else. No heads were bloodied. Instead, there was a demonstration of trust—both mental and physical.

Tonight the group bares its collective personality.

However, this time, the flow of communication reverses. The group feeds back to each member the aspects of his or her personality that come on the strongest.

In a recent study of the social behavior of wolves, a naturalist was able to become so trusted by the wolf pack that he was able to crawl down the tunnel that a female wolf dug and to film the birth of her litter while the other wolves stood guard above. We may not have built up that level of total trust in one another in a single Evening, but a degree of trust now exists, enough so that one member of the group may say something critical as well as laudatory about another, and that person can know that there is no animosity, but that the comment is meant to be in the interests of all.

Again, there have been no advance instructions. The element of advance planning of what to say is eliminated in the interests of the reality of the moment. (“I don't want to hurt Jack's feelings so I won't mention that he talks too much about himself; instead I'll just say that he has a great gift of gab,” or “I guess Helen knows about her tendency to knock people, so I'll just mention her

gregariousness." This avoidance is less likely to happen when honest feelings are solicited on the spur of the moment.)

Still, there may be those that hold back. They will not be contributing to the success of the Evening. In fact, though they may feel that they are preserving friendships, they may in fact be jeopardizing them. Friendships are strongly cemented when honesty is displayed in an atmosphere of mutual trust.

Because a group personality chart or "grid" is used, you might call the game "Grid and Bare It." And if people hold back or soften their participation, call that "Cringe and Bury It."

The grid can be made in advance. If there are ten or less members of the group, a standard $8\frac{1}{2} \times 11$ sheet of white paper will suffice. More would require a larger sheet. Write the first names of all members down the side and again in the same order across the top. Draw vertical lines and horizontal lines forming squares. Label the horizontal names "Senders," and the vertical names "Reflectors."

Now you are ready for an Evening so action-packed, you may never forget it; memorable because it will probably:

Cause you to have thoughts you never before experienced;

Reveal how you are coming across to others;

Make you sharply aware of human similarities that exist, despite apparent differences, among individuals;

Demonstrate the love people can have for each other, transcending the barriers of their inner worlds.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is chosen to read the above introduction and this Procedure. He requests that the group form a circle and designates himself as the first to be a Sender, indicating in which direction around the circle turns as Sender shall be taken. He then takes a position at the center of the circle.

Step 2 A recorder is named to enter briefly in an appropriate square the gist of the remarks made by each Reflector about each Sender.

Step 3 Going in the opposite direction from the direction that Sender turns will be taken, each Reflector in the circle states briefly what he feels the person in the center

of the circle ought to know about himself. The person in the center (the Sender) remains there until each person in the circle (Reflectors) has had a turn. Statements should be no more than a sentence or two and cover only one personality point. Nothing shall be considered out of bounds. Dress, hair-style, or make-up can here be just as much an expression of personality as warmth, frigidity, introvertedness and extrovertedness. The Reflector *reflects* whatever he or she feels comes on the strongest from the Sender.

Step 4 After each person has been a Sender and has heard the comments of all Reflectors (this will vary with the number of those present; i.e., 10 present, 50 minutes; 15 present, nearly 2 hours), the leader reads his own personality chart—which is represented by the vertical line of boxes under his name. He then hands the chart over to the recorder who reads the horizontal comments made by the leader about others when he acted as a Reflector. This can give further insight into the personality of the leader.

Step 5 The recorder hands the chart to the next Sender and the same procedure is followed until all have read aloud their chart.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. A group discussion of the event ensues, as the grid chart is passed around for further perusal. The leader should seek to keep the discussion on an objective level. Perhaps it could cover such points as:

Did the method serve to permit confronting others without offensiveness or defensiveness?

Were the resulting personality "grids" basically accurate or inaccurate?

Did the Evening help those people to articulate who usually cannot make critical judgments in ordinary situations?

Did everyone enjoy the opportunity to criticize constructively and to have his own image reflected with mature clarity?

Is the group in its present discussion recognizing bitterness and dissolving it in love?

(In closing the evening, the leader advises everybody to come next time in work clothes, sports attire, or other garments that would not inhibit an "active" Evening. The

leader appoints an acting leader who will make preparations as outlined next.)

Evening No. 3

“Musical Alchemy”

“Up-tight” is an expression born with the present young generation. It describes quite aptly the tenseness that we all can develop because of physical or mental inhibitions. Tonight’s Evening should help to release these inhibitions and the tenseness while simultaneously providing an exhilarating and often hilarious time.

A little preparation is needed, as the Evening requires music and some art materials. An interim acting leader, appointed by the last session’s leader, should consider it his responsibility to line up a record player and records or tapes appropriate to the needs of the evening. Of course, if somebody who plays piano is available, so much the better. The larger his repertoire, the better.

A variety of music is needed. The selections to be made available should include symphonic music, martial music, amorous music, folk music, country and western music, dance music, rock, soul, jazz, operatic and so forth, if possible.

Here is why. Members of the group will react in movement and expression to the music. They will let themselves go as the mood of the music strikes them.

Different musical styles are needed because people have different life styles. Symphonic music can “send” one person and mean nothing to another. Soul music can be “the end” for one person, and irritate another. In between there can be all levels of reactions which, when expressed in the middle of the room by one or more people intent on interpreting their responses physically, can yield an intriguing outlet for all.

The art materials are needed because art will provide another outlet for expression, another means of “inter-

preting" the music. Sketch pads, charcoal, watercolors, art paper, brushes and any other art medium are perfect. If material for only one person to work with at a time is available, that's perfectly all right, but several working at the same time spreads the fun.

A final word of instructions on the music preparation. Since only brief excerpts (two to four minutes long) are needed, the acting leader should preaudition the selections, noting the most "moving" or poignant portions on the tapes or records.

The curtain is about to rise on an absorbing aspect of personal awareness and sensitivity. Layers that have taken years to drape around our personalities, in the name of propriety and a civilized society, could be instantaneously dissolved. In their place a vibrant aliveness may well be displayed which, because we lost it in childhood to the ravages of conformity, will appear childlike to us.

Yet calling it childlike does not belittle it. The childlike can be more sensitive to, more aware of, and more perceiving of people and the world around us than the more staid, apathetic, and remote adultlike.

To reacquire even momentarily the freedom to express ourselves that we had as children is to be given a taste of true joy. The quality we want is childlike, not childish.

Procedure

Step 1 The acting leader reads the above explanation and asks that the center of the room be cleared and the furniture moved back, to allow each individual maximum space to react to the music. The first selection is introduced by name, orchestra or performer and composer, as is each subsequent selection. Anybody may get up at any time, with any selection, and "do what comes naturally." This may be a dance, a walk, a pantomime, an exercise, lying on the floor in various positions, hand movements, facial gestures or any combination of physical movements. In other words, there are no bars.

There should be no vocal expression, no involvement with others at the present time. One person's activity may inspire another's, but there should be no partnership or teamwork.

The first selection begins.

Step 2 The acting leader watches for tapping feet or other signs of reaction to the music and encourages people to move into the center of the room. It may take a few

moments to overcome natural reticence to begin; the acting leader can help this along through encouragement. As a last resort (or first, if so moved) he can take the "stage" himself. This will break the ice and others should inevitably follow.

Step 3 After twenty to thirty minutes of various selections, the music is temporarily halted. The acting leader asks the group to vote as leader the most expressive member. Voting takes place by nominations and then a show of hands. The new leader then assigns priority to those who did not take part in the movements (if any) or those who were less "active" and expressive than others. The people who so choose are instructed to paint or sketch what they "hear" in the music; lines, color, shadings and form can be used to show what the music does "inside." The nonpainters may continue their physical movements as the music resumes.

An interchange can begin to take place. Perhaps a dirge is being played. Someone dancing can no longer relate to it through movement. He moves to a painter, and the painter, seeing the need, hands over the brush. The dancer becomes a painter and expresses the black music on paper. Similarly, those who are dancing to martial music, say, might want to stop and paint a militant painting. Thus, they express themselves in two media while interpreting the music.

They should feel doubly good, doubly aware of themselves and twice as convinced that they can do the things they, perhaps, thought they never could do, would do or should do.

(At one such gathering, a person who could not play the piano spontaneously began to make musical sounds on it; perhaps more noise than music, but he was using the piano as a medium for his own mood. His spontaneity and expressiveness were catching. Soon there was a total letting go. People played on the piano, people danced, people painted. They danced to express the paintings. Others painted the dancers. It took quite a while before they simmered down and the leader could ask them to clean up and straighten up the room.)

Step 4 After the action slows, or after thirty minutes to an hour, refreshments are served.

The release, exhilaration or other effects of the movements are discussed over the coffee or whatever. Those who painted now exhibit their work, ask others to com-

ment or guess, and then they explain what type of music was portrayed and possibly the reasons behind the result. The artists take home their art. The others take home their glimpse of joy.

Evening No. 4

“Full-Length Mirror”

This Evening the group will enjoy an exhilarating experience that derives its strength from the need to be loved and appreciated. Life's competitive environment provides a constant downward push to us as others try to better themselves at our expense. Even husbands and wives compete, and the results of this domestic contest are usually ego-depression and debasement. Love can have dramatic positive effects when translated into affectionate and nonsentimental endearing terms.

Without love, understanding and appreciation, we wilt. We turn inward. Awareness is dulled. We even insulate ourselves from the outside world to prevent awareness of it. All of us do this. Just to what extent is hard to say. Some people lose their appetites and waste away when the one who loves them most turns away. Many may be exhilarated after tonight's exercise in appreciation.

Procedure

Step 1 (A leader is chosen to read these directions.) The “Full-Length Mirror” exercise is done in a standing position along one wall of this room and around the corner if space requires. Each person is confronted in turn by every other who acts as a mirror to reflect what he or she sees in the person before them that is good. Each statement must be constructive and positive. No criticism is permitted. You might comment on a person's looks, bearing, radiance, personality, character or attitudes. It does not matter whether the person is seen for the first time, or your spouse. Speak about the attributes you

sense. Each statement should take about one minute, but no rigid time factor need be imposed.

Step 2 Participants line up. The leader is number one, at the beginning of the line. He faces number two, then faces number three, then number four. Number two then faces number three and number four in turn. And so forth. At the end, number one takes his place at the end of the line in turn to become a mirror. Number two does likewise, and number three, until the line is restored to its original position and all have been both mirror and recipient to all.

There may be tears or other evidence of emotional release triggered by a "direct hit" from a mirror. Because these are positive mirrors that see the good, not the weaknesses, the tears are tears of joy and the emotional shock is one of relief, as distorted and limited self-images are restored by mirrors to their proper high-potential perspective.

Step 3 Refreshments are served. Participants gravitate to the people whose remarks made the most impact on them, to discuss privately some discoveries about the self.

Step 4 The leader then interrupts to request that the group be seated again. He asks that comments on the effects of the experience be directed to the chair so that all may participate and react. Everybody leaves ten feet tall.

Evening No. 5

"The Physical Eye and the Mental Eye"

Many groups show marked changes by the fifth meeting. At the first meeting, members are usually cautious, goals are unclear, conversation is self-centered, the climate is not exactly one of trust.

By the fifth meeting an understanding should begin to develop. The group is likely to be more interested in what another person is saying; they are listening, not just hearing. There is often a feeling of expectancy, almost an impatience to get on with the next "adventure."

Further changes will almost certainly occur as the Evenings continue. Feedback from one person to another will doubtless be more common as a sort of group dynamics begins to appear. Soon a leader will probably be unnecessary as the group becomes integrated.

Tonight two people share the leadership in order to perform separate functions.

The host acts as leader number one. His first task takes place before the group arrives: he is to take two platters and fill each with fifteen different household objects. These can include such items as a spool of thread, a salt shaker, a bar of soap, a magnifying glass, a tie clip, a paper clip, a pen, an envelope, etc. The objects are placed so that all are in view. Be as diversified and imaginative as you can in your selection.

Put one platter on a small table in the meeting room. Cover it with a pillow case or large towel so that the contents and the edges of the platter cannot be seen. Keep the second platter out of sight in another room, also covered in the same way.

Now writing materials should be provided at each chair so that members will each have four sheets of paper, numbered one to four, large enough to list even more objects than are on the platters. You are now ready for their arrival.

The title of the Evening may raise some eyebrows. Is there a so-called "mental eye"? Can we perceive with our mind in a way comparable to what we do with our eyes?

A now-classic story is told of a day in New England when several children became lost. When they did not return that evening, a posse was sent out to search the nearby woods for them. They searched all night without success. They still had found no trace of them the following noon, when someone noticed that a blind and deaf child, of the same parents, had been "looking" off in a certain direction while gesturing and pointing and making small cries. A man in the searching party decided to

consider this a clue. He headed in that direction and within an hour came on the huddled group of frightened youngsters.

There is a world of evidence that the mind can "pick up" intelligence at a greater distance than the eye. This is called extrasensory perception, or ESP. It often goes unrecognized or under the label of intuition, inspiration or instinct. We all have it to a degree. Some who have tried to develop it have succeeded. Some prefer, on the other hand, to call it "coincidence."

Tonight we test our visual awareness as well as the awareness of our mind's eye. There may be some dramatic discoveries. And a few "coincidences."

Procedure

Step 1 Leader number one reads the above introduction, starting with the last four paragraphs ("The title of the Evening . . ." etc.). He avoids reading the examples of household objects in order not to provide "suggestions" that might affect results. Everyone writes his name at the top of all four numbered sheets. The leader asks each member to try to "perceive" with his mind's eye what is on the platter in front of him and to list any common objects that come to him. Leader number one collects the folded papers.

Step 2 Leader number one announces that he will now remove the cover from the platter and will place it back in sixty seconds. In that time all the group members should come to the table, examine the objects and try to commit to memory as many as possible. When the cover is taken off, leader one, as a private exercise, uses his one minute to attempt to "second guess" the total number of "hits" that the group has made in their attempt to "see" the objects before the cover was lifted. He calls time at the end of one minute. The members return to their seats and write what they've seen. Leader number one then collects these folded papers. He moves the first tray to the side and brings in the second covered tray.

Step 3 Leader number two is appointed or elected. He will now conduct the group in a relaxation exercise to see if a deep state of relaxation will:

Improve the perceiving ability of the mind's eye;
Improve the teamwork of the physical eye working in concert with the memory.

Tenseness works against us. Relaxation permits the

faculties to operate at closer to their fullest potential. Also, deep relaxation is akin to self-hypnosis. When in a deeply relaxed state, the mind often exhibits some of the strange powers that it does in hypnosis. One of these is heightened ESP.

Members are asked to place writing materials on the floor within easy reach. They are to sit comfortably in their chairs with their hands on their laps. The following monologue uses the "heaviness" technique of relaxation. Since we fight gravity unconsciously all day, surrendering to gravity is a key factor in relaxation. Leader number two then reads this monologue slowly with the group following his instructions:

We are very comfortable. . . . We sit limply. . . . We concentrate on our feet. . . . We wiggle our toes to make sure the muscles are all relaxed. . . . We let our feet rest heavily on the floor. . . . The limpness makes our legs and thighs heavy. . . . It creeps up our hips into our back. . . . We sit heavily and limply. . . . Our whole body feels loose, limp and heavy. It is a pleasant feeling. . . . Now our face loosens. The lips part. Our eyes droop. . . . It is an effort to keep our eyes open. . . . Now they close gently. . . . We relax our mind, permitting it to concentrate on the sound of my voice, keeping out other thoughts. . . . Now even my voice will stop, and your mind will be blank . . . free to concentrate on the objects in the covered tray I have just brought in. . . . I want you to permit pictures of what lies on that tray to enter your mind. . . . When they have done this, open your eyes, reach for your pencil and paper, write what comes to mind, return paper and pencil to the floor and close your eyes again. . . . Begin. . . . [One minute pause.] One minute to go. . . . [One minute pause.] All-right, time is up; at the count of three, open your eyes feeling refreshed and full of energy. One, two, three!

Step 4 Leader number two repeats Step 2 with the new tray as leader number one—who was concentrating on direct "hits"—at the close of relaxation now records his new estimate.

Step 5 The original papers are returned. Leader number one calls off the objects as each member checks his right answers on the mind's-eye and physical-eye lists. Leader number two does the same for the second tray. Each member in turn then recites his score:

Number of mind's-eye "hits" before relaxation;
 Number of mind's-eye "hits" during relaxation;
 Number of eye-memory items before relaxation;

Number of eye-memory items during relaxation.
 A show of hands is requested for all whose mind's eye improved through relaxation—then for all whose memory improved through relaxation. Leader number one is asked to report on his mind's-eye estimated "hit" results.
Step 6 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on mind's-eye "hits" and how they may have happened, and on the effects of relaxation.

Evening No. 6

"Vanity of Vanities"

Men and women are vain. They like to be flattered. Knowing this, many of us flatter others. What are our reasons or our needs? What does the flatterer or flattered seek from the other? Power? Affection? Money? Attention? Friends? Social position? Esteem? Respect? These are all worthwhile ends, but is flattery a valid means to them?

Tonight we will discover just how much we flatter others or like to be flattered ourselves—and, possibly, why. We will discover how wrong people can be about us and how wrong we can be about them.

Many friendships cool off when one friend does not permit the other to retain his self-image. One might continually praise the other for his good judgment but when his own vanity is not fed in return he begins to think that maybe that person is not "on his side" after all.

This deterioration in human relationships is a sad waste and could be avoided if a new dimension of awareness were added—awareness of vanity at work. With such awareness people could enjoy:

Closer and more lasting friendships;
 A refreshing honesty in all relationships;

Less frustration and greater fulfillment.

This game is also designed to show that we are continually judging people at face value as to their motives (i.e., politicians), jealousies (social) and honesty (business world) almost daily without even knowing personally many of the characters we read about in newspapers or see on TV. Those whom we meet as strangers are also often judged summarily. How much can we really judge about the inner world of another? Here we try a game which reveals our capacity to make statements of the kind we make every day about people we often don't really know. But in the game we make these statements to people we *do* know, however slightly, to get some idea of the difficulties involved and to get some feedback.

Participants who arrive early are asked to circulate expressing flattery as a limbering-up exercise.

If the number of participants exceeds ten the group should split into two circles. The host writes the three questions in Step 1 on a piece of paper to be read out by the one who volunteers to occupy the hot seat.

Procedure

Step 1 There is no leader tonight. The host or another designated person may read the above introduction and these procedural steps. The group sits in a circle. A volunteer is picked to begin. He or she sits in the center of the circle, in "the hot seat," and asks each person in turn for an evaluation of how they see him in each of three respects:

Do I harbor malice, jealousy or resentment?

Am I honest with myself and with others?

Am I an overly materialistic or sensual person, pulled away from loftier purposes?

At any point the subject may change the questions to some other negative qualities such as: Am I vain? Deceitful? Pushing? Aggressive? Inconsiderate? Greedy?

Step 2 The subject may at any time terminate by turning to the group as a whole and asking for a consensus as to whether the witnesses have been accurate and if anyone has some different concept of him. (It is important that the conversation be limited to three points—above—at any one time, and all should be alert to any wandering and call out "Point of order" when it happens.)

Step 3 The subject then answers the three questions the way he sees himself. No argument or debate is permitted. He allows all statements made about him to stand and merely states his own facts about himself as he sees them.

Step 4 The next volunteer assumes the center of the circle and proceeds in the same fashion. Remarks should be crisp and to the point, otherwise the game can become rather vague and begin to lag. As it is, it is unlikely that all can have a turn. In a group of ten, each subject will probably consume fifteen minutes or more, and there may not be time for a full round.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. A leader is chosen now for Evening No. 7, as certain preparations must be made. There is no formal discussion. Each person will be taking home much to reflect on privately. Each should realize the extent to which he stoops to flattery and how much he likes to be flattered himself. Each should realize how most judgments of others are based on vanities and the projection of our needs and prejudices into the lives of others. When we become addicted to these white lies, they can spread and interfere with "right thinking." Awareness of this in time can pull us back to a determination to reach the perfect state of clear judgment, pure appraisals and rational thinking.

Evening No. 7

"Comedy of Errors"

The leader for this event was named at the last session so that he or she could prepare for a rather "far out" Evening. It is an Evening of errors.

Awareness of things going wrong is a measure of total awareness. A person sensitive to error is a person sensitive to truth, good judgment and correct action.

A technique for improving this awareness is part of the evening's agenda, but first the leader must prepare a list

of twenty to thirty errors that he will commit, half before the exercise of this technique, and half after.

These errors or mistakes can take the form of:

Calling people by the wrong name;

Running short of drinks, so a person is omitted;

Mispronouncing a word repeatedly or several words on separate occasions;

Wearing socks or shoes that do not match;

Getting facts wrong about people or events;

Or any other simple, detectable errors that are not forced but can fit naturally into the course of the Evening.

A list of these errors should be made in advance. Then the list should be divided in half—those that he will make during the first part of the Evening, and those he will make during the second half.

Also needed for the Evening are make-up materials. These can be standard lipstick, rouge, face powder and eye shadow or they can include the stage variety of greasepaint, if available.

The purpose of these materials will be for participants to enjoy making up themselves as they would like to appear to others, or making up others as they seem to appear to them—all in symbolic exaggeration and caricature. It is a therapeutic exercise deriving its benefits from the releasing of inhibitions and the exploding of personal mannerisms and fantasies.

Halfway through the Evening an age-old method of instant awareness will be introduced. It is called meditation.

Meditation is a word that is its own worst enemy. Most people think that to meditate means to strike the pose of Rodin's "The Thinker." Actually, there is no thinking in meditation. In fact, that's what meditation is—not thinking, just quieting the mind and placing it in a receptive, expectant state.

The effects of meditation are often dramatic and hard to explain. Why does quieting the mind for several minutes:

Help alleviate physical conditions?

Bring answers to difficult problems?

Improve the personality?

Accelerate personal growth?

At this point, ours is not to reason why but instead to experience the dramatic changes that can take place.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader reads the above introduction and asks all present to make mental notes of all errors they detect. He can now begin to implement them.

Step 2 Pairs of volunteers are solicited to enjoy the greasepaint party. The recipient should be willing to surrender to the grotesque results that might ensue. The make-up artist should be anxious to create an exaggerated but valid "impression." If there are many pairs of volunteers, several may work simultaneously at the center of the room so that the rest may enjoy the proceedings. Or one pair may work at a time. When finished, the make-up artist explains why he exaggerated eyes or lips, etc., and invites questions or comments from the others.

Step 3 Each pair reverses roles and the process is repeated until half of the volunteers have had a chance.

Step 4 This is the halfway point of the Evening. People with make-up on are permitted to wash up and "restore" their faces. When all are gathered together again, the leader requests quiet. He dims the lights and informs the group that two minutes of meditation will take place. He will say "start" when meditation is to begin, and he will mark the end of two minutes by saying "stop." He explains the need to relax the body, similar to the heaviness technique of Evening No. 5, and then to quiet the mind (some people visualize clouds, say, others just "listen" to the universe, some attune themselves to God or to the prophet of their choice, some maintain a mental vacuum). He says "start" and at the end of approximately two minutes he says "stop."

Step 5 The balance of the make-up volunteers are given their chance to proceed as in Steps 2 and 3. The leader proceeds to carry out the second half of his errors.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. The leader asks for a show of hands on the total errors spotted in the first half of the Evening. "How many spotted only one error? Two errors? Three? . . ."

This is done for the second half as well. A quantitative comparison is made of the two halves. Someone is asked to enumerate the errors. Others are then asked to add any not mentioned. Were all errors discovered? Were there unplanned errors also discovered?

Step 7 The leader asks if anyone present noticed any change in the mood or tenor of the make-up in the second

half of the Evening as compared to the first half. Less exaggeration? More emphasis of higher qualities?

Step 8 Experiences of meditation, if any, are described by those who wish to share them with others. A leader is chosen for the next Evening.

Evening No. 8

“Body Magic”

Except for the leader's private information, this introduction should not be read until just before refreshments are served.

Can we believe our senses? Is it possible that our eyes, ears, sense of touch, etc. can give our brain wrong information?

If so, when is this likely to happen and how can we double-check ourselves?

To prepare for this Evening, the leader needs the following materials: an empty frozen-juice can in the standard six-ounce size, an empty coffee can (two-pound size), two dinner plates and three household buckets (preferably of uniform size).

Before the Evening is over, participants should realize that we cannot always believe our senses; some distortion is constantly occurring. And that one quick way we can help to purify our “reception” is by being aware of this possibility of distortion.

Future Evenings will provide more advanced techniques to heighten fidelity and sensitivity. Meanwhile, prepare for an Evening of surprises as follows:

Fill the juice can with sand or soil almost to the top. Place only a little in the coffee can so that it weighs one ounce less. Weigh them on a scale that indicates ounces. If the bathroom scale is not this accurate and you do not have a postal scale, try the local meat market or grocery store. Keep these cans in the kitchen out of sight of the participants. The three buckets should also be a deep,

dark secret. You should be ready to fill these with ice water, hot water and lukewarm (skin temperature) water respectively.

You are now ready for the fun.

Procedure

Step 1 The above introduction is *not* read. These instructions are *not* read. The leader states that the title of the evening is "Body Magic" but explains, "That's all I'm permitted to say."

Step 2 The leader asks each person to shake hands with the person on each side of him; all are in a circular group. He next asks that the act be repeated with the left hand. A discussion ensues on the differences felt by breaking through the sense barrier built by habit. The leader asks for another round of handshaking—this time the right hand is used and the grip held for as long as is necessary to attain the same degree of "feeling" as enjoyed by the left hand. Differences are noted as some need to hold for longer than their partners or other pairs.

Step 3 The leader asks that participants arrange their chairs so that two equal groups face each other on opposite sides of the room. While they are moving the chairs, he goes into the kitchen for the two cans and returns. He asks the two people at the ends of each row nearest him to stand up and face so that the group can see them. Each is asked to hold palms up, waist high. The leader places the cans on the hands of the first person and asks which is heavier. He gets an opinion in the same way from the second person. He then asks that both be blindfolded, using handkerchiefs or scarves.

While this is being done, he puts the cans on the floor in full view of all and brings two dinner plates from the kitchen. The first blindfolded "weigher" then again places palms up and the dinner plates are placed on his hands. "Any weight difference?" Then the two cans are placed on the plates. "How about now?" The second blindfolded "weigher" is then given his chance. If all has gone well, the two "weighers" have declared the coffee can heavier on the first go around with no blindfold, even though it is actually lighter. And no weight difference has been felt when they were blindfolded. If, per chance, one of the blindfolded "weighers" has felt a weight difference on the plates above when blindfolded, they should be reversed and weighed again. This may reveal that a "righty" or

"lefty" is being affected by the better muscles of the hand he favors. Occasionally, a blindfolded "weigher" will accurately detect the one ounce difference of the two cans.

Step 4 The leader requests a discussion on why the lighter can "felt" heavier while the optical sense was participating. While discussion is in progress he prepares the three pails. One has lukewarm water. One has ice water from which any unmelted ice is now removed. The other is filled with steaming hot water from the tap. This water should be tested so that one's hand can be inserted in it, but still it should be as hot as possible. In some climates this bucket will steam. If it does, the leader asks three pairs of opposite participants to blindfold themselves when he brings out the lukewarm bucket and places it in the center of the room. He waits until this is done before returning for the other two buckets.

Step 5 The participants are instructed that no talking is permitted by anybody unless so instructed. The leader places the cold bucket of water in front of the first blindfolded person and the hot bucket in front of the blindfolded person opposite him. He asks each to place his right hand in the bucket and to hold it there without comment for thirty seconds. Then he leads each to the center bucket and asks each to immerse the same hand in that bucket in turn for just a second or two. He then asks the two to discuss the temperature of the center bucket with each other and to come to some conclusion.

Step 6 When a disagreement is apparent, the procedure is repeated for the second and third pair of blindfolded members. Others not blindfolded are invited to go through the two-part procedure.

Step 7 Blindfolds are removed. The obvious reasons for the different "feeling" of the water are discussed. The terms "vantage point," "relative" and "comparative" are likely to pop up in the discussion.

Step 8 After the cans and pails are removed, the participants are asked to return to their chairs in the original circular arrangement. The leader asks one person to think of a brief episode involving him that day, to write it down in a few short sentences and in fifteen seconds maximum to whisper it into the ear of the person on his right. That person in turn whispers it into the ear of the person on his right. When the last person receives it, he announces to the group what he heard. The first person

then recites the original form of the "message." The inevitable discrepancy is analyzed and discussed.

Step 9 Step 8 can be repeated until the appropriate hour for serving refreshments. The following is read as a preamble to discussion:

The senses can be fooled. Separately they are not totally trustworthy in our evaluation and judgment of life's experiences. When all the senses that can be used in a situation are put to work, the results can be more accurate, especially a sixth sense or intuitive deduction at a higher level of consciousness. Our feelings about people can be quite wrong when the input is limited to sight and sound. This higher level of conscious awareness is vital.

Evening No. 9

"East Meets West"

In India, the art of meditation and body control has reached such skilled levels that "impossible" feats can be performed. Scientists and other observers are hard put to explain what they see. Tonight, we will not lie on beds of nails, walk through burning embers barefoot, defy gravity or bury ourselves alive. But we will do something to our state of consciousness and awareness that will vault us to new levels of existence.

Seldom, if ever, do we permit our mind to wander through our body, nor do we direct its visualizing capability at its cells, nor do we remind the molecules that they are connected by electrical forces to molecules in other humans, indeed to the whole universe. Yet, if you translate what the Far Eastern yogis and gurus do into Western terms this is exactly what takes place.

It may not be everybody's cup of tea. Some may wish to watch instead of participate. Others who start may wish to drop back to the sidelines. Fine. This is a permissive Evening.

Those who participate "all the way" are in for:

A recharging of their life force;
 A spiritual uplift of major proportions;
 An unforgettable inner illumination.

Procedure

Step 1 Light refreshments or beverages are served at the start of the Evening with the explanation that participants will understand why later. The chosen leader reads the above introduction and reemphasizes the optional aspects of participation. He has the group form a circle and then conducts the relaxation exercise using the hypnotic monologue of Evening No. 5, Step 3.

Step 2 The leader then places a lighted candle in the center of the room and guides the group by reading the following discourse slowly and in a monotone voice:

In the world of light there are many kinds of light and many kinds of light energies. The life light within us is the light that quickens our vital functions, a kind of psychic energy. The light you see in front of you is to help you to visualize light and then to step up your visualization from a candle to a sun, from a sun to the life light within us. Those who prefer to visualize a religious symbol in place of the candle may use their imagination accordingly.

If you wish to sit or lie on the floor so that your eyes are level with the candle, you may. Keep your feet pointed to the candle, because this has been found to be the path by which this divine light, if you wish, has been found to enter the human most readily.

Look at the light. Then close your eyes and look up inside your head to the center between the brows. Send your vision soaring upward until it is lost in the mind's eye. There it will find a point of light which is the central intelligence of our being. I will pause as you concentrate on this center. . . .

This center is the transmitting station from which inspiration can be flashed into your mind. Now we send a message down through the nervous system from that central point to the whole brain and into the heart, to the bottom of the feet. The message is that the whole body is tuning in to its source of electrical energy. We know, electrically and scientifically, that all the molecules and atoms of our body are merely vibrating frequencies of electricity. As we visualize and experience this deeply, we send out a message for the whole universe, that we are connected by these electrical forces to the sun and the moon and the stars. These highly energetic oscillating electrons and atoms in space are

whorls of energy swirling in our own expanded field of being. We are like a radio listener whose set is enveloped in the radio frequencies coming from the signal transmitting station. These, too, are passing through space continuously whether one has got his radio set on or not. We liken ourselves to the radio set which is now being switched on and is receiving the program over the radio waves. As we do this, we become aware that our body is not limited by its physical form, that, as vibrations of electricity and wave lengths, it can transmit to any part of the universe and receive a message back by the same kind of radio that sends messages to the moon and to Mars or to the sun. The sun's rays are part of the sun, they are the radio magnetic energy which has come from that central sun. Likewise we visualize ourselves as a burning, blazing sun, transmitting our rays of light out into the far reaches of the universe. As we feel this golden light enveloping us, just as the earth is bathed in the sun's light, we begin to feel its warmth within. The material gross wave lengths of the body merge together, unite, and join to involve the organs of perception. Our consciousness now controls this light, permits it to stream through all the sensory organs of the body, bringing our prevailing state to one of illuminated intelligence. I pause as you bask in this light. . . . [Pause fifteen seconds.]

This is the stuff which plays through us when we are asleep and unconscious, when the self has been put away. Then our entire nervous system and organs are regenerated with this vital force.

Now, with our mind, we begin to weave this light into threads, and imagine that from our head the light has flashed to the center flame or the figure at our feet, and it becomes a flashing circle from the right of our head to the head of the figure of light through the center of the candle flame, thus completing the circle. This radiant image in our mind's eye is done in a flash. The mind does not wander lingeringly, but as a spark of electricity, without time for contemplation. It comes like a flash of lighting. It becomes a quickening process. It should be done quickly so that the mind does not linger over the process. Do it now. A circle of light from our head to the flame to our feet. *Flash!*

As soon as we have done this we enter into the central flame and become the light ourselves: instead of being separate points of consciousness, we become one with light and energy and vibration, so that our wave length is the same. And then we become conscious of the pulsating movement of this light passing through us like the breath in our lungs and we begin to breathe in and

out, as the whole universe breathes, with pure life energy.

On the inward breath, we become conscious of the gravitational forces pulling toward the center within. On the outward breath, we become conscious of the centrifugal forces expanding the universe outward. And as we do this conscious psychic breathing, we bring to being the rhythm of our eternal life energy which is actually creating our breath.

Then we begin to visualize breath going down from the body in the solar plexus to the feet. And then the breath going straight from the solar plexus to the infinite point of light above. We know if this exercise is repeated every day, whenever we are worried, uncertain or angered by anyone, or whenever we feel resentment, we will solve the problem.

We visually enter into this conscious breathing of the vital forces; relaxing and letting go in the universe; becoming one with the forces of light. Our own breath becomes fused with the very source of creation and thus we transcend the pressure of the material body and enter into its real manifestation as electrical, vibrational energy. We create a renewed body. By the integration of atomic substance in the human flesh with the whole universal process, we provide a channel for life energy to be transmitted through our "television station"—that center of consciousness in our own life.

Thus we retune ourselves and improve our receptivity to divine wave lengths by the continual focus of our mind with the mind of God, if you will, or the universal source. Where our mind is focused is very important indeed. For there you are, yourself, identified. Just as when you focus your mind on your worries and your problems, frustrations and inhibitions, then that focus is the cause of disease and eventually the cause of death. And death may come while we are still alive, for we can be walking dead. We can be dead to our own universal process that is going on within, because we instantly become what we identify with. So the practice of this exercise is meant to focus the mind on the universal energies and the vital forces which flow through us at all times and which carry the divine program. Just as we know that all around us radio waves carry the programs of different stations, so we must learn to tune our receptivity into that wave length of the divine universal mind.

Step 3 The leader of the group brings back the circle into their waking consciousness with suggestions that they will remain centered in God or the universal source, and that hopefully they will continue to practice this exercise

on their own as individuals each day until the group meets again the following week. No discussions of the experiences which people have had in this session should be allowed since those who did not experience profoundly would feel inadequate if those who did rambled on about their own inner states and experiences. And, after all, these verbalizations are mere vanities, often glamorized by people needing attention, or in self-glorification of their own powers. The group should be asked to go home in silence and ponder their experiences rather than lose psychic power and energy by verbalizing them one to another. Many people talk about their psychic experiences the way some people talk about their operations. This form of self-adulation is to be discouraged, since all it does is encourage psychic forces to leak away; the whole object of the exercise is to store up these forces so that they can be channeled and used for higher spiritual experiences.

Step 4 The host explains that he has prepared a "loving cup" of communion wine or punch and that all those who feel inclined to share it are invited to come forward to partake of it. He should not go round the group offering it to everyone, because some may refuse it, but he should allow those with the humility to share to come forward, and let those who would feel embarrassed remain seated. He should then drink the entire remainder in a significant way, as in a ritual. It is important to master the embarrassment of not speaking when there is nothing sacred, or more important to say, and to let silence speak louder than words. This embarrassment will be difficult for some present, but they will grow by dealing with it.

Step 5 The leader then breaks the silence by saying that all are welcome to stay in silence, as the object of the Evening has been to bring all present into a nonverbal experience of communion and fellowship. He invites those who wish to sit in the silence until they feel moved to leave. He explains that all they need to do is to get up and salute the host or hostess, in the Indian way, pressing the palms together as in prayer—which means, "I salute the highest in you." Then they are to put on their coats and say goodbye with the eyes, or, for those who like closer contact, by using the Muslim way of the silent bear hug. The silence should be so pregnant and thick with profound meaning that each member of the group should feel he could cut it with a knife.

Evening No. 10

“Building Telepathic Power”

The powers of the mind have often been harnessed by men who have abused them. Adolf Hitler had an advanced awareness of these powers, but a distorted sense of what was right. The practitioners of voodoo in Haiti today and the kahunas of Hawaii can use their knowledge for good or for evil in the guise of good.

Abuse has a way of returning to the abuser, just as good has a way of returning its blessing to the doer.

Tonight we will toy with a power of the mind known as telepathy. Being aware of this power is the first step in its further development within us. Knowing that we are always “senders” and always “receivers” can begin to improve our effectiveness in both of these telepathic functions.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is named. After reading the above introduction, he asks whether anybody has ever tried the trick of staring at the back of the neck of the person in front of him in an elevator. It usually does not take long for the person in the elevator to show some evidence that he “feels” the stare. Or has a man looked at the receding figure of a bathing suited girl and seen her reach to tug down her suit in the back? The leader then asks two volunteers to join him as starers while the others turn their backs. The starers confer as to who will be their target. The leader asks that a person raise his hand as soon as he feels a stare. The leader says “begin.” The starers take care not to let their stares wander. Anyone who raises his hand who is not a target is asked to become an observer until only two are left.

Step 2 The above Step was just a demonstration. Now this Step will be a “control” exercise. It will be done now,

and then it will be performed again after two telepathy-development exercises are performed. There could be an improvement in the results in a short period of time. The following Step 2 instructions are read completely before proceeding. The leader asks all present to examine the furniture in the room carefully, taking special note of the location and placement of all pieces. He explains that they will all be asked to leave the room in a moment, and then to return blindfolded to see if they can detect what single change has been made. He gives them another half-minute to observe and then dismisses them. He interchanges two somewhat different chairs—not large pieces of furniture. Then he calls for them to return when their blindfolds are in place. Each person attempts, silently, to work out what change has been made. The leader instructs those who feel they have the answer to leave the room silently and to remove their blindfolds only after they have left. When all are back out, he returns the two chairs to their original positions and invites the participants to return and to announce their “findings.” After all have done so, he confirms the change that had been made. He advises participants that a smaller object will be involved the second time around, after Steps 3 and 4, and to improve their mental picture of the room in the interim.

Step 3 Everyone stands in a circle while one person stands in the middle with eyes closed. The leader silently points to a member, and all in the circle lean toward that person while simultaneously looking and concentrating on the person in the center. The person in the center has no idea who has been chosen, but usually leans toward him. To be a good receiver, the person in the center should not consciously “try,” but should stand in a relaxed, receptive way. Others wishing to try the center role may change places and the exercise may be repeated.

Step 4 Members return to their seats. One member is asked to leave the room and to return when called to try to identify an object in the room on which all present are concentrating. When he has left, the group leader, with the agreement of the others, selects the object. Concentration should be by visualizing the object, but not by directing the gaze at any objects. Eyes should be closed or staring at the floor. The leader recalls the person. Silence is maintained as the person is merely told “cold,” “warm” or “hot” as he tries to focus in on the object.

Step 5 The exercise in Step 2 is repeated. This time a

smaller object, like a footstool, table lamp or side table is moved to a different location.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on what telepathy might be and why it has eluded standard scientific approaches.

Evening No. 11

“Verbal Stimulation”

The most severe punishment ever devised by man is not the “stocks” of colonial days, the water drops on the head said to be a Chinese device or the torture racks of Inquisition days. The most severe punishment is solitary confinement.

When sensory inputs of human relationships cease, the personality of man begins to disintegrate. Mental imbalance, hallucinations and eventual breakdown can follow.

The opposite—an abundance of rich human relationships—can be the greatest blessing that can accrue to man. Everyone has a basic need for human relationships. They are the prime food for the growth of the personality. Given a continuing flow of meaningful experiences with other people, a person’s growth in life is assured, his mental stability becomes more unshakable and he realizes more and more of his fullest potential—intellectually, physically and spiritually.

The answer appears easy. Be a good mixer. But this is not necessarily inviting *rich* human experiences. As we meet here tonight, there are social meetings and get-togethers in millions of other American homes. Yet, when goodnights are said, participants go home with very little more than what they brought with them.

Tonight, here, this point should become abundantly clear: the average social get-together can be sterile compared to a growth-in-awareness get-together. The usual meaninglessness of the former ought to become evident when compared to the living reality of the latter.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader for tonight declares that for the first part of the evening (he declines to mention how long because this element of time would tend to interfere with natural "performance") there will be a social get-together. He does not read the above introduction until the end of about one half hour of socializing. During this period he makes the rounds and advises that instructions call for the members to change positions from time to time. This is so that the usual rather superficial discussions will take place between the small groups of two, three or four that people naturally form.

Step 2 The leader ends the "social" session and reads the introduction. Another Evening within an Evening then takes place. It can be entitled

"Face To Face"

The first step is for each member to greet every other member with a traditional Continental embrace. This is a hug, with cheek to cheek—first on one side, then on the other. The leader can start by greeting the person on his left and continuing around the circle; the person just greeted rises and follows suit, etc., until all have greeted and been greeted by everyone present.

The second step is for the group to divide into pairs. This is a nonverbal session in which a pair faces one another and examines each other's face and looks into each other's eyes. There may be no speaking. One partner who desires to may touch the other's face if he or she "gets" nonverbal permission. The pairs change partners at the leader's command after about five minutes until there have been at least three combinations.

Step 3 The leader asks all to sit quietly and meditate on the two events that have taken place. He announces that one person will be asked to give a three-minute talk on "Which of the two parts of this evening I found most rewarding, and why." Members are quiet for several minutes. The leader selects the person to give the talk. (It is important that this selection is not made until everybody has had this chance to prepare his piece. This should have the effect of charging everyone up until each is "bursting" to say his piece. When only one is chosen, the others feel the need to expound later in the course of discussion.) When the person completes his brief talk, discussion is invited. This promises to be one of the liveliest discussions so far. Even a "sticky" group will come alive. The leader can use the serving of refreshments to end the

Evening or, at his discretion, permit the "verbal stimulation" to expend itself.

Evening No. 12

"Clearing the Air"

Many so-called awareness sessions have been described as "insult free-for-alls." Participants trade insults, and something positive is expected to emerge from the negative morass. We wonder.

The therapeutic effect of any confrontation among participants should be the total honesty which it produces. It is hard to conceive of people who are not worthy of some compliments. Compliments should fly back and forth just as frequently—if not more so—as criticism.

The resulting honesty clears the air. You can almost smell the ozone as after a summer thunder shower.

Tonight the group will be confronting each member. Unlike the "Full-Length Mirror Game" previously played, criticism is permitted along with compliments. In fact, it is required.

However, debate is not permitted. The receiver of the compliment or criticism may reply "I agree" or "I do not agree." He or she may not argue or comment on it. Likewise, the giver of the compliment or criticism may not support, elaborate or defend it.

The key to the game is that *no idle conversation* or chatter or debate will take place. There will be long silences, but these should not be considered embarrassing. People may be looking at each other hopelessly, but—behind the silence—defenses should be dropping, barriers melting, clairvoyant feelings sent and received and the group air should become purified.

The results can be:

Loads lifted from shoulders;

Personalities released from self-made prisons;

Enriched friendships.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader for tonight reads the above introduc-

tion and then asks that chairs be adjusted to form a rough circle. He begins the proceedings by taking the "hot seat" at the center of the circle and asking the group to begin their analysis of him. Any member of the circle may speak up at will with something good or bad about the leader's appearance, personality, effectiveness, character, etc. After each comment, the person in the "hot seat" is given a chance to think about what was said and to reply "I agree" or "I disagree." Only then may another member offer the next remark. Each person must remain in the "hot seat" for at least five minutes, even if comments lag—and longer if comments are still flowing.

Step 2 The leader selects the person whom he thinks has been most critical as the one to follow him in the "hot seat." The leader continues to name the next participant, favoring this same criterion where applicable or possible, until all have had their one turn in the "hot seat."

Step 3 Refreshments are served and an informal discussion follows.

Evening No. 13

"The Pendulum"

The growth of awareness is a process quite similar to being born. There may be no first breath, no cutting of the umbilical cord, but there are strange new lights, feelings and experiences that defy relating to past experiences because they are so new.

A young married woman was once visited unexpectedly by her neighbor and caught in the act of reading Emerson's essays. Had it been Spock, things would have been different. She would have been doing what comes naturally to the diaper-talk set. However, Emerson marked her as a misfit in her neighbor's eyes and she was no longer invited to that house.

Little did that neighbor know that she was witnessing a birth.

A man in his forties, vacationing at Waikiki, rented a

surfboard and took it down to the ocean's edge. It was his first time. He floated it gently in the quiet reef-protected water and then tried to lie on top it. He fell off. This process was repeated several times before he found the secret of approaching it from the rear instead of the side. People were amused as they watched him—a middle-aged man ought to stick to his chair and umbrella.

Little did those people know that they were witnessing a birth.

When we try new experiences we are evolving—being born to a higher and more evolved state of existence. The laugh is actually ours.

If Mr. and Mrs. Average Joe from down the road were to barge in tonight, they would be a bit taken aback. The activity they would witness would cause them to leave promptly, scratching their heads and wondering what had “come over” their neighbors.

Yet tonight's activity goes on daily in the privacy of the offices of thousands of psychologists. It is known as the pendulum technique and it has enabled subjects who use it to delve into the deep recesses of their unconscious minds and to find out causes for unwanted conditions and solutions to complicated problems.

For some people, the pendulum technique can go further than causes and actually indicate effects. This may be a simple cause-effect relationship being “read.” Or it can be a not-so-simple probing of the intelligence in the space-time continuum—in other words, a look into the future!

Procedure

Step 1 The leader reads the above introduction and then asks that a button and a piece of thread be produced by the host so that a simple pendulum can be made about twelve inches long. This is done by merely tying the button on one end of the string and holding the other end so that the button is free to swing.

Step 2 The leader or a volunteer accepts first chance with the pendulum. He sits comfortably with his elbow supported by his knee and the pendulum free to swing in any direction. He is reminded that the pendulum is not to be consciously moved. It should be held limply rather than rigidly so that it can be more easily moved by imperceptible muscular motions directed by the subconscious. The person holding the pendulum asks the question, “Which way is ‘yes’?” The pendulum should begin to move. For some it will move in a straight line; for others, in a circle.

The straight line in which it moves then indicates a "yes" answer to future questions. A line perpendicular to this straight line will indicate "no." If a circular motion results, then that is "yes" and the opposite circular motion is "no." Some sample questions that the pendulum holder can ask of his own subconscious are:

Will I be successful in my business?

Will I stay on my present diet long enough to attain normal weight?

Will I sell my house?

Will I take a plane flight this week (month)?

Will I benefit from these awareness sessions?

Other members can ask questions about the individual holding the pendulum, too. Questions must be clear or the pendulum will move erratically or not at all. For instance: "Will we all become mature adults from these awareness sessions?" is an unclear question as it covers more than one person and uses the term "mature," which is relative.

Step 3 The pendulum is passed to the next person for similar questioning.

Step 4 Another method used to probe the subconscious is known as "automatic writing." The leader explains that this is nonconscious writing by a subject who permits his subconscious to "take over." One or two volunteers now go to separate rooms with pad and paper to try it. Each performs the relaxation exercise when seated. Then he places his hand in a writing position, asks a question and waits expectantly. Each returns in twenty minutes with or without results.

Step 5 Refreshments are served and the results are discussed.

Evening No. 14

"You Don't Understand Me"

How do we picture our roles in the group? Are we who we think we are? Do we overestimate our capacities or underestimate them?

This game provides the feedback we need to answer

these questions. It involves role playing. This is a process wherein we'll act out a part selected from domestic or social life in order to see ourselves in action. Sometimes this action becomes quite real as the actors warm up. Its advantage over real life is that the "action" can be stopped at any point, then analyzed and discussed in a constructive way.

Tonight there will be a two-fold purpose to the role playing:

1. How do others receive us? How do *they* see our roles?
2. What do we expect of other people? If our major expectation is understanding, to what extent are we being understood?

Understanding, like love, can be a hunger greater than that which we have for food. It can make us shrivel up inside when we don't have it, and glow with vitality when we do have it.

Hopefully, tonight we will glow.

Procedure

Step 1 No leader is necessary tonight. Each person writes down a description of the person they would like to be or to become. If words come with difficulty, one can instead select a character from history or from drama that best types him: Lincoln, Lindbergh, Romeo, Judy Garland, Jacqueline Kennedy Onassis, Florence Nightingale.

Step 2 As soon as someone is ready, he can begin by asking others if they think the qualities or achievement are there. If not, what qualities need to be strengthened, what capacities are totally missing? How do others receive us? How do *they* see our roles? The result is an engagement in deliberate creative conflict. The asker may defend his role as he sees it, or attack the others' points of view. Intense creative conflict can arise from "one-upmanship"—picking fault with others to raise one's own esteem (a trait of drop-outs, overzealous demonstrators or revolutionary types). Each person holds the floor for at least five minutes and then until discussion comes to an end. Then the next person most anxious to explain his role begins.

Step 3 Injured personalities and shaken relationships should be healed over refreshments. Points brought up in an informal discussion might include:

What do we subtly or openly expect of other people?

Do we consider it a right to be understood?

Does everyone want to be understood?

To what extent is this possible? Are we able thoroughly to understand another's experiences?

Do wives expect to "understand" their husbands? Vice versa?

How well do we understand ourselves?

The host of the next session may have to be changed in the interests of acoustical privacy; the group decides at which home the next meeting can best be held so that loud voices will not be a problem to neighbors.

Evening No. 15

"The Venting Voice"

At a recent awareness workshop, a role-playing event had just been completed which had a pronounced cathartic effect. Several participants were noticeably "shook up" but nevertheless quite relieved. One girl, Alice, who was in her early twenties, expressed her feelings quite audibly with a groan of relief. Jim was triggered by the sound of her voice to let go a grunt. Someone said "Wow!" Others began stretching and moaning with relief. Soon the room was filled with spontaneous oohs, aahs and uuhs as feelings were vented.

Anyone who has ever had pain knows that it helps to give vocal vent to it. The pain may not go away when you moan, but there is a type of satisfaction or relief in moaning. Anyone who has ever sung in the shower (where he won't be imposing on society) knows the satisfaction and exhilaration that can come from that type of vocal venting.

A group of women in the western United States make themselves available to various club meetings to teach "toning"—a technique of therapy via the voice. "Miserics," headaches and even more serious ailments have enjoyed alleviation from the singing of long notes or from the up-

lift that comes with raising one's voice from the lowest black tones of agony to the highest silver tones of pure joy.

One of the restrictions which an urban or suburban society places on us is sound-oriented. We are restricted from loud vocal demonstrations for fear of being heard and taken for some kind of nut. Tonight we'll break out of this restriction and enjoy the inspiring power of our own voices. That "silly feeling" should vanish as everybody joins in the fun.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader is chosen and reads the above introduction and these instructions. Everybody stands in the center of the room facing the leader, spaced as if they were about to do calisthenics. The first exercise is a full letting go. The leader demonstrates by permitting himself to bend forward at the hips and flinging his arms downward toward his legs. He does this several times with a loud grunt or groan as he visualizes himself relieved of all worldly burdens. The others join in.

Step 2 After several minutes of this the leader asks for a show of hands by those who feel a sense of relief already. He then picks those who did not raise their hands to begin the next event. It is an even more powerful venting exercise because it goes beyond the letting go of burdens and helps to relieve hidden aggressions and frustrations. Each person selected goes to a stuffed chair, upholstered couch or some carpeted area of the floor. Pillows are also helpful. Each is asked to pound the object while at the same time expressing anger through shouts and screams. The leader should encourage them by circulating and exhorting "Harder, harder!" and "Louder, much louder!"

Step 3 Participants return to the center of the room in the position of Step 1. The leader demonstrates the next exercise which begins by assuming the ending position of Step 1—torso bent at the hips, hands reaching limply for the floor. The lowest possible note is then intoned and as the body is gradually straightened the vocal tone is raised until the body is erect, hands reaching for the sky and the voice singing at its highest and loudest capability. All follow repeatedly.

Step 4 All are seated. A discussion is held on the effects of "toning." However, the whole discussion is sung instead of spoken. Let the singsong effect evolve spontane-

ously—wax operatic, if that is your mood, or merely speak musically. Let rhythm, volume and pitch add a new communicative dimension to what you are saying. If the discussion lags, the speaker should present a new topic that is timely and pertinent, such as “What should we do to get the town to fix those bumps in our road?” or “What diet really works?”

Step 5 With everybody’s “wrinkles” out as a result of venting, it is a perfect time to tune in to the sound of the universe. Mystics throughout the world intone this sound, best spelled by the letters OM. By expressing a long-drawn-out, reverberating O-O-M-M-M-M, we’ll be echoing the “sound” theoretically made by the rotation of the planets and the movement of the galaxies. At least this is the closest that man’s voice can come to creating this hypothetical sound. As proof of its efficacy, nearly everything reverberates to this sound, even the human skin. To demonstrate, the leader or any male with a deep, stentorian voice is asked to face the group as everybody holds his arms outstretched in front of him, palms down. Each concentrates on his palms as the singer intones OM three times. Almost everybody present will “hear” the note with his palms. Now a relaxation session is held with the monologue used in Evening No. 5. Just before ending it, the leader asks all to intone OM three times with him. The session is ended with suggestions of well-being and the count of one, two, three.

Step 6 Refreshments are served and an informal discussion held.

Evening No. 16

“I Touch Me, I Touch You”

Tension is a killer. It can kill us physically by diseases brought on as a result of lowered resistance. It can kill us

psychologically by deadening our awareness and enjoyment of life with anxiety and fear.

Physical contact—touching and slapping ourselves, touching and slapping others—relieves tension. Guilt about sex is the chief reason why touching has become taboo. Yet touching can, of course, be done in a nonsexual context and indeed should be done if we are not to become “out of touch” with each other and ourselves.

The only child in a family is usually deprived of the physical roughhousing that children enjoy. Nature uses play in many of her creatures to develop coordination, understanding and growth. We who are deprived of touch by society’s walls are enshrouded in one more imprisoning layer.

Tonight we’ll try to remove it.

The only touching we adults continue to do seems confined to erogenous zones. These need not be included tonight. We should permit ourselves to be touched anywhere, but the toucher is not seeking to arouse or to be aroused, merely to roughhouse and to break the contact barriers.

This can yield:

The elevation that comes with acting with a new dimension of freedom;

Stimulation of the circulation and the psyche;

Another opening of the doorways into heightened awareness and perception.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is named and the above introduction is read. All take places in the center of the room with the group facing the leader as they would for calisthenics. The leader roughly demonstrates the Samoan Slap Dance by slapping different parts of his anatomy with the flat of his palm, slaps in different places in rapid succession—arm, thigh, belly, buttocks, arm, chest, leg, neck, chest, thigh, back, hand. Both hands are used and the motions accelerate, making loud slapping noises on the bare flesh and on the clothing. He leads the group in this dance in unison.

Step 2 The dance is halted in a minute or two. Each person is then asked to feel his or her own body. Start with the head, neck, and arms; feel the chest, stomach, back, buttocks; run your hands over your thighs, legs, ankles, feet. Now each does the same with the person in front of him. About face, and repeat with that person.

Each person has a chance to be felt and to feel another simultaneously as front and back rows are interchanged.

Step 3 The leader interrupts by calling out: "Anybody feel like tickling anyone else? Go ahead!"

Step 4 When the tickle party has run its course, the leader invites volunteers now to touch with faces. Faces touch faces, hair and hands. Other participants may massage backs, give scalp treatments, "read" palms or lift each other off the floor.

All enjoy the frolic and horseplay in an unhibited climate of sensory awakening.

Step 5 Refreshments. No directed discussion need be scheduled; however, it might be useful to hear from those who wish to offer their personal reactions to the experience.

Step 6 Before leaving, all participants are asked to bring with them next time a game or event of their own making, aimed at breaking down inhibitive barriers, awakening the senses or building stronger self-images. The games can be patterned along the lines of past Evenings, with variations, or they can be totally original.

Evening No. 17

"Dealer's Choice"

Man's effort toward greater awareness and an expanded consciousness is not only motivated by the need for a fuller, more productive and more enjoyable life but also by the need to know what life is, the nature of the universe and the source and purpose of existence.

"One small step for man, one giant step for mankind" was symbolized by his setting foot on the moon, that dry and inhospitable desert which will be impossible for man to master for many years to come. Even then it may never enlighten him as to the cosmic forces which made this planet and the moon. This is not meant to belittle man's spirit of adventure. We who are in this room tonight know only too well how important it is to nurture this spirit.

However, we also know that it must be directed along many fronts. As man is inspired through science to attain new frontiers in space, he may be totally unaware of the nature of the source of that inspiration. New unprobed frontiers lie within his own consciousness. He must push along these frontiers, too, or risk costly delays in the discovery of the very truths he seeks.

Even here there are a number of routes to be taken. During the sixteen Evenings so far experienced, this group has traveled along sensory and extrasensory routes, psychological routes and spiritual or metaphysical routes.

For some, one route has been more interesting than another—or more fruitful, or just plain more fun. Three Evenings from now the group will make a decision as to whether to confine its future Evenings to one of these three general routes or whether to continue to “mix it up.”

Tonight may foreshadow that decision.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is designated to read the above and what follows. Each person should have paper and pencil. Each is instructed to rate the “games” suggested in the following manner:

Games that sound great and which you would like to experience tonight—rate number one;

Games that sound fine and which you would enjoy any time—rate number two;

Games that do not appeal to you but in which you would participate—rate number three;

Games that do not appeal to you and in which you would not participate—rate number four.

Each game can be identified by letter A, B, C, etc. in the order presented. In addition, one person is asked to keep another type of scorepad: to identify each game as basically psychological, sensory or metaphysical. (See page 70 for help in this.)

Step 2 Participants read or describe the game or event they have thought up, and everybody rates them. The leader then prepares a consolidated score by going down the list, starting with A, and adding the individual scores called out around the circle. The games with the lowest scores are selected for tonight in that order.

Step 3 The leader asks for the category of each game and obtains a consolidated score for each category. The preferred category is then announced as indicative of an

initial judgment by the group as to the direction it favors. However, a final decision is not made tonight. (A further analysis may be in order, if the vote is close, to see whether extremes in voting took place—many “1” votes but also many “4” votes. To avoid nonparticipation, the group may wish to make some compromise or adjustments in its eventual decision.) Save these results for Evening No. 20.

Step 4 The games selected are played. The leader hands over his role to each game's creator.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. Discussion is optional.

Evening No. 18

“The Silent Ones”

“Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth.” Many believe that Jesus was referring at least in part to the power of silence in this statement from the Sermon on the Mount.

Silence is a psychic state into which a person can enter. It is not merely the absence of voice—a common misunderstanding. Quiet or lack of sound are necessary conditions but only steps toward the eventual goal. Silence is a condition which can enable practices to be induced that produce psychic power and psychic changes.

Concentration is one of the practices that requires quiet, and that flourishes in silence. Concentration in silence is the focusing of one's entire psychic power and being into a central object of interest, whether inward or outward.

If the object of concentration is the body, then the subject can be the mind—some inner thought or psychic condition.

If the object of concentration is some outer object or symbol, then this becomes an exercise to help train the mind to obey the will of the meditator who is concentrating.

The more we are able to concentrate on anything—inwardly or outwardly—the greater power we gain over it and the more skilled and effective we become.

The following are exercises in concentration which, though they should be practiced regularly at home, are particularly rewarding in a group setting as preparation for “concentration in the silence.”

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is named to read the above introduction and to break the silence at approximately fifteen minute intervals by reading the instructions for the subsequent Steps. The first of tonight's four games for “The Silent Ones” consists of imaging your closest living relative—mother, father, wife, etc.—in your mind's eye. Hold this image as long as possible, making the details stand out. Fit in the color of the eyes, shade of hair, face complexion and other markings on the face. Work on it to make it vivid. See more intently into this image. Can you now discover any particular details or features that you did not notice before? You may. If so, make a note and the next time you are with the person, see if these impressions are correct.

Step 2 Take your watch off and gaze at the second hand, noting the time as you begin. Follow the second hand around its complete circle, never letting your attention be diverted even for one second. Concentrate with all your powers of mind until you find your thoughts are wandering and you cannot get them back under your control. Note the time on paper when this happens, and begin again. See how the time of control lengthens as you approach absolute control over your concentration. (Recently KMPX-FM, a California radio station which often holds ESP experiments, tried to stop the big 76 Union clock in San Francisco at 11:03 A.M. by getting enough people to concentrate the power of their thoughts toward that end. The clock is computerized and powered by an electric substation. At 11:02 A.M. that day the clock jumped from 11:02 to 11:41, then after five seconds it went back to 11:03 and blinked off twice before going on to 11:04.)

Step 3 Read a page from a book in the host's library which is not your taste or style in reading, or else is totally new to you, preferably of essays, poetry, drama, or philosophy. If you are not a scientist, pick a scientific title, etc. Read and reread the page with the determination to fath-

om what it means irrespective of any technical words at which you may have to guess. Never let your attention lapse for even a second. Try to get into the mind of the author. Watch your understanding grow. (Home practice could include any esoteric subject.)

Step 4 Visualize in your mental "TV" the face of a deceased person who was close to you at one time. Picture it about two feet in front of you. Hold this face firmly in mind; don't let it slip away. Study it until your imagination begins to fill in all the details. When you have held the image successfully for two minutes without its coming and going, place your fingertips or thumb tips on your head providing the area of the brain with their vital force. Can you capture any message from that person, either long-since forgotten or never-before received? (Many who practice this "silence" exercise over and over at home have found it possible to communicate telepathically with those who have passed on.)

Step 5 Refreshments are served. The need for practice at home is stressed in a discussion or closing remarks. The physical system is sluggish and unskilled without exercise and practice. So are the mental and spiritual domains of reality. People are rare whose natural gifts win them Oscars or bring them to the Olympics. Behind achievement is long, hard work. The fruits are self-mastery and control over a nonmeasurable energy of infinite strength called psychic power.

Evening No. 19

"Put Awareness to the Test"

Most people are practiced at perception and deduction. They can interpret what they see and hear and then draw conclusions.

However, far fewer people are as practiced at that time-tested shortcut to conclusions known as intuition.

The intuitive answer comes in a flash. There is only a moment to receive it, recognize it and grab hold of it. To be able to take advantage of such a moment we have to expect it. Aware people work with their intuition constantly. Their "antennae" are up for intuitive flashes.

Intuition is not infallible any more than the senses are infallible or human reason is infallible. In fact, because it involves such delicate faculties, it can "conk out" or "goof"—when these faculties are blocked, just as any sensitive machinery is more prone to defect.

Yet, intuition has been responsible for countless successes in, for instance, business, social relations, scientific discoveries and medical diagnoses. Its development by an individual provides him with a magnificent device for extending his intelligence, influence and effectiveness.

What decreases our "electrical resistance" so that we can receive these intuitive flashes? Working with silence as was done in the last session and by some who practice at home is one of the best ways known. It is not enough to gear our consciousness to intuitive events. We must purify ourselves of extraneous "noise"—the impact on our senses of our complicated environment. (The bushmen of Australia are known to have an amazing intuitive sense and can foretell, say, who will be visiting them days in advance; they live in an environment with little clutter and much quiet.)

Other ways to improve our conductivity is to remove fear, anxiety, bias, guilt, remorse, jealousy and other negative emotions from our consciousness. These are often impassible blocks to the intuitive senses.

True intuitive ability begins when these defenses are down, we are attuned to universal energy and we feel a oneness with all life.

Tonight we will enjoy a number of tests of our intuitive progress. Future evenings may well help us to make giant steps forward in this ability.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader is chosen and reads the above introduction. With the host's assistance, a number of objects are placed on a tray in the kitchen (a hairbrush, key chain, shaving mug, scissors, vase, jewelry box, salt cellar, book, perfume bottle, etc.). The tray is covered by a

pillow case or tablecloth so that the objects are totally hidden. Participants then proceed to "discover" what these objects are by sitting quietly and looking at the tray. The leader can require that a written list be submitted or he may invite oral expressions.

Step 2 The leader writes down a number of instances of "emergencies" on separate pieces of paper, e.g., 1) You are traveling in a bus, seated next to a child traveling alone. He is suddenly and violently sick. 2) You are in a church. A mouse peeps out from behind a pew or kneeling hassock and seems likely to come your way. 3) You are just about to serve up a meal for six people, consisting of individual steaks, when your husband arrives with two extra guests. . . . The leader then gives each member of the group, in turn, an "emergency" to read aloud, asking that he immediately describe how he would deal with it.

Step 3 A plain box is used by the leader in this test. He inserts an object in it. It can be anything, contained or uncontained. The group members have to find out what is in the box, working together as a team. Actions such as shaking the box may destroy fragile contents, or turning it upside down might spill liquid, etc., and should be avoided.

Step 4 Volunteers are blindfolded and unusual or uncommon objects are given them for identification. They touch and smell and use intuitive faculties to identify the objects.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. The group then discusses plans for an Awareness Dinner, a unique experience that will also serve to mark the end of this phase in the Awareness Evenings and the choice of the next. To aid in this latter decision, each member is asked to bring to the dinner a list of the three Evenings they enjoyed the most, in the order of preference and identified by the number in this book.

Evening No. 20

“Awareness of Food”

Two women walked into a luncheonette. They each ordered a hamburger and a Coke. When they finished the hamburgers, they lit cigarettes. When the Coke was downed they doused the cigarettes, got up and left.

Did they enjoy their lunch? Chances are they did not even remember eating it, or smoking their cigarettes.

As people grow in consciousness and awareness, they savor their food as they savor *all* of life's experiences. Many become gourmets with a highly sensitive taste for the finest flavors.

The mechanical nature of eating today is due largely to the rush and crush of twentieth-century living. Like shaking hands with your left hand, slowing up a meal can help break down the automaton within us and awaken the senses to the dining experience.

When dining is a group experience and members of the group are friends, new frontiers are present for expanding these friendships simultaneously with culinary awareness.

Tonight the group enjoys its first dinner together. The event, planned at the last meeting, is totally open-ended—no special place, no special menu. If it is in a member's house, though, there will be more privacy.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader or host helps to seat everyone and then calls for a minute of relaxed silence with all holding hands in an unbroken chain. He taps a plate or glass to begin and taps it again to end the meditation. If wine or juice is served, he asks all to take just one sip and to look into the glass to see the patterns and textures in the liquid. Each then shares his glass with a person next to him.

Step 2 The breaking of bread is an ancient custom. The leader asks participants to break bread slowly, to watch

it crack and split apart. Do the same again together with your neighbor; each holds part of a roll, a loaf or a slice and the two pull it gently apart and watch each other eat.

Step 3 When the main course is served, the leader announces that it will be enjoyed in silence. The glass is tapped and there is no conversation until the glass is tapped again. The quiet permits the full taste of the foods to be "felt."

Step 4 During dessert each member feeds another and is in turn fed. Each should become aware of the right time to offer and the right time to receive.

Step 5 Over after-dinner beverages, the leader asks each person to read off his list of favorite Evenings in order of preference. He uses the scorecard below to enter 1, 2 and 3. After all scores are entered he totals the three columns. The lowest score indicates the group's consensus as to which direction it would like to go next—a psychological, sensory or metaphysical one. If the scores are close (that is, less apart numerically than there are members present), the group may want to alternate Evenings between the two preferred directions, or among all three. It may be helpful to compare tonight's results with the preliminary results obtained on Evening No. 17, Step 3. When a decision is made, and before the dinner is adjourned, the leader calls for a final minute of group meditation. The glass is tapped . . . and tapped again.

GROUP PREFERENCE SCORECARD

(Enter total votes for these Evenings)

Psychological (Part II)	Sensory (Part III)	Metaphysical (Part IV)
Evening No. 2 _____	Evening No. 3 _____	Evening No. 5 _____
Evening No. 4 _____	Evening No. 8 _____	Evening No. 9 _____
Evening No. 6 _____	Evening No. 10 _____	Evening No. 13 _____
Evening No. 12 _____	Evening No. 16 _____	Evening No. 18 _____
Evening No. 14 _____	Evening No. 20 _____	Evening No. 19 _____
Total _____	_____	_____

(SPECIAL NOTE: Evenings No. 1, No. 7, No. 11 and No. 15 have been omitted from the vote tally because they overlap two or more categories. Also, Evening No. 17 has been omitted because it varies depending on the group.)

PART II

Psychological Games

INTRODUCTION: A Psychological Approach to Awareness

If we were to divide the mind's vast unconscious areas into two parts, we could call one part the subconscious and the other the superconscious. The former designating the basic, primitive self that controls the functioning of the body, memory and the conditioning that affects our attitudes and our behavior; and the latter designating the part of our mind that appears to tap universal energies that we call creativity, imagination, extrasensory perception, intuition and inspiration.

The part in between the two would be our conscious mind—our faculty for receiving sensory input and for making critical judgments. Of course, it would be difficult to say where one part began and the other ended, because all three do indeed communicate and interact with each other.

This Part of the book deals with the communication and interaction of the subconscious and conscious areas of the mind. It ought to illuminate some hidden recesses and provide some more insight into your personality strengths and weaknesses. It contains programs for twenty Evenings devoted to fun and frolic, the better to know yourself and your fellow man.

Evening No. 1

“Ink Blots”

Psychologists have several favorite techniques for obtaining windows into the personality. Tonight we will all be psychologists. It would be helpful, but not essential, if you could obtain Rorschach cards borrowed from a psychologist and a book on graphology borrowed from the public library.

A study of a person's mannerisms, including how he writes, not only provides *clues* to his personality but *tools* to change it.

For instance, graphologists who see patterns in the handwriting of habitual criminals are successfully changing criminal behavior by changing these handwriting patterns. A man who crosses a “T” with a downward slant, indicating dejection and pessimism can, with practice, acquire the habit of crossing the “T” with an upward slant, indicating hope and optimism. In the process, he affects his own attitude toward life. It sounds like the tail wagging the dog, but it works. What does our handwriting divulge about us? Can we change it?

Gait, posture and diction are some of the other aspects of ourselves that derive a style from our personality and which can be used to alter personality traits. We may not be making those changes tonight, but we will have an opportunity to have those traits reflected to us.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is named to read the above introduction and to conduct the first psychological exercise: word association. Each person is addressed in turn and asked for instant one-word replies to a group of ten words. The words are changed for each person. Here are three sets of examples:

Night	Blanket	Sun
Sister	Food	Wave
Love	Father	Tree
Bread	Glass	Wrinkles
Car	Trip	Baby
Blood	Knife	Chair
School	Cloud	Paper
Water	Television	Kitchen
Book	Blue	Game
Rug	Breath	Fear

The replies are interpreted by the group for each person before going on to the next. What, if any, is the significance of such associations as "night"—"fear"; "sister"—"father"; "love"—"hate"; "bread"—"knife"; "car"—"accident"; "blood"—"me"; "school"—"teacher"; "water"—"drown"; "book"—"shelf"; "rug"—"smother"? It is doubtful whether such fear and negatively ridden reactions will occur in a group such as this, but these are the types of clues that this technique can produce.

Step 2 If Rorschach cards are not available, the leader delegates somebody to spill ink on plain white paper and fold it once, while wet, to cause a shape to be formed. When several of these have dried, each gets a chance to describe what he sees in the design—birds, guts, flowers, animals, genitals, objects, faces are some of the more likely replies. Again, the group offers its comments on the psychological insights these may provide.

Step 3 Some typical handwriting-analysis points are outlined, by the leader, from a book, or by some other knowledgeable person. Paper is provided and a sample of handwriting obtained from each. Identify each sample on the back. The first sample is circulated. Each person analyzes the sample according to typical handwriting characteristics. This is repeated with the other samples. The names of the writers are announced at the end.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Each person comments on the results of the three psychological approaches. Accurate? Contradictory? Enlightening?

Evening No. 2

“Psychoanalyze the World”

At the last meeting each participant played psychologist to the others. Tonight, the group will attempt to psychoanalyze the world.

There is one special major problem. Just as it is very difficult and often impossible to psychoanalyze oneself, so is it equally difficult to analyze a group, a town, a state or any other entity of which any of us are part. And we are part of the world.

To be objective, one has to be able to see nonsubjectively—that is, to step away from one's self and get an outsider's view. We talk of a bird's-eye view, a point of vantage that provides broad scope and wide perspective. It is not the only point of vantage. An ant's-eye view might supply important detail that would be missed from the sky. Similarly, there are different points of vantage in social strata, in levels of wealth, in different races, religions, languages and cultures.

We need practice in seeing the world from different points of vantage. It will take some imagination to get this practice in a living room, but remember that the mind is capable of some very accurate picturing, as we should now experience.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader reads the above and then selects a place familiar to all the members. In New York City this might be Times Square; in Philadelphia, the corner of Broad and Market; in any town, it can be the park, a main intersection, city hall, etc. In turn, each member describes that place from two different viewpoints. He can select

these viewpoints from the following examples or he may create his own: 1) A baby in a carriage; 2) A bird in the sky; 3) A truck driver; 4) A newspaper seller; 5) A policeman on duty; 6) A toddler of two; 7) A puppy; 8) A worm; 9) A housebound invalid; 10) A minister. The object is to get into someone else's world.

Step 2 The leader asks that the group now directs itself to one personality trait of the world today. A suggested trait is revolution because so much of this is going on now. People are revolting against authority, against social custom, against the status quo. First, the leader conducts a relaxation session, then a minute or two of meditation as each member transports his point of vantage to a point from which he can observe a case of militarism or activism or demonstration or revolt. On ending the meditation, comments are solicited. To encourage these to begin, or to get them back into focus later, the following may be helpful:

Are scientists who offer new concepts to replace old "in revolt"?

What about a new religious leader who brings about some revolution in thinking? How does he stack up against the instigator of a sit-in at the public works department to protest wholesale sprayings with DDT?

How widespread is the current push for change? What spheres of human knowledge and experiences are now being subjected to a revolutionary force? Are there any areas of apparent immunity?

Is "revolution" a release of creative energies formerly syphoned off by world-wide wars or by the need to fight nature in order to survive?

Are the areas of most activism characterized by any environmental factors: i.e., cities versus rural areas, Oriental versus Occidental, vegetable and grain eaters versus meat eaters, developed versus so-called undeveloped countries?

How much is "revolution" actually against the idea of nonrevolution and in favor of replacing peace, tranquility and utopia with continuous struggle, effort, rethinking and change?

How much is "revolution" a distaste for order, constitutional instruments and self-government?

What does each member think the attitude of non-revolutionaries vis-à-vis revolutionaries should be—tolerance, hostility, obstructionism or appreciation?

Where do the rights of militant minorities end, and the rights of privacy for the "quiet" majority begin?

Step 3 Refreshments are served. Members are asked to remember a dream they will have, or have had in the past, to write it down and to bring it to the next meeting. Solid books on dreams are also invited.

Evening No. 3

"The Meaning of Dreams"

Many years ago an Englishman found that his dreams were predicting events that made headlines several days later. He began to take his dreams to London newspaper editors who themselves became convinced of this man's precognitive ability while asleep. Accidents, earthquakes, fires and other calamities in this man's dreams became tomorrow's news with startling accuracy. It became natural for him to consider dreams as glimpses into the future. He wrote a book called *Experiment in Time* in which he suggested that the reader write down his dreams, and then keep score to see how many even seeming trivialities actually then occurred in real life. He received many letters confirming his theory that this occurs frequently if one is alert to it.

But many dreamt of being chased and not being able to move their legs quickly. And it never happened. Or of having to climb up a long, gloomy, seemingly endless stairway. And it never happened. Or of being about to be engulfed by a huge wave. And it never happened.

For psychologists and for most of us dreams can be mirrors of the present more often than precursors of coming events.

People who have problems which they refuse to face in their waking hours are often confronted by these problems through dreams. If the symbols in these dreams can be interpreted correctly, they can offer solutions to these problems. Just the facing of the problem, the admission of

its existence by the conscious mind, can yield a cure. Dreams, too, can detect and discover physical disorders not known consciously by the dreamer. And dreams can express inner forces and prompt a change in habits as well as provide creative ideas for a way of life.

Like fairy tales and parables, dreams speak to us in an indirect way. Theirs is a language of symbol and analogy. A car rolling backwards down a hill with the dreamer in it can portray his concern that some matters in his life may regress out of his control. A long corridor that leads only to other long corridors can reflect frustration in one's job or another activity. The small child with whom one has difficulty in a dream can reflect one's own struggle with the personality within.

The language of symbols crosses geographical boundaries and historical eras. Water as the subconscious, darkness as the unknown and fear of height as insecurity are fairly universal, as they are simple in meaning.

The language of dreams can be an easier language to learn than one might think—and one of the most rewarding. As we practice, remembering our dreams becomes easier. As we direct our attention to interpreting them, we discover more about ourselves, the obstacles to our progress and our need for continued and accelerated growth.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader for tonight reads the above introduction, together with excerpts on dream symbology from any substantial book that may have been brought to the session.

Step 2 Each member is asked to describe a dream and to explain what it means to him. Participants comment. Should a dream defy understanding, the leader calls for a relaxation exercise and a minute or so of meditation on the dream. The conversation is then resumed on that dream to see if any further light can be thrown on it. Then the next dream is discussed.

Step 3 Refreshments are served. . . . It will be helpful at the next session if a tape recorder is made available.

Evening No. 4

"The Power of the Spoken Word"

With the gradual dissolving of personality quirks and inhibitions, people who have hidden their best qualities behind shyness and other "protective" devices, blossom forth into fascinating and compelling conversationalists.

They say that more commercial deals are worked out on table cloths over lunch than in offices. Certainly face-to-face conversation is the source of most decisions and actions. The results of good conversation can be: new awareness of personality, the removal of blocks, greater outpourings of creative ideas and enthusiasm, and more success in life.

Have the members of the group improved as conversationalists? Are they better able to draw friends? Hold your attention? Maintain your interest? Radiate their own enthusiasm? Project a winning personality? Get ideas across with conviction?

Despite the assaults on it by radio and television, the art of conversation remains one of the simple attributes in life that can bring us the greatest joy, but the galloping pace of life today seldom provides the opportunity for enjoyable conversation. Tonight an opportunity arrives.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader reads the introduction and asks the group to count off, starting with himself as "1," and going clockwise around the room. These will constitute identifying numbers and will be used to form groups of two. All odd and even numbers pair off in order: 1 with 2, 3 with 4, 5 with 6, 7 with 8, etc. The leader explains that

each group will converse for a ten-minute period on one of the following topics:

The younger generation has been called "the new people." How are they "new"? Will they stay "new"?

How do "religious convictions" and "spiritual beliefs" differ? Does either hold more promise in solving family problems? Community problems? World problems?

Does sex have a place outside of marriage?

The leader appoints an unpaired person (if there are an odd number present) to prepare a scorecard for each member, indicating the subject covered in each conversation, and a rating. This person will also move the tape recorder about to pick up a few minutes of each conversation. If no person is available, the leader delays his own conversation for a minute or two to complete this scorecard and gets the recorder going in one location. The conversations begin. When ten minutes are up each person calls out the subject covered by his group and how he rates his partner: 5—thoroughly absorbing; 3—interesting or meaningful; 1—"small talk," meaningless.

Step 2 All change, with the odd numbers going to the next higher even numbers than their last partners held: 1 with 4, 3 with 6, etc., with the highest odd number going to lowest even number—5 with 2. The new subjects are selected from the same list. Again time is called after ten minutes and scores recorded. Any person left out replaces a volunteer willing to stay out.

Step 3 After all combinations have had their ten-minute conversation, the leader computes final scores. Those who missed a session are given "3," an average for that session. The two best conversationalists are then paired and asked to discuss the event, while others listen. It should be stressed that this Evening is at best a limited, temporary indicator of conversational ability, and that the subject matter and listeners may well have been more stimulating to some than to others.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. The tapes are replayed.

Evening No. 5

"Group Therapy"

Many people today feel the need to open up more to other people, to feel more free in expressing themselves, to "get in touch" more. The means that are open to them are few indeed. Barriers are up everywhere.

These barriers can make people sick—in body or soul. It is ironic that if one winds up in a psychologist's office, he can be placed in a group for therapy where he can more readily open up and express himself.

Group therapy has been a source of controversy ever since its inception some twenty years ago. In such groups, people react to one another, sometimes critically, sometimes supportively, under the supervision of a professional. There they act out their problems, express intimate feelings, exhibit neurotic symptoms, confront other members of the group and release their emotions—often. The end result for many is often a dissolution of neuroses and a greater self-awareness and self-mastery.

Social scientists are finding that groups of people working together on a common problem begin to recognize more fully those differences in human experience which hamper communications and kindle misunderstandings. They find that these differences can be coped with through group work, and that what would ordinarily disintegrate into competition, frustration and even attempts to destroy becomes instead increased communication and cooperation.

Tonight there *will not* be a group therapy session in the true sense. Such sessions should be structured. That is, people in them should be professionally selected as psychologically beneficial for each other. And such sessions should be led by a trained person.

What we *will* have tonight is a group-therapy game—a limited Evening that stops short of the shock treatment

of most encounter groups. It may not be as therapeutic, but it should be fun, and constructive.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is selected. He reads the above introduction and these instructions:

This game places a premium on honesty. A vote by participants determines if a player is "with it" or a "phony." Each player must continue to pick a card and follow the instructions until he is released by a vote of "with it," indicating that he has been honest in the opinion of the others.

Step 2 Cards or slips of paper are prepared with the following written on them separately:

Pick a member of the group you relate to least and explain how it is really your own problem and how you expect to cope with it.

Do a suggestive dance explaining, as you go, just what each movement suggests and whether you think it is morally right or wrong.

Describe your body to the group, explaining which you think are your best features and which are your worst and why.

Confess a failure or a sin. Give details. Explain what you learned by it.

Name a bad habit you have and describe an embarrassing event that occurred as a result of it.

Step 3 After each player has had his or her turn at the cards, refreshments are served. The two players judged by the group as the most honest (they got a vote of "with it" on the first try, or sooner than others) then conduct a discussion in front of the group in which they evaluate the judgment of the group in the various honesty votes taken.

Evening No. 6

"A Look at Hypnotism"

Hypnotism, once the handmaiden of mysticism, is today an accredited medical technique. It is used for anes-

thesia and the easing of tension by dentists, obstetricians and surgeons—and for symptom removal by doctors in many areas of medicine; in orthopedic work, with respiratory and gastro-intestinal ailments, heart conditions, etc.

However, its use is not limited to medicine. Athletes are discovering that hypnotism can improve their golf and bowling scores, increase their skill on tennis and basketball courts, on the football gridiron and on the baseball field. Teachers are discovering that hypnotism can improve their own concentration, and accelerate the learning process of their students. Business executives are discovering that it can aid problem solving and help make fuller use of mental capacities.

Now hypnotism has entered the home. Individuals are discovering that they can become their own hypnotists. Self-hypnotism is a skill that can be learned quickly. In a matter of an hour or two of practice you can learn the technique for accomplishing the two basic steps: self-induction and auto-suggestion.

Once learned, self-hypnotism is useful in getting rid of insomnia, smoking, excessive drinking, and other unwanted habits. Thousands are using it to lose weight and to stay slim without resorting to the willpower required by dieting. Its use to spur enthusiasm, energy and positive attitudes is legend.

In awareness, the greatest values that a knowledge of self-hypnotism has to offer lie in:

Realizing the somewhat computerlike nature of the subconscious and how the conscious mind can be used to program it and reprogram it;

Understanding the dangers and limitations of hypnosis and self-hypnosis;

Utilizing the techniques for removing personality hang-ups and awareness blocks;

Utilizing the techniques for enhancing one's physical appearance and personal self-image, and for improving one's attunement to universal sources of intelligence and energy.

The first to ascribe computerlike characteristics to the subconscious was Dr. Norbert Wiener, a professor at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. He coined the word "cybernetics" to describe the automatic, without-reasoning, functioning of the subconscious. Others consider the subconscious as a spiritual tie to the universe. And there are many other concepts in between.

No matter what view you take of the subconscious, the pressing need for man is to be able to control it. This he began to do consciously long before Wiener; indeed, at least as far back as the late-eighteenth century—when Friedrich Anton Mesmer created a sensation by curing thousands of invalids through the power of “magnetism.” Even Mesmer was not wholly original, and was treading paths made by metaphysicians over the centuries. Today, control of the subconscious is a more scientific procedure, no longer requiring the artifacts and showmanship of yesterday.

Because the subconscious is better understood today, the dangers of dealing with it are also better understood. The services of a professional hypnologist are always more effective than the use of self-hypnosis methods—and safer. However, the self-hypnotist is on safe ground if he observes the classical shake-well-before-using instructions on the label of most household medicines:

If symptoms persist, see your doctor;

Observe prescribed dosages (even too much aspirin can be dangerous);

Follow directions. Use, don't abuse, the power of suggestion.

Earlier in this century, the French psychologist Emile Coué wrote a book on self-mastery through conscious auto-suggestion. He had people everywhere looking into the mirror and repeating over and over, “Day by day in every way I am getting better and better.” For many it worked. For many it did not work. It worked for those who expected it to work. It failed for those who did not believe it could work.

An important factor in the success of tonight's self-hypnosis exercise will depend on the application of “as if it were true.” A person must be sincere. The astounding fact is: it is true. For the moment the image is held in the mind, it works automatically:

A woman no longer has a phobia about closed rooms.

A woman with a spasm in her left shoulder has it moved to a less obvious location—a finger of her left hand.

A man with “hysterical” blindness sees again.

A boy stops stuttering.

An overweight girl who has been eating a quart of ice cream a day now detests it.

A man with chronic fatigue now bubbles with a zest for life.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is chosen. Since he will assist in relaxation monologues and autosuggestion, he will have to catch up with the group by practicing on his own after tonight's session. He reads the above introduction and then conducts a simple susceptibility test as follows: Everybody stands and faces him. He asks them to place their arms out horizontally in front of them, palms down, and to close their eyes. "I want you to visualize me hanging a shopping bag full of groceries over your left wrist. I am doing it now. It is very heavy. You can hardly hold up your left arm. It seems to get heavier and heavier. It is pulling your arm down. Lower and lower. Now open your eyes." The measure of susceptibility to suggestion is the degree to which the left arm was lowered in each case. One to two inches indicates a satisfactory subject. Anything over that indicates an excellent subject. No movement at all is the sign of a poor hypnotic subject. However, many poor subjects become better subjects by improving their visualizing ability, and their acceptance of the "as if" principle.

Step 2 A relaxation exercise is now conducted with everybody back in his chair, sitting comfortably and, at ease. The same monologue is used as in the previous session. The leader reads this monologue, noting that the subjects should be listening subjectively. That is, each one should not let the leader merely lead him in the exercise, but should visualize the ideas mentioned, and be his own hypnotist.

Step 3 After as much relaxation as possible is achieved, the leader reads on:

I now concentrate on my left hand. I see it in my mind's eye with my eyes closed. As I sit fully relaxed and breathing deeply, visualizing my left hand, I feel it move imperceptibly. With each breath I take, my left hand seems to get lighter. I visualize it rising off my lap. I say to myself, With every breath I take, my hand gets lighter and lighter. It rises slowly from my lap toward my face. I know that when it touches my face I will be in a deep state of relaxation. Now my left hand touches my left cheek.

Step 4 Regardless of how many are successful in touching their faces, the leader proceeds with the following:

"I know I can reach this deep state even quicker next time. I am now about to terminate this session. At the end of the count of three my hand will drop to my lap. I will feel wide awake, revitalized and refreshed. One, two, three!"

Step 5 The leader checks out all participants. Anyone who is still sleepy-eyed should be given direct terminating suggestions, with "you" instead of "I," and the count repeated. The reason for this is that the leader may have been the hypnotist rather than the person himself, despite the use of the first person "I."

Step 6 The leader suggests that participants practice this by themselves before the next session. A general recharging suggestion was used tonight. It can be repeated safely in practice sessions. More specific suggestions will be used for individual goals at the next session. Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 7

"A Hypnotic Lift"

A stage hypnotist has seven or eight volunteers in a fairly deep state of hypnosis. He suggests to them that when they wake they will see the audience in a state of undress. He wakes them and the audience rocks with laughter as the men on the stage probably nudge each other and stare, and the women more likely hide their faces in obvious embarrassment.

A psychiatrist is probing, through hypnosis, his 30-year-old patient's subconscious, for a childhood event that may have brought on a certain phobia. "You are now three years old. Where are you?" "At Nanny's," replies the man, in a baby voice, as he relives that age.

A professional golfer is having a problem with his drive. The hypnotist has the pro visualize himself making a perfect drive. "Now repeat the drive in your mind's eye a number of times. A minute of this will allow you an hour of practice." The golfer gets a full day of driving practice in eight minutes.

A veteran actor has trouble memorizing his lines. He is faced with loss of the part if there are any more slips in rehearsal. Under hypnosis, he is told by the hypnotist that by reading the part once it will be indelibly fixed in his memory. It is.

These are some of the mental miracles that are possible through hypnotism. There are also physical miracles. A person is told he is being touched with a hot iron when actually he is touched with a cold coin. He gets a blister. And when the situation is reversed, there is no blister. A woman can be told her body is rigid. She can be placed with her head on one chair and her feet on another, and a man can stand on her midsection without her flinching or being adversely affected. A patient is hemorrhaging in surgery. All efforts fail. The hypnotist is called in. He commands the flow of blood to stop. The patient's subconscious obeys.

Last week we learned the basic technique for obtaining a state of self-hypnosis. Some were able to attain this state fairly readily. Others were not. Still others were able but did not believe it. The state of self-hypnosis is not a sleeping state. You are aware of everything that is going on during it. You remember everything that transpired, unless a hypnotist gives you the suggestion that you will not remember. Some 80 to 90 per cent of all successfully hypnotized people believe that they were really not hypnotized at all.

You will improve your own results from now on if you can accept the fact that you can or did successfully attain a level of self-hypnotism. After all, even a person relaxed in front of a television set is in a mild state of hypnosis. Let the "as if" principle go to work for you tonight.

Here are some other basic principles to remember in order to improve your success:

You must really want the suggestion you give yourself to work.

You must be thoroughly relaxed. Practice a few times a week.

Visualize rather than verbalize. A picture is worth a thousand words here.

Now here are some don'ts:

Don't use suggestion to remove nature's warnings, such as hunger, exhaustion, chronic pain.

Don't use suggestion to cause great change. Go one small step at a time.

Don't use suggestion to attempt the impossible.

Don't use suggestion on medical problems. See your doctor.

Don't eliminate something without substituting something in its place.

A word of explanation about the last point. The body may need the habit you are trying to remove—like nail-biting. Giving it up can produce a substitute habit that might be more harmful—like smoking—unless you substitute something in its place—like gum chewing.

Also, about that small step. Be patient and persistent. Start with just an iota of progress. See how it works. Go on to the next. A young man who was afraid to talk to large groups began by talking to his dog and recording his voice. Then he visualized himself talking to two classmates as he listened to the recording. He gradually increased his audience until he was comfortable with a whole class. He never made the debating team, but never again was he too shy to speak.

Much of the success of many spiritual disciplines is owed to self-hypnosis. The psychology and psychodynamics of self-help and self-improvement are keyed to suggestion. Hypnotism and self-hypnotism certainly help to demonstrate that there are fewer and fewer known limits to human potential.

Procedure

Step 1 Each person stands in front of the group in turn. His or her posture is criticized. Ways to improve it are suggested. The person stands more erect, making whatever changes are suggested. If a full-length mirror is available, he notes his new image. If not, the group supplies this image by describing how he or she looks in this improved posture. In addition, other physical aspects may be discussed. An overweight man may be described by the group as looking slimmer. A flat-chested girl may be described by the group as more curvaceous (many young women have enlarged their bust by one or two inches in a very short time through visualization). Tired stances, middle-age slump and sagging shoulders can be removed in the mirrored descriptions.

Step 2 The group is seated and each person inducts himself into self-hypnosis without the help of a leader. Vivid visualization of the new physical image is enjoyed.

Each sees himself as described. Each ends his own session with an energy-suggesting one, two, three!

Step 3 When all have completed this exercise, individuals who would like to share various goals with the group then describe what they wish to achieve. The group devises a visualization procedure for each that follows the principles given at the previous evening and in tonight's introduction. Alternatives are discussed and the safest and most logical and natural visualization is agreed on. Each person in turn is then free to return to his seat and begin. Some of the types of suggestions that the group members might want to utilize are:

A person's assets are visualized at work, making for social or business success.

A person's skill at a sport or game is visualized, in perfect form, over and over again.

A person is at the crossroads re alcohol. Down the left-hand road lies trouble. Down the right-hand road of moderation lies happiness. He visualizes himself taking the right-hand road.

A person wants to give up smoking. He uses the above visualized suggestion, or he imagines, say, every cigarette tasting like burnt rubber and each pack crawling with lice.

A person seeks spiritual uplifting. He visualizes himself radiant with joy.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Members discuss their experiences. Those who are more successful offer help to others. . . . Participants are asked to tear out interesting or colorful pictures from magazines and bring as many as they can to the next meeting.

Evening No. 8

"A Fantasy in Color"

During the past two Evenings we have learned to open the doors to our somewhat computerlike subconscious and

to reprogram it by auto-suggestion. The subconscious is programmed automatically by daily experiences. Many of these are long-since consciously forgotten but still lie deep in the subconscious, affecting our lives today. Often, by merely exposing these mental anachronisms to the reasoning, sensible light of our conscious evaluation (if they're negative) they dissolve.

A hypnotist can probe the subconscious by regressing the subject and getting a "replay." This is dangerous business and must not be attempted by amateurs. Traumatic experiences and hidden psychoses spell trouble—which only a professional psychologist is trained to cope with through hypnosis or other means.

There *are* other methods of probing the subconscious that are relatively safe. Psychiatrists and psychoanalysts use fantasy and free association quite frequently in therapy. These involve a change in direction of usual thought currents. Instead of outside stimuli affecting our thoughts, we permit these thoughts to flow from an inner direction—from the inside out.

This is not easy; most of us need an outside stimulus to get us started. This will be supplied by the magazine pictures that have been clipped and brought in by members tonight.

Fantasy, which we will attempt now, speaks in the picture-and-symbol language of fairy tales and dreams. The subject who has a fantasy can often interpret this message from the subconscious. The message can start a reasoning process which in turn can dissolve a problem which the subconscious has dredged up.

Sometimes, however, interpretation is difficult and assistance is needed. Even so, a full interpretation may not suffice to get anything going in the nature of a change or of therapy. Analysis of the interpretation is often required.

There have been unexplained instances wherein, without interpretation and analysis, therapy has taken place. One man, for instance, who had a fantasy about the cause of his stomach pains, obtained permanent relief. His fantasy was one of getting inside his stomach to "look around."

A fantasy can be a directed daydream. This needs to be given a starting point and a direction in which to go. In the case of the man just mentioned, his stomach pains were the starting point and imagining himself small enough

to get inside himself was the direction the fantasy was asked to go.

What should each individual declare as a starting point? A matter of health? A hang-up? A habit? A business problem? A problem in interpersonal relationships? Some personality problem? An attitude?

Tonight's exercise will be a preliminary to the main event. It will help us through a type of conscious-subconscious fantasy to find a starting point for the next Evening.

Procedure

Step 1 The selected leader reads the introduction. He asks everybody who brought magazine clippings to place them in a pile at one side of the room. Three volunteers are each asked to create a "montage," or composite piece of art, by sifting through the clippings, selecting what appeals to each and placing the choices in an appropriate position on his or her spot on the floor.

Step 2 When these three floor "murals" are completed, the group is asked to compare the results. Is one gloomier or brighter than the others? Are there people in one and not in the other? More men than women? Perhaps a particular person? Each of the three artists are then asked to comment on their own montage and on the comments of the group. What significance or insight might the montage offer?

Step 3 The other members of the group complete the same procedure in threes or pairs.

Step 4 The clippings are returned to a single pile. Each member is asked to supply himself with pencil and paper, to select a single clipping, and to write about 50 words—no more than 100—on why he chose that clipping and to what it may relate in his life. The paper is identified by name on the reverse side.

Step 5 The leader collects the papers, with the clippings attached, and redistributes them, checking the reverse sides to make sure he is not returning any to the originator. He keeps the last paper for himself *without* noting the identity. Each person then reads the paper assigned to him, exhibits the clipping that inspired it and comments on any insight into a problem, hang-up or personality matter to which it might point, directly or by inference. Before going on to the next paper, the group comments on these ideas and offers further ideas. Only after this is completed, does the

originator identify himself or herself in each case and accept or reject the inferences or the drift of the analysis.

Step 6 The leader returns the material to the originators and requests each to bring back his clipping next time or else to substitute another clipping that is found in the interim and which appears to have special meaning for him. Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 9

“ ‘Real’ Fantasy”

When problems are acted out, solutions often appear. At the last meeting, fantasy was used to detect problems; tonight, fantasy will be used to try to find solutions.

Because some people harbor deep emotions and because this fantasy technique can often reach the most hidden recesses of our mind, a skillful leader is required. Tonight's leader will be elected by the group for his past record of honesty, skillful handling of difficult moments and personal awareness.

It will be the leader's responsibility to help conduct each fantasy exercise, and to end it at any time when there are tears or other evidence of emotions going out of control. Hopefully, because only relatively superficial methods have been used to select problems, no such instances will occur. If they do, the leader will stop them by diplomatically “ringing down the curtain”—ending the fantasy with words of praise for the performance. The participants will co-operate by applauding and lending a helping hand to the person by rising, offering a hug, a pat on the shoulder or a word of praise.

Participants are advised not to take part in these fantasies if they have any record of emotional illness, disturbance or acute discomfort in the past.

There are a number of directions that a fantasy may take once its starting point—the problem—has been de-

terminated. Certain directions lend themselves better to certain types of problems than to others.

For instance, a problem related to another person might call for a fantasy in which a trip to the zoo is imagined and an activity is shared with an animal there. Or the subject may be instructed to make himself very small—as small as a grain of dust—and enter the other person in some way to look around.

Other types of directions that the leader may offer subjects include: imagining themselves five or ten years old, in bed after the lights go out; imagining themselves in a maze, trying to get out; imagining themselves lost in a crowd and trying to find someone they know.

Once the “starting point” problem and “type of fantasy” direction have been established, the leader must continue to lead. He must listen carefully and ask continuing questions. “What does he reply? [The person in the fantasy.]” “What happens next?” “What do you see?” “Where do you go now?” “Is anybody with you?” “What is the book about?” “How do you feel about that?” “Do you walk or run?” “Describe it in more detail.”

These are all intended to assist the fantasy to unfold and to take it along a path that may have significance.

The leader should also be ready to lead each person gently out of the fantasy in the same way he or she entered: “It is getting late and time to go home,” or “We must leave now and return to our friends; perhaps you can come back here again some time.” These are, of course, offered only in case the subject does not voluntarily end a fantasy in a reasonable time—five to ten minutes.

The cautions have been stressed just in case of a chance upset. But actually this is a game. It is a game that can be loads of fun for all, whether participants or spectators. And it can be a valuable tool to increase self-knowledge.

Procedure

Step 1 The host reads the introduction to the group. A leader is elected.

Step 2 The leader asks if anyone has identified a personal matter as a result of the last meeting. A volunteer is solicited from those who indicate that they have. He or she states the nature of the problem and produces the clipping that aided him in the last exercise, providing it is still pertinent. The subject is instructed to lie down on the

floor in the center of the room. A pillow is supplied for comfort. The leader pulls up a chair nearby. If the clipping lends itself to such a technique, the leader suggests that the subject "enter" the picture and describe what is going on. If this is now not appropriate to the problem, the leader asks that the fantasy begin in some other way, inspired either by the instructions above or by the nature of the problem. If in doubt, he should ask for a minute of silence and use this to have a fantasy himself as follows: he imagines that he is the subject on the floor and begins to let his fantasy range. In what direction does he go? At the end of the leader's interruption, he proceeds to direct the subject accordingly.

Step 3 At the conclusion of the first attempt, the group comments on what transpired. Is the "language" of the fantasy clear? Is there a clear-cut moral to it? What does it teach? What clues does it provide?

Step 4 The next volunteer assumes the prone position and the exercise is repeated until all who wish to have participated.

Step 5 Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 10

"Spotlight on Quirks"

Tonight's get-together begins with a rather esoteric reading. It has a triple purpose. First, to permit the authors to "get into the act" and get across what they consider some basic approaches to awareness. Second, to encourage an open-ended discussion on the progress of the group and the relative benefits of recent techniques. Third, to permit this discussion to act as a vehicle for an exercise in awareness: specifically, to recognize and spotlight habit quirks and nervous mannerisms in each other and in ourselves and thus help to get rid of them.

It is often difficult for us to see our own quirks, but they are seen and often objected to by others. One com-

pany executive would inject the word "alright?" at every comma and period in his conversation. He never realized that he was doing this until a drunken colleague mimicked him at an office party. In a few weeks he was out of the habit. Many of us repeat ourselves without being aware of it.

It would be helpful at this exercise to have funny noisemakers—the kinds they use New Year's Eve. The group sounds off with one or more of these every time a person in the discussion says "um," "you know," "and" (if too often) or pulls on his nose, brushes back his hair or exhibits any other repetitive pattern of behavior that is more a nervous mannerism than anything else. In the absence of noisemakers, a bicycle horn, a bell, a knock on the chair, a whistle or any funny disruptive noise will do.

All of this has to be accepted in the spirit of fun by the person using repetitive mannerisms.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is appointed. He reads the introduction and then continues by reading the following passage:

There is something about group action, group awareness, which nourishes "togetherness," if you will. At the root of this nourishment is the ability in each of us to see the best in others, and the ability to use the worst as an opportunity to look into ourselves—to see if we have the same defects.

So, at first, the goal of the group is to prosper in being together; that is, to study this spirit and to prosper both as individuals and as a group. We invoke this spirit of unity so that we won't fight as individuals over one another's defects. In all close relationships people know each other's defects.

It is important not to play on each other's faults, because these faults can be infinite in both parties. Instead, we should aim at reaching that high potential—overlooking defects. The body itself is a defect, since the best teacher of all is that which has no body and is resident in us as the master within, consciousness itself, the I AM within us. The body teaches very little. A great man is one who studies instructions for obtaining peace of mind and who becomes aware of the facts about others, not the faults of others. A sure sign of insecurity and immaturity in a man is when his entire education is geared to finding fault with others for the purpose of elbowing his way around society more effectively, arguing and involving himself in verbal

battles with others. His great purpose in life appears to be to destroy others. One-upmanship is his "bag."

Whereas the whole power and force of an evil man is to destroy others, the virtuous man devotes the fruits of his education to serving others. In the lives of the saints of history, it is obvious that all their physical energies were devoted to serving others.

The field of investigation in which we are engaged tonight emphasizes faults. But we'll do it in a lighthearted way, secure in our established communion.

The physical body is much more than just a lump of protoplasm. It is a marvelous network of antennae, systems—sympathetic systems, cardio-vascular systems—all kinds of systems operating as organs and making a greater whole governed by an indwelling intelligence. We should understand how this intelligence manifests itself through the physical systems in the body. In this game, we understand that we cannot look directly at consciousness, but we can look at its effects as it operates through these systems. Study of these organs could lead to the possible development of potential organs which are not as yet in use by man—organs of perception and sensitivity. We'll be helping nature then, possibly, to develop instruments in the brain, instruments of increased sensitivity. Nature has been doing this since the time of the amoeba, the first sensitive protoplasm which developed this sensitivity to respond to our environment. So we, as a complex group of systems of organisms, have still to develop an awareness that there is yet another means of knowing and sensitizing ourselves as physical organisms to what is happening in the universe.

We have to understand that the observer in all cases, whether he looks through a telescope, a microscope or some future organ of perception, is the same observer. The instruments have changed, but the see-er is the same: one who observes and looks. Though we may change the instruments—and our bodies as instruments are changing every second, our organs are changing every second—and though we may change these organs through which we sense the universe, these narrow slits called the senses, we ourselves, by means of our indwelling consciousness, go on and on.

One organ—that of speech—is the most abused organ. This is unfortunate because the voice imprint, the vibration of the human voice, reflects the vibration of the whole body. Through detecting what is in its voice, we may enter an organism and understand it, for it is the representative of the being.

Energy always accompanies speech. Hearing follows

speech, and, just as our voice reflects the vibrations of our personality, so does the universe vibrate totally, throughout its homogeneous vibrations; the sum of all vibrations together dictate its personality—the whole being. Everything in the universe may be a manifestation of this consciousness which is behind the vibrations. Our own consciousness is behind our vibrations. Therefore this investigation of the voice and of the mannerisms of the nervous system is the study of the life force, that life force in us which gives us consciousness. This is the life force which constitutes our very personalities and the creative processes which operate through all our organs. This study, this game, should help us begin to observe the life force in others.

Step 2 The leader sees that all are supplied with noise-makers—natural, manufactured or improvised. He then invites a discussion on what was just read, asking specific questions of participants, if needed, to get things going. Awkward mannerisms and speech defects get the noise treatment from whoever notices them. Others may join in if they agree.

Step 3 Refreshments are served as the discussion and noise signals continue.

Evening No. 11

“This I Seek for Myself”

The first Evening outlined in this book was entitled “This I Believe” and involved the expression of personal philosophies. Many people have discovered their personal philosophies for the first time at such Evenings.

Tonight some may discover their personal goals for the first time. Others may find out that the thing they are hoping for and driving themselves toward is, perhaps, an illusion through which happiness will not really come, and

that their friends may possess higher or better goals which they, too, might consider.

This introduction is divided into two parts so that the initial step of this Evening's experience can be accomplished before the balance of the discourse. In this step, all participants are asked to write down their personal goals in the order of importance to them. The basic question for each to ask himself is: What will bring me happiness?

For instance, of first importance might be money or position, family wellbeing, travel or a change of property or home. Some may seek marriage, children, new friends, love, sexual experiences or pleasure. Others may look for athletic prowess, health, power, new careers, social status or job promotions. Everybody has a goal. Even the suicide has a goal—to escape from unhappiness. Many of us never stop to think what our goals really are. Tonight these goals come into focus.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader for tonight reads the above introduction but does not read its continuation below until Step 1 and Step 2 are completed. He sees that all are equipped with writing materials and asks that each write down his goal, or goals, in life, in order of priority.

Step 2 The leader asks each in turn to read his goals and to elaborate on them if he wishes. At the completion of this, a discussion ensues on whether these are really the deepest goals within each, or whether they are really only superficial goals on the way to something else. Whose goals appear to be the deepest? The leader allows the discussion to continue until it has been thorough and then goes on with this second part to the introduction:

We all possess innate drives—instinctive forces which impel us toward more complete expression of our potentialities. The bank robber is responding to a drive for money as his path to fulfillment. He thinks, albeit in a misguided way, that obtaining lots of money without working for it will make him happier. If it is at other people's expense, or if he has to knock somebody over the head in the process, this does not worry him because he is not concerned with anyone else's happiness. It is not a matter of his happiness coming first. There is nobody else in the running.

The force that drives us toward our goals—love objects such as money, people or whatever we want—is

so powerful that it moves us in spite of ourselves. It can move us over other people, over the laws of society, over even the more eternal laws of the universe.

When the goal is superficial or short lived, it's little wonder that we often look back and say, "Was this trip really necessary?" We feel let down. On the other hand, when a personal goal is idealistic or directed toward a long range, valid purpose, every step in its accomplishment can become a joyous, gratifying event.

In nature we see goals, too. In biology there are what are called organizers in each cell which assist it in reaching its ultimate structure. In the DNA molecule there is a kind of stop-go punctuation which steers the molecular chain toward a synthesis of all of its constituent chemicals. In every organism in nature, the growth and development of these immature biological structures is regulated toward an ultimate end which can be described as part of the goal of the universe.

Man is not immune from this force. He, too, has a cosmic impulse that seeks growth and development, integrated with these other natural forces. He may misinterpret it, misdirect it, misuse it and misunderstand it. Or he may recognize it and use his superior consciousness to aid nature in assuring its realization and fulfillment.

There is no escape from this force. We can turn on the radio as loud as our ears can stand it. We can drink ourselves blind. We can eat ourselves sick. We can bury ourselves in work or lose ourselves in pleasure. It doesn't matter. The force is still there, moving us along with all other living things in an integrated and integrating universe. It does not depend on what type of man, whether he is a Pygmy in Africa, a cultural revolutionist in China, an American in an affluent society or a British traditionalist—this ultimate goal is all-pervading in nature.

Of course, men vary in intelligence. They vary in physique and outlook and philosophy; but their goals need not exceed their individual capacities. Sometimes they can exceed their physical endowments; a man with a diseased leg could try to win a race, someone who doesn't have a good voice could try to get into the opera, someone without much muscular development could try to carry a heavy sack, or someone with a finely tuned brain could try to do a job which should be given to someone with brawn.

When this happens, of course, you have conflicts and you have failure, and, eventually, a point of arrest. A point of arrest is one wherein a person cannot go any further with his natural abilities or endowments. It can

be compared to a stagnation point in evolution. The next step must be a breakthrough in capacities and endowments, or there must be a reevaluation of the goal.

Not only human beings, but all living organisms will extract nutrients and vital forces from the world around them, according to their goals. And if these goals are limited, so will their relationships and inner wholeness be limited within this vast mass of varied processes, energies and inputs in the surrounding environment and the universe around us. We extract what we need according to the goal which we entertain.

Actually the goal of man might well be the happiness that comes with the realization of his full potential by his mature integration with the world and universe which surrounds him. This goal could well determine how he makes immediate decisions and how he works with others. Obviously he cannot achieve self-realization when he's out of tune or out of sympathy with the needs for self-realization in others. If every whim could be gratified when it clashed with existing social or group needs, then we would have chaos, not harmonious integration. The understanding of our own goals comes with the understanding of the goals of others and with an intuitive feeling for the universal goals of nature.

Step 3 The leader now asks, "What are our real goals? What lies behind the goals we have written down?" He directs the group into a relaxation exercise in which there will be one minute of "listening" meditation. At the end of this minute, he will end the session with the count of three, giving suggestions for well-being, and then again ask for each to write down a goal, on the other side of the paper.

Step 4 Each reads his goal. Refreshments are served. Discussion. . . . Needed next time: a Bible or other book of ancient wisdom; sketching paper for everyone, charcoal or sketching pencils and one good-sized lump of modeling clay or plasticine.

Evening No. 12

"I Understand You"

Nobody has ever estimated the number of words that are communicated orally or in writing throughout the world in a single day. Certainly an average of thousands of words are spoken, written, heard or read by most, and when you multiply that figure by a few billion people, you begin to get an idea.

You also begin to get an idea of how many are aborted—that is, how many get launched but are never correctly interpreted or understood, and are therefore lost.

The art of communication improves with the awareness one has of the "language" of other people. If we talk to a child in adult fashion, we may not "come through." If we talk to an adult as we would to a child we may "turn him off": the net result is the same—we just don't "come through."

Personality differences shape the nature of our attempts at communicating. There was a businessman who stopped to ask a farmer directions to a small village. When the farmer hesitated, the never-waste-a-minute driver tried to hurry things along: "What direction is it and how far do I go?" The farmer paused and then replied, "You just can't get there from here."

We all have a tolerance level for communication. We can absorb just so much per unit of time, and then we permit the rest to "overflow" or get by us. We all have our source preferences and our media preferences. Make a speech on a street corner in Manhattan and there'll usually be an audience. Make one to your family and the chances may be that they'll show you in no uncertain terms that they prefer the record player or television.

Tonight we will witness some of the difficulties experienced in communicating and being communicated with. Hopefully, we will increase our ability to communi-

cate, not necessarily through improved enunciation, pronunciation or vocabulary but by understanding psychologically what is inside people. A person can "hear" only that which he can relate to what is already within his experience. Sometimes that experience causes him to be too sensitive to hear the words, or sometimes that experience can cause blind spots. How well you are attuned to the factors at the other end of this communications line will determine whether you get back "I understand you" or "I don't understand you."

Procedure

Step 1 A leader reads the above introduction and then reads a passage from the Bible or another book of wisdom or philosophy. He asks for a volunteer to state what that passage means to him. Next, he asks whether it means exactly the same to everyone else. Others describe what differences they see in it. Several other passages are read to obtain these different reactions. A sample passage might be this statement by Edgar Cayce: "Individuals who draw solely, wholly upon the Creative Forces within themselves may change their own surroundings and the very vibrations within their bodies."

Step 2 All are asked to draw in privacy a simple sketch on their sheet of drawing paper. It can be a geometrical figure, a symbol, a still life, a person's face or form. Time limit—three minutes. No other instructions are given.

Step 3 Each person places what he has drawn face down at his feet. The leader asks the first person to select the member with whom he thinks he can best communicate—one who was not seated adjacently so that he could glimpse his drawing. The object is to have the recipient draw a replica of the first person's drawing under his verbal instructions. Time limit—five minutes. The results are then compared. The procedure is repeated for as many as time permits, allowing fifteen minutes for one more step prior to refreshments.

Step 4 The group then judges which communicator and receiver have come the closest in their original and replica. These two then change roles. The former communicator leaves the room. The former receiver is given half the lump of clay or plasticine and proceeds to model a symbol or shape at the direction of the group—following the first direction he hears, and then indicating when he is ready for the next direction. At the end of five minutes

of sculpturing, the result is covered by a cloth and the second person invited back. He is given the rest of the modeling material and is instructed solely by the first sculptor. At the end of seven minutes the results are compared.

Step 5 Refreshments and discussion. . . . *Important:* Someone is assigned to bring seven brightly colored swatches, either of paper or cloth, to the next Evening: in red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo and violet.

Evening No. 13

“Color, and Human Drives”

Color affects our lives every day. People live by color in their choice of food, clothes and furnishings. Most choices that are based on color are made unconsciously. A man does not stop to think what effect a red tomato will have on him; nor does a woman pause to reflect on the personality factors behind why she has selected a blue gown.

The way we relate to time and space appears to be closely aligned with the way we relate to color. Man is sensitized to sound, light and radio frequencies in ways that he cannot yet explain. He can be comfortable in surroundings dominated by one frequency of light and uncomfortable in another. It is somewhat like the time distortion that makes boring activities seem to take forever and happy, fulfilling ones take no time at all.

Color has been used, not extensively but nevertheless successfully, in therapy. Only recently was official medical notice taken of the curative effects of color when, quite accidentally, it was discovered in one American hospital that babies with an “incurable” blood condition

showed marked improvements when exposed to a yellow light.

Tonight, with the help of color, we will discover more about our natural drives. There is no magic to it and there are no absolutes. However, it affords one more doorway that man can unlock in his search for knowledge of self, so that he may consciously accelerate his own evolution toward becoming a more perfected entity in the universal order.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader is chosen. He reads the above introduction. The seven color swatches, brought pursuant to the instructions at the close of the last Evening, are pasted or taped on a doorway or wall. Each person walks up to the colors and determines which attracts him the most, and which moves him the least or even repels him. He writes these down, using the names red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo or violet, and returns to his seat.

Step 2 The leader reads the following description of the psychological significance of red:

Red is a stimulating and exciting color. It can increase muscular tension, even stimulate higher blood pressure and respiration rate. It is the color of vitality and action. It signifies the sex drive. Among the less mature it stimulates lust, hatred and anger. A person who is oriented to the red band of the spectrum is oriented to *now*. He has little awareness of the past or the future. His inner world depends on outer-world stimulation—on his sensory input from minute to minute, hour to hour. He is aggressive. If he lacks opportunity to express this quality in business or love making, he will find another way, such as eating aggressively or participating in physical sport. He wants to influence his environment and is accustomed to quick action.

The leader then asks if, in the opinion of the others, the description applies to anyone in the group. If anyone receives one or more "votes" for this color, he notes the number of such votes on his paper. If he "votes" for someone else, he notes this, too, by name and color.

Step 3 The leader reads the following on orange:

Orange is warm and invigorating. It vibrates with vitality and strength. It reflects a human personality which craves social contact, social acceptance and security in group protection. It stands for the herd instinct. Advertisers try to appeal to these people "to keep up with the Joneses." Their drive is one of ambition or

exploration. This is directed for the whole community, as much as if not more than, for self. People who favor orange are extroverts with gregarious feelings. A person of this persuasion will not react as surely as one of the red persuasion to immediate stimuli, but will react when those stimuli are presented in terms of a wider community, and when he sees ways in which his action can affect others and achieve success. His main objective is usually to widen his areas of experience and to shake off inhibitions and self-doubt.

The leader again asks for "votes." Records are again made by the voters and the voted for.

Step 4 The leader reads the following on yellow:

Yellow is cheerful and bright. It radiates enlightenment, intuition, intelligence and wisdom. When mixed with other pigments it tends toward olive and signifies cowardice and deceitfulness. Yellow stands for change—a movement from social contact toward thinking. The person orientated to yellow finds himself to be a member of the intelligentsia, often paralyzed from action by a need to examine all related principles. He would be likely to vote to table a matter for further study rather than make a decision. Yet his drive is for change. He loves newness, novelty, self-expression, intellectual freedom, travel and human rights.

"Votes" are taken and records made.

Step 5 The following is read on green:

Green is nature's color—cool, refreshing and rejuvenating. It neither excites nor subdues and so affords a tranquil, natural, compatible environment. Green symbolizes material possessions and wealth. In its impure shades it can denote selfishness or jealousy. It stands for a drive toward possessiveness—to possess what is loved. This is the drive that the prophet speaks of when he describes the difficulty of the rich man in rejecting possessions in order to receive the treasure of the kingdom of reality. Green reflects a need for self-security and self-confirmation. This can lead to hoarding, or to the accumulation of knowledge for its own sake. Still, green is the color that denotes power, an increase in appetite and a reinforcement of other temperaments and traits. Without it there could be no action, no movement, no life.

Votes. Records.

Step 6 Blue:

Blue is a spiritual color. It is associated with sky and water. It provides a cool feeling and invites peaceful meditation. In its purest form it symbolizes thoughtfulness, deliberation and creativity. Impure, it becomes

cold, indifferent, and suggests the "blues." It connotes a drive toward authority—something higher—in the family, in science, in religion. A person drawn to blue hopes to find contentment, he will often tolerate a bully or a dictator in the interests of peace and quiet. He can be uncomfortable when faced with new or strange facts not yet accepted by existing authorities. Blue is the color of the conservative whose drive for satisfaction in any endeavor can be seriously hampered by the absence of historical precedent. Although an idealist, and in search of the realization of human potential and spiritual unfoldment, he can find the "mind" to be a stumbling block.

Votes. Records.

Step 7 Indigo:

This deeper blue recedes before our eyes, leading us into the more mysterious areas of sensitivity and intuition. This indeed is what it stands for. People drawn to indigo would like to see the brain govern the movements of particles in every nerve and fiber of the body so that they would resonate with universal intelligence. People living in the past or the now have difficulty understanding the man who prefers indigo because he interprets the present in terms of the future. Nothing is important to him unless it has a relation to what will happen five minutes or five days or more from now. He is often late and his schedules are unreliable. As do those in the East, he relates to the world through spiritual rather than doctrinal persuasions. He has long range goals and visions but often lacks the patience to acquire the skills needed to manifest them.

Votes. Records.

Step 8 Violet:

Once reserved for royalty, violet is elevating and bespeaks human dignity. It is a high frequency vibration which in its purest form can point to eternal mysteries and the occult; in its lower form, to melancholy and martyrdom. The drive of those drawn to it is toward an enduring order, brought out of chaos by imagination and will. The man who likes violet seeks to use his power of imaging to condition himself rather than permit himself to be conditioned by his environment. He seeks to understand his will and his consciousness so that he can use his powers to work with nature in order to transform life. He is the poet, the musician and the visionary who sometimes suffers because he is ahead of his time. Because of his need for a hazardless security in absolute order, he senses that he may be unloved by his community. Since this absolute security

is impossible in temporal life, he turns inward for it, finding it in his knowledge of what is absolute.

Votes, records.

Step 9 The leader asks for those who favored red to stand and indicate how many had "voted" this color for him. Then the leader proceeds down the other six colors. All present check off their correct "hits" in their own "voting." Each is then asked in turn to state his number of correct "hits."

Step 10 Refreshments are served. Each person announces his first-choice color again, and the color that least attracted him or even repelled him. The group discusses the significance of the combination. Are there any obvious relationships between the goals expressed in Evening 11, Part II, and these color drives?

Evening No. 14

"Breaking the Ice"

A person with increased awareness is a person who understands people better than he once did. He is more secure in his relationships with people and eager to expand his circle of acquaintances and his experiences.

Yet a curtain remains drawn—drawn not by him but by others who have less knowledge of people and who are prompted by fear, suspicion and distrust to maintain a discreet distance from everybody, especially strangers.

The sex motive, more frequently than any other, is thought to cause both men and women to attempt to reach across these personal barriers. From the friendly pinch in Rome to the whistled wolf-call in New York, barriers are considered to be traversed by physical attraction. As a result, anybody who tries to meet someone else or to talk to a stranger is often immediately judged to be motivated by sex. The result is that people don't try, and, with few exceptions around the world, people are

cold to each other and distant—and lonely and deprived and frustrated.

Given something in common, people often lower barriers. People at a parade or spectators at a football game or at a fire talk to each other. Motives are no longer suspect. Sometimes they even talk to each other in an elevator or on an airplane or poolside. Here, proximity forces barriers to melt.

What do you do to get acquainted with a person you would like to meet? How do you break the ice?

Usually you have to find—or create—something in common. An example of the something-shared approach is the classical question, “Do you know ——?” “Haven’t I seen you somewhere before?” A couple on the beach provided an example of creating proximity when they kept moving up to another couple as the tide came in until they were close enough to use the topic of the incoming tide to “break the ice.”

Tonight we will practice “breaking the ice” among ourselves by role playing. Then we’ll have some fun putting what we’ve learned to the test via the telephone.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader reads the above, then selects two volunteers. Sometimes these are two males, then two females, then mixed. The leader can help initially by setting the scene: You are both waiting in line at a supermarket check-out counter; she is sitting on a park bench as you approach; you are both waiting for a traffic light to change—etc. One volunteer is to try to start a conversation going. The other is to be cold and resistant. The starter remains persistent until the cooler person laughs or in some other way warms up. Participants comment on the performance. “I might have said this.” “Mightn’t you have brought up that?” etc.

Step 2 Volunteers then test their skill on the telephone. People should be selected for the calls who are known to someone in the group. However, the one who knows the person does not make the call. The object of the call is to win confidence and a reciprocal desire on the part of the outside person to continue the conversation. A timer should be appointed to time the conversation with a minimum of perhaps two to three minutes set. However, the important criterion is not length of conversation so much as a “warming” up of the other person. Since anonymous

calls are frowned on by the law and telephone companies, the person calling should introduce himself first by name and address. Other factors that can be brought into the conversation quickly are:

I live in your neighborhood.

I am with a group of people some of whom you probably know [no identities yet].

Our interest is to expand awareness and self-knowledge.

Here is what we are doing tonight—etc.

The mutual acquaintance is not identified until consent is given. There is a discussion and critique before the next call in each case.

Step 3 Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 15

“Personality Recognition”

How well known are we to each other? Most of us have spent some 34 evenings together with our antennae up and our guards down. How much have we garnered about the others' goals, drives, personality facets, attributes and potentialities?

Tonight we will find out what progress we have made in getting inside others, and, in the process have some fun.

Procedure

Step 1 Names of all participants are placed in a hat by tonight's leader. Each then draws a name from the hat (if he draws his own, he puts it back and draws again). Each keeps the name drawn a secret. Paper and pencils are supplied to all.

Step 2 The leader asks that a minute or two of quiet meditation be held during which each person attempts to think of all he can about the person whose name he has

chosen. The leader relaxes the group; he starts and then ends meditation.

Step 3 Each participant writes down a personality evaluation of the person chosen. What are his or her good points and bad points, apparent drives and goals, and chances of fulfilling them. Write about 100 to 200 words. See the sample below, following Step 6.

Step 4 The leader starts by reading what he has written, without divulging the person he has written about. The words "this person" are used rather than "he" or "she." No identifying events are mentioned. "This person" is designated as #1. When the leader is finished, all in turn state who they think it is and write this down on their sheets. The next person reads about #2, and so forth until all have read their descriptions and, in the process, been described anonymously.

Step 5 The leader divulges who #1 is and counts the right votes. The next in line divulges who #2 is, etc., until all have been identified.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. A discussion afterwards reviews which descriptions drew the fewest correct guesses and which the most correct guesses. . . . At the next session a copy of the *I Ching* is needed. If one is not available from participants, it can usually be gotten from a local library or bookstore.

Sample Personality Description

This person is headed for big things and appears to be very much in a hurry to get there. There is a lack of patience and although one gets the impression of spontaneity, it is probably more a case of acting impulsively. This person is very generous and loving. Although one senses a feeling of oneness, there appears to be some doubt as to whether this person is really attuned to a universal kinship or is just plain insecure. The latter feeling derives from a loudness and extrovertedness. This has quieted down in recent weeks and the result is certainly an improvement.

*Evening No. 16**"The I Ching"*

Recently the ancient Chinese *I Ching*, or *Book of Changes*, has won a surge of interest in the West as thousands turn to its pages, to seek its enigmatic counsel, via the spinning of three coins.

How can the spinning of coins designate the precise passage in a book applicable to a question asked millenniums after the book was written? In his introduction to the Richard Wilhelm translation,* the venerable psychiatrist C. G. Jung prevails quite convincingly upon the reader to put aside the conventional causal point of view (that D happened because C happened, which in turn happened because B happened and A happened), and, instead, to think in terms of what he calls a synchronicity (A, B, C and D are all events in the same momentary situation of the physical and psychic realms). He himself questions the *I Ching* about his writing the introduction and gets an amazingly "perceptive" reply.

If you can approach the *I Ching* with an open mind, tonight can provide some unexplainable evidence of the wisdom of the ancient Chinese. Answers are invariably "on target," pertinent to the question, to the subject and to our times.

The living meaning of the oracle's words lies as much in our unconscious mind (one of the attributes of the psychic realm) as it does in their literal translation. Because understanding the *hidden* symbolism is a key to extracting that meaning.

One must also understand the Chinese approach to evaluating a moment in time. The logic and judgment of the Western mind, as it sifts and evaluates, is by-passed by the

*Published for Bollingen Foundation, Inc., by Pantheon Books, New York. 1950.

Chinese in favor of a *total* picture at the moment of observation, down to the most nonsensical of details—including the way the subject has caused three coins to fall.

One can accept this total picture concept more readily when it is seen in action—maybe not unerringly for even doctors, lawyers and scientists can be wrong, but certainly convincingly. It is not a concept exclusive to the use of the *I Ching*. It manifests itself, too, when a wine taster sips to identify a vineyard and vintage, when a psychometrist tells of an object's past, when an astrologist *without* knowing your date of birth tells you what it is, or when a man with a forked stick tells the U.S. Army in South Viet Nam or a New England farmer where an underground water supply exists.

The *I Ching* has been an object of study and guidance for Chinese scholars and statesmen for three thousand years. The two main Chinese philosophies—Confucianism and Taoism—took inspiration from it. Even today, where political bars do not interfere, the *I Ching* is a common companion of Chinese people who seek counsel to help them cope with the perplexities of life.

For some, the perplexities of the *I Ching* may be just as frustrating as life, especially when attempts are made to understand the origin and meaning of its symbology—the hexagrams in particular. However, the *I Ching* is not meant to be a tool of scholars alone; the book may be used directly by an individual for guidance on a particular problem, and that guidance may be obtained from a few passages selected by the toss of three coins. Instructions are contained in the procedure below.

As Jung says: to some the *I Ching* and how it works may appear as clear as day; to others it may appear "shadowy as twilight" or "dark as night." Those here this evening who are tied irrevocably to the concept of the flow of time, and cannot accept the fact that time may be an illusion just as matter is an illusion of the senses, are free to observe. Others, who feel free to seek to discern the *I Ching's* meaning, should now prepare for a discovery.

Procedure

Step 1 The leader reads the above introduction and asks for a volunteer who wishes to pose a personal question which he or she is willing to share with the group. As in the case of the pendulum, the question should not be made up of a number of parts, but should be kept as

simple as possible. However, the question need not require merely a yes or no answer.

Step 2 When the question is framed and stated, the questioner throws three coins six times. Each time a record is kept of the heads and tails. Trigrams are constructed: the table supplied with the book explains how this is done and indicates a "judgment" in the book which should then be consulted. This "judgment" should be read together with the further elaboration offered in the "image" and the line. If further instructions are needed, see below, after Step 4. The questioner responds to the reading by telling the group what the passage means to him as regards the problem. The group comments on any other ideas that they may have gleaned from the passage.

Step 3 The procedure is repeated by other participants who wish to volunteer.

Step 4 Refreshments and discussion. The group then can, with respect and seriousness of purpose, direct a group question at the *I Ching* such as: Should the group continue? Or: What is the next step for the group to take—Part III or Part IV (Sensory or Metaphysical awareness)? Or: What level are we at? The procedure might be for six interested persons at random in the group to make the tosses of the coins.

Instructions on the Use of the I Ching

The toss of the coins is translated into a sum: heads counts as 2, tails as 3. (Two heads and one tails would then be 7.) This total is then translated into either a broken or solid line: 7 and 9 are solid lines and 8 and 6 are broken lines. The hexagram is constructed from the bottom up. If 7 is thrown, the first or bottom row of the hexagram therefore becomes a solid line. It is later referred to as line 1. Two more lines are drawn (line 2 and line 3) above. This is the bottom trigram and appears on the left side of the key table in the back of the *I Ching*. The next three throws of the coins determine the top trigram and these are on the horizontal key at the top of the key table. Where the two rows cross, the number of the "judgment" in the text is found, and that is then read. Continue to read the "image" following the judgment. Also read those lines that apply to your hexagram, i.e., "seven in the first place," etc.

Evening No. 17

“Free Association”

What happens on the psychiatrist's or psychoanalyst's couch? A person with a problem lies there talking, usually about himself, as honestly as possible. The psychiatrist makes notes. Occasionally the person is asked to provide further details on something that was described, or to provide an explanation, or meaning to him, of a statement—or to elaborate on inner feelings stirred up by a memory or an image.

From all this the good psychiatrist or analyst is usually able to discern attitudes and hang-ups and to direct the person toward further venting and eventual successful therapy.

This technique, common in the field of psychology, is known as free association. In effect, the conscious mind is laid aside in relaxation and the subconscious mind permitted to drift through, as in daydreaming.

What often comes through is an inner anxiety or concern or worry. When this is apparent, conversation should be centered on it. A woman with domestic worries may begin to pour out her problems. She may become emotionally wound up in the process, but the more she talks, the more calmed down she may become.

At the end of such a session, the subject may be smiling and quite rested. There is a healing power in words. When we talk about our troubles we get them off our chest. Analysts have been making use of this principle ever since the days of Freud.

We will use this principle here tonight. Our friends will comprise a type of group confidant to whom we can free associate, identify anxieties and hopefully obtain the relief that comes with getting things off the chest.

The psychologist has many advantages over the group.

A vast amount of training and experience is necessary to use psychoanalytical techniques safely and effectively.

What we will be conducting tonight is merely a play-acting of the real thing, because little depth analysis can come in one session, not to speak of the obstacle of having five or ten of our intimate friends in on this instead of an objective professional.

One unique technique will be used to help overcome the inhibitory aspect of a group. A few moments will be spent in a game you might call "Glossalalia," or talking in tongues. There are many references to this in the Bible and in history. Recently the Pentacostal churches and now other Presbyterian churches have had unusual experiences with it. People who do not know a foreign language will speak in it. Or an ancient version of English will be spoken. Or Sanskrit. Or some unidentifiable dialect or language.

We will give this a chance to happen tonight by merely beginning to babble. There will be chatter that has never been heard before. Maybe something identifiable will be heard, maybe not. But one thing is fairly sure. All should be less inhibited, and the stage will be set for free-er associating by members of the group.

Procedure

Step 1 A leader reads the above introduction and invites all to participate in a verbal "letting go." It helps to have all standing near their chairs or scattered in the center of the room. The leader demonstrates and sets the mood by exclaiming loudly in nonsense words. He may shout "Yub-bidy Yoo Da" and other meaningless word inventions. He may recite from *Alice in Wonderland's* "Jabberwocky," etc. He may find himself talking pidgin English, pseudo-English or something that may sound like the Bible or Shakespeare. He may be quite surprised himself. Let the laughs fall where they may. Enjoy it. Gobbledegook's good for everyone.

Step 2 All join in who can feel it and do it. Voices will probably rise and fall; first, a few sounds and then torrents of sounds.

Step 3 After a few minutes of fun, the group members return to their seats. Personal reactions and experiences are described and discussed.

Step 4 The leader calls for a period of instant relaxation through self-hypnosis, and a minute of meditation on

inner growth: he leads the relaxation, begins and ends the meditation.

Step 5 A volunteer assumes a prone position on a couch. He says what he is thinking about now, returns to his thoughts during the meditation, during the "glossalalia," before arriving tonight and so on back until some incident or experience enters the recitation which a member of the group feels might be vented. Leading questions are asked. The time regression process may have to be continued if a dead end in the questions and answers is reached. Or, when about 15 minutes has elapsed, the session is ended.

Step 6 The same procedure is followed with other volunteers taking their place on the couch.

Step 7 At the leader's discretion—and this may be advisable if any highly emotional moments have occurred—another minute of "glossalalia" is conducted for "further release and catharsis."

Step 8 Refreshments. No formal discussion.

Evening No. 18

"Body Talk"

People communicate with each other in many ways. Conversation is sometimes the least informative. How often have you noticed somebody at a party on the other side of the room and felt something immediately about that person that created a like or a dislike in you?

The way a person moves, stands, holds his arms and expresses himself with his hands and eyes can speak much louder than his words.

Many of us get across to others better when we become more aware of how the whole body "talks." And many of us are more knowledgeable about other people when we understand the language of the body.

The kindergarten in this school of study confines itself to the A B Cs of physical attraction. The first things we learn about body talk are, say, the meaning of swinging hips,

flirtatious smiles, masculine winks. But there is much more to nonverbal communication. Many of us never get beyond elementary school in this subject. This evening we go to college.

We will extend our awareness of the smile. Is it meant to be friendly or disarming? Is it an expression of pleasure or is it a baring of teeth? Is it used discriminately or continuously?

How about eye contact? The person with feelings of inferiority seldom looks into another's eyes. Social custom sometimes still forbids this between the sexes, as it did in the south for the black man and the white woman, and in the Middle East for women. What do shifting eyes connote?

How do we hold our heads? Do we look down, look away, look around?

What is there about a person's manner that gives us a feeling of warmth or of hostility? Is a person interested in communicating with us, or uninterested?

It is difficult to translate nonverbal communication into words. It lies more in the feeling realm. We know the source of spoken words when we hear them, but the origin of these feelings conveyed by nonverbal communication is often impossible to characterize as self-generated or sender-generated.

Then there are subliminal interactions—smells of which we are not conscious (a dog senses fear this way), thoughts through space and other effects which we can call "vibrations" for want of a more concrete tag.

Some of the exercises tonight should make participants more aware of the "input" they are receiving. Some of the exercises should make them more aware of their own output. All of the exercises may well speak volumes without using a word.

Procedure

Step 1 After he has read the introduction, the leader asks for two volunteers—preferably a husband and wife or an unmarried couple. They go to one corner of the room and the rest of the group stand in the opposite corner. The couple holds a two-minute conversation, argument or discussion on some matter which involves them. They do this by whispering—they're audible to each other, but not to the group. Each member of the group guesses the topic of conversation and the stands or positions of the two who participated. After all have guessed, the couple divulges what took place. This is repeated by two men, two women

and a mixed couple who are not married or dating. Results are compared: the men's nonverbal projection versus the women's, the married or dating couples' versus those not involved.

Step 2 A game of charades is played. The group can be divided in any desired way. This differs from standard charades in that it is not a word game but a situation game. Each team retires to a separate room to plan a fictional situation, one of words rather than of action, and to assign roles. (Example: a tennis foursome argues whether a ball was in or out—it would not do to include the action of the game as this would be too obvious—or a few people are discussing what movie they should go to, among several choices.) The first team acts out its situation as the second team members call out their guesses until they hit it. The second team takes the "stage" while the first team guesses. The shortest time for a correct guess wins for the guessers, but the other team has the satisfaction of knowing it *communicated*.

Step 3 The group is divided at random into two parts. One half retires to permit each person in it to cover himself with a sheet. They emerge one at a time, remembering the order. The other participants write down who they think is under the sheet. The cloaked form makes no sound nor exhibits any motion that will give away his or her identity. Neither are antics permitted that might mask identity. When all have walked across the room and left again, they return without their sheets. Each of the other participants recites his order of recognition and the errors are totaled. The second half of the group becomes cloaked, and the same procedure is followed. The winning group is the one with the least errors.

Step 4 A period of nonverbal communication is held. At first, this is done in pairs for about five minutes. The pairs may look into each other's eyes, touch, dance or gesticulate, but no sound is made. At the end of the period, the leader calls for the pairs to break up, and for a general commingling, still with only nonverbal communication.

Step 5 The session is interrupted as refreshments are served in silence. This is also an exercise in nonverbal communication. The leader ends the session and verbal reactions are shared.

Evening No. 19

“Psychodrama”

Presumably the members of this group have met close to forty times. Presumably, too, they have grown both personally and as a group.

As individuals, each one should understand his potential more than he did before. Each ought to be more loving and trusting, both of himself and of the others. Each is, we hope, more aware, more spontaneous, more free, more creative.

The group itself has probably grown in love and trust; members make decisions more readily and move more harmoniously toward their goals. The group, too, is doubtless more spontaneous, uninhibited, creative and participative.

With these assumptions, the group is ready for one of the most powerful tools known to psychotherapy: psychodrama. It cracks personalities wide open and scours them of hold-downs and hang-ups. It does in hours what milder forms of analysis cannot do in years.

This, like fantasy, is an area where great care is needed. There are already a number of built-in safeguards. The group members are pretty certain to be more secure in their relationships than a clinically structured group might be. The members shouldn't be physically exhausted and mentally drained as is so often the case when psychodrama occurs in a marathon confrontation session. And steps will be taken to keep this Evening's drama focussed on group relationships rather than on what can certainly be more traumatic—family relationships.

Still, the leader should be selected for diplomacy, cool headedness under fire and mature judgment. Psychodrama highlights dissonance, fear and distrust. It puts interpersonal relationships under the hot, white light of group airing and candid scrutiny. It is an experience in emotional depth. It can lead to even greater spontaneous freedom, to integration of the members into a group capable of easy

consensus and to more creativity in the choices of activities in the future.

There is no holding back in psychodrama. You take a role. You play it to the hilt. You spare no feelings. You cry if crying comes. You laugh if laughs are there.

If you choose to follow Parts III and IV, having to do with sensory and metaphysical awareness respectively, your group will become autogenic. That is, no leader will be named for the sessions. (The group has been quasi-autogenic right along, in that there has been no single leader to guide the activities and discussions on a continuing basis.)

The autogenic group is a step in the direction of greater development. Without even a temporary leader, a group becomes more intimate. Events become more meaningful. The forces of group dynamics become more compelling.

The subject of leadership is used for this Evening's psychodrama.

Procedure

Step 1 The host reads the above introduction and volunteers to play the role of tonight's not-yet-appointed leader. The person at his left or right challenges his ability to be the leader. The host defends his right with all sincerity. Others take sides. Anyone who thinks he can be a better leader than the host enters the conversation and explains why. He becomes a target. Some remember when this new pretender to the throne was leader, and bring up reasons why it would be a mistake to have him lead again. When there seems to be little more to add—or when thirty minutes have elapsed—the psychodrama ends.

Step 2 Again the host assumes a role first: it is now stated that the leader for tonight's session shall be the one who has up until now participated the least, been the most retiring and shown the least desire to lead. The host decides that he is the one most qualified to lead under these new standards. He states why he would be a proper leader and defends this against all opposition. Others are nominated. They react. The session ends as before.

Step 3 A leader is chosen for tonight based on the qualifications contained in the introduction. The method of selection is based on consensus. This leader conducts a discussion on the difference in the group's behavior in the psychodrama and in the real selection.

Step 4 The couch is cleared and a blanket supplied. Each takes his turn in playing a young son or daughter, and in being put to bed and tucked in by his father or mother,

played by the leader. A typical good-night scene lasts a few minutes in each case, and covers the actual day or evening's events, or involves regressing in imagination to cover a childhood day.

Step 5 The leader calls for a group handshake. All members join hands in a circle then move forward until their hands can reach the center and touch.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. The leader announces that the twentieth Evening of this series will be devoted to awareness exercises which members will create between now and then. The authors invite the testing of new "games," and their submissions to London for further testing and possible publication. Members should outline the procedure for their games on sheets of paper and bring them to the next meeting.

Evening No. 20

"The Impact of the Group"

As science and technology have catapulted ahead, man has been left behind—often unable to explain his own nature, to cope with his environment, to live peaceably with his fellow man or to unleash his own full capabilities.

Industries, individuals, governments, societies, religions, universities—all have failed to extend man's consciousness and intelligence to the point where he is using the major portion of his brain's capacity. Most have not even begun to size up the problem.

Now a new entity has appeared on the scene—the group. Its initial successes have been phenomenal. Groups are springing up all over the country. They are at organized churches, at spiritual retreats, at sales conventions, at philosophical centers and now in homes.

Their impact is so great that time is being collapsed to a degree in the evolution of man. Man is changing. He is changing his behavior, his intelligence, his ability and even his rate of change—by daring to challenge the insularism of his own mind and body and sharing it in a group.

In many types of group interaction, notably training groups or confrontation groups (also termed "sensitivity groups"), changes in behavior and attitude come about through a process known as cognitive dissonance—i.e., when two individuals hold opposing opinions in a group, the resulting dissonance is uncomfortable and one or both will attempt to reduce this discomfort by adjusting his or their attitudes. This is of questionable validity in the opinion of the authors. The type of group interaction that produces this dissonance has been avoided here in favor of a freeing of everybody's barriers to growth. This freeing permits attitude adjustment in a direction that the individual sees as right for him rather than in a direction forced by the group.

This Evening the group participants are suggesting ideas for activities, some of which will be tested here and now. It is hoped that these too will emphasize the freeing of positive potential rather than confronting the negative.

How can you judge whether an exercise or "game" contributes positively to the development of awareness and the realization of potential? Here are some gauges by which to measure each suggestion offered tonight:

Does it provide a new experience?

Does it challenge resources of consciousness?

Does it encourage a clearer self-image in each?

Does it involve participants in the activity and with each other?

Does it assist in the melting of unwanted personality or social barriers?

Does it promote love and understanding?

Is it fun?

It is not necessary that an exercise meet all of these criteria, but certainly to have merit for the group purpose it needs to meet two or three, and the more the better.

There may be a tendency to replay previous Evenings with minor adaptations. This should be discouraged in favor of totally new approaches and directions. These are often determined by the group personality and group interest. Many possible directions are absent in the Evenings provided by the authors because they were considered of special rather than general interest. Now is the time for the group to express its own personality and pursue its own objective.

For instance, it would certainly be of interest and exciting to some groups to discuss an important figure in history or literature, such as, say, Napoleon or Shake-

speare's King Lear. As regards Napoleon, some would say he was a great butcher, that he had no regard for men's lives, was bathed in blood, was a conqueror; others would say that he was brilliant, a military genius, a great general and a great man, that he said many great things, understood men and understood their need for heroism, glamour, etc. Perhaps each would see him in a different historical light. Some would see him as a great failure—a man who spent his last days in prison, became despondent and unfulfilled. Others would see him as a great patriot of the De Gaulle type who was only interested in making friends and a great nation.

Other groups might prefer to use the tools that were introduced in the self-hypnosis, free association or psychodrama exercises to explore the unconscious further and build new personality strength. Caution is advised if this is the direction the group wishes to take. You might want to invite a psychologist, psychiatrist, psychiatric social worker, analyst, respected hypnotist, doctor, or some other professional with related experience to observe or lead such sessions.

Remember, the broad framework tonight should remain psychological. Ahead in this book are twenty more Evenings that open up new horizons via the recognized senses, and via the unrecognized senses, or the extrasensory. And there are twenty more that take the group off into the areas of the mind that can control matter and circumstances, and of the spirit wherein the physical recedes and the unseen metaphysical begins.

Procedure

Step 1 The host reads the above introduction. Each game is read by its sponsor. The group gives each a score obtained by adding up each person's opinion of how many of the seven gauges or criteria are met by the different games. The highest-scoring game is tried out first, then the next highest, until time has run out.

Step 2 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on whether the group wishes to continue in the future with its own original events, with sensory and extrasensory Evenings (Part III) or with Metaphysical Evenings (Part IV).

Step 3 A person is assigned to forward original events tried tonight to the authors, with comments for possible further testing by other groups, in accordance with the instructions at the end of Part IV.

PART III

Sensory and Extrasensory Games

INTRODUCTION: "Sensory and Extrasensory Awareness"

When we expand our awareness we open the tap wider to permit a greater flow of the life stream so that we may gain more of the power of the universe.

The tap was opened wider in Part II—for those who followed it—by removing impediments in our conditioning, and permitting our subconscious minds to work more in harmony with fresh, new outlooks, attitudes and goals.

The tap is now opened still wider in Part III by sensitizing the conscious mind to input, through the senses of sight, sound, touch, smell and taste. Our conscious minds can also be sensitized to the input, via the super-conscious, of extrasensory impressions.

What does this mean to the office worker, the housewife, the professional practitioner, the businessman? It can mean the difference between knowing and not knowing, between abounding energy and chronic fatigue; between everything going right and everything going wrong, between enthusiasm and despair, between efficiency and waste, between profit and loss, between ecstasy and misery.

The next twenty Evenings can magnify the perception of a group of people to the point where their lives may be dramatically changed. It is fun by definition. For man's hunger is to grow in awareness and self-mastery, to melt his separateness and to gain power through knowledge. Achieving this even in part is sheer joy.

Evening No. 1

“The Sensitive Plant”

Experiments have recently shown that plants can react to human thought. When polygraph (lie detector) equipment is attached to plants, it registers dramatic changes as people express thoughts of violence or destruction toward the plants. These experiments have been demonstrated again and again and are now the subject of considerable investigation. For instance, at the Spring 1969 meeting of the Institute For Parapsychology, considerable interest was evidenced in a successful study involving plants, a polygraph and ten people attempting to affect chartrecorder readings.

Of course, it is astounding to almost everybody to consider that plants can have “feelings.” However, by far the greater point of the demonstrations is that they give evidence, by observable, repeatable, controlled experiments, that man’s thoughts can travel through space and be received. Man has known this, but science, which demands the observable, the repeatable and the controllable, has not been satisfied. Now, apparently, the “green thumb” is no longer the “rule of thumb,” but measurable.

We are not going to affect plants with our minds during this Evening but we may affect each other. Certainly if man was totally aware of what he was receiving in the ether, he would find that human radiations were being received among all the other types. And he should be a better receiver of human thought than are plants.

At first we will sharpen visual perception. Then we will move gradually to becoming aware of our skin perception. And, finally, we will become “radio” broadcasters and receivers, in this sense.

Procedure

Step 1 The host reads the Part III and the Evening’s

introductions and these instructions. The group members spend five minutes observing every other member of the group. Then, in turn, each member goes out of the room and returns, having altered slightly something in his appearance—taken off something, put on something, done his or her hair differently, changed his shoes or socks, altered a pocket handkerchief. There should be as slight a change as possible so as to provide a test of observation. Each person writes what he thinks was changed. Later, each announces what the change was and scores are tallied.

Step 2 One person in the group intones the sound OM resonantly as all stand facing him, with their arms stretched forward toward him and their palms down. OM should be chanted in two parts. First the O-O-O then the M-M-M. Vibrations should be distinctly felt in the skin of the palms. This is a refresher exercise to remind us that skin can do more than hold us together.

Step 3 Pieces of colored paper or cloth are placed in separate positions on a table and numbered. Bright, clean colors should be used—green, red, blue, yellow, white, black, etc. Before the numbering, each participant is securely blindfolded. Each person places his hands palm down over the colors and attempts to “feel” their emanations. He records his “second guess,” for each number. Later the scores are tallied.

Step 4 One person leaves the house or apartment and walks about a block away after first synchronizing his watch with another person in the group. He is to remain outside in a lighted area where he can read his watch. As soon as he feels a message to return, he notes the time, by minute and second, and comes back. This message is sent from five to ten minutes after the person has left. It is done in the following manner: At the timekeeper's signal, each visualizes the person who is outside and “sees” him start back. This is done with a feeling of warm love for the person that lasts about five seconds. The timekeeper announces the time at the start and finish. This is compared with the returnee's sense of the message time on his arrival. Others may try if they wish, and scores may be recorded.

Step 5 To test the group as receivers, a person leaves the house or apartment, and, five seconds before ringing the doorbell, he visualizes the group in an aura of love and “sees” a member of the group rising to open the door. Does anyone catch the thought and say “now,” just a

second or two before the bell rings? Does the right person "feel" that he is the one to rise and open the door? Scores are tallied.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Individual scores are compared in Steps 1 through 5. Are there any extrasensory "sensitives" in the group? How about women as senders or receivers as compared to men? (Special note: parapsychologists constantly wrestle with a factor known as psi-missing, where "misses" are recorded far beyond the laws of chance. Some attribute this to a subconscious negative reaction to the tests. Was this factor present tonight? . . .) Art materials and modeling clay will be needed for all for next time.

Evening No. 2

"Dull Senses and Sharp Senses"

This Evening art materials and modeling clay will be used. We will use them after our senses have been awakened by a number of amusing exercises—and one exercise that will go unclassified as to whether it evokes amusement or fright.

We are creatures of habit. Habit dulls our senses. Anything positive that we do to break daily habits increases our awareness and makes us come more alive.

Eat something different. Put on a new tie. Buy a new hat. Make a new friend. Go somewhere you have never been before. Drive to work by some other route. Take a sauna. Try out a new word in the dictionary. Each new experience of this kind quickens our senses and "turns us on."

When you shake hands with the left hand you *feel* the other person. When you shift from one brand of coffee to a different blend, you taste your morning brew more in-

tensely than you can remember. When you make any change in your habitual sensory intake, there is an intensifying that spells a fuller experiencing of life.

Why is this? There is no change in our physiology, so there must be a change in our consciousness. Our consciousness is actually awakened by new sensations and put to sleep by habit. Most people sleep away at least part of their waking hours.

Tonight we will see evidence of this as we test the results of some sense-deadening habits, and "come alive" to some novel experience.

Procedure

Step 1 All members who smoke go to the center of the room where they are blindfolded and given an ashtray. (If all smoke, some must stay behind.) Each is asked to take a cigarette from his pack and light up—and to place his pack on the floor in front of him. As these people start smoking, they are asked, "Are you sure that is your own brand of cigarettes?" When all confirm this, the nonsmokers take the lighted cigarettes away and begin making switches. They go round and round noting how many smokers can tell their own brands. Each time a switch is made, it is noted whether the pack in front of the smoker is the same brand or a different brand from the cigarette being given him. Sometimes a smoker gets his own cigarette back, sometimes one of his own brand but a different cigarette, sometimes a different brand. Chances are they will seldom guess their own brands correctly. In the first place, smoking dulls the taste buds. Secondly, closing the eyes can affect taste sensations. Discussion follows while the host prepares Step 2.

Step 2 A similar test is now conducted with one brand of coffee. The host *alone* should privately read the instructions for this step: some of the coffee that is being prepared for refreshments later this evening is poured into two different types of containers. One type is a beer mug, the other is a tapering wide-mouthed teacup or coffee cup—the standard, delicately shaped variety. Each person is asked to sip black coffee from both types of containers and to determine which is the *stronger* coffee. (The host is to say and do what he can to enhance the illusion that two kinds of coffee have been brewed.) A record is kept of who sips which container first (here again the host cooperates by not divulging that the order is significant and

manipulates in such a way that each container gets picked up first its share of times.) A record is also kept of who picks which container as the strongest. The results should be:

The wide-mouthed container sipped first—most votes for strongest coffee;

The wide-mouthed container sipped second—tie for second;

The mug first—tie for second;

The mug last—least votes.

Explanation: The first taste is always the best. (Subsequent tastes are good, too, but the antennae are really poised for that first taste impact; the second never quite makes that much of a taste impression.) Also, the sense of smell augments the sense of taste and is closely integrated with it. The mug inhibits the vaporization on which smell depends while the tapering cup enhances it, like a brandy snifter.

Step 3 Half of the group moves over to the other half and lines up so that each looks into each other member's eyes for a few seconds. When all have completed this, they return to their seats. Both halves discuss the differences that they noticed in individuals. Now the first half rises again. This time they pick one individual in the other half, and look into that single individual's eyes for three minutes. Again they return. What else has been noticed that was not noticed the previous time? Chances are that this intense observation reveals such details as the contracting or dilating of the pupils or the watering of an eye. A feeling may be noticed coming from the other person—perhaps hypnotic, perhaps possessive, perhaps hostile or loving. Discussion.

Step 4 Some excellent creative work has been displayed by painters and sculptors who are blind. Through what senses do they work? Participants are better able to answer the question after the following exercise. All are given paints or modeling clay, whichever is preferred or available. Everyone is blindfolded. Painters paint, sculptors sculpt. Blindfolds are removed and the results compared. Results are taken home as future conversation pieces.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. . . . It is announced that all are to come to the following Evening in a masquerade costume complete with mask.

Evening No. 3

"The Masquerade"

One reason why masquerade parties are such fun is that they permit us to think we can be somebody else. In the process we leave behind our burdens and problems, and since that "somebody else" is symbolic and less than skin deep, his burdens or problems are not taken on in the exchange. No problems, no weight, a light evening.

Actually, we are more likely to be ourselves at a masquerade party and that is the real reason we can have more fun. The mask we normally wear and the image that we are constantly trying to project to others are tossed aside. We are protected by the party costume. We can be ourselves. No need to work at being what we want others to think we are. No work, an easygoing fun evening. Under the disguise one is protected and can start afresh as a new person. (The word *persona* means "the social facade an individual assumes.")

This Evening provides an interesting test of awareness faculties, as we will see. Once the novelty of each other's attire has worn off, we'll begin to sense the real person beneath the trappings. Certainly, the girl in a tiger outfit may "put on" (exaggerate) tiger behavior to enhance the illusion, but the real self will probably come through stronger than ever. The man who wears a Captain Hook outfit may blunderbuss around for effect, but he himself may well come through louder and clearer than the sound and fury.

In sensing people and understanding their behavior in everyday life, we are constantly coping with having to distinguish between the games people play and their inner motivations. A masquerade party provides a third dimension, and possibly a means to get our bearings or zero-in on people, as navigators do—by triangulation. A personal style becomes one and the same as a personality to the

undiscerning. Awareness of the symbolism and emotional ties between the outer garments and the inner person can come with the masquerade exercise we will now enjoy.

Procedure

Step 1 On arrival, participants socialize and enjoy each other's outfits for the first half hour. Masks are worn.

Step 2 Masks are removed. Everyone is seated. Each person comments on the outfit of the other participants. Was he fooled when the person arrived? What made him finally recognize who it was? Is there any relationship between the person and the costume he or she chose (a deep personality need, the exact opposite, etc.)?

Step 3 Two or more participants agree to put on an impromptu play or skit. They confer for a few minutes to establish the situation and the roles each will play. They then return and play only half of the scenario. In the middle they stop, leave the room to remove their costumes and return wearing robes or other regular clothing provided by the host. They continue the skit. When it's over, the other participants comment on any differences in acting or behavior that they may have noticed between the costumed and noncostumed portions of the performance.

Step 4 The players remain in their borrowed attire. Two or more other volunteers are now needed. They are each in turn to go through the following imaginary circumstance. Each is to assume he has accidentally broken something belonging to the host. The host is approached and each of these volunteers explains how a watch was broken, a vase smashed, a television set damaged or some other valuable object injured or destroyed. Participants listen carefully. The host's reaction is always cautious and non-committal. As each finishes, he leaves the room and dons a different costume, temporarily relinquished by the first set of volunteers. He then returns and once again explains to the host how something has been accidentally damaged. Participants then comment on any differences they have noted that may be due to the effect of the costume on the individual. It should be noted that there are many facets to the process of justification and rationalization in excusing the misuse of a borrowed object, or explaining the lack of awareness that caused an accident. What different approaches were used by the volunteers—exoneration? Apology? Transfer of responsibility? Promise of restitution?

Who made the event the least painful to himself and his host? How?

Step 5 Refreshments are served and the masquerade party reassumes its social flavor.

Evening No. 4

“A Safe ‘Trip’ ”

“Turn on!” The challenge is hurled no longer by hippies and flower people alone. It is now part of the American vocabulary. It elicits an awakening, awareness and sensitivity. It asks you to expand your consciousness.

A recent surprise police raid on a Long Island university netted a score of drug users. It also brought criticism by nonusers among the students. “The police need to be turned on,” said one student. He meant that the police showed no human sympathy or understanding, no sharpened awareness of the needs of the students.

The urge to expand consciousness is as old as man himself. It is the natural life force that has caused man to evolve beyond the level of the ape. In the last five thousand years it has enabled him to build a civilization that has changed the face of the planet and now it promises to extend his influence into space.

The expansion of consciousness is also pressing inward. It is seeking to put a magnifying glass in front of the five senses and a public address system in front of the small voices of intuition, creativity and judgment.

The use of drugs to accomplish this has proved a mirage; vivid colors, sensuous sounds, intensified fragrances are sterile when found on the dead-end street of mental distortion and unreality.

Those seeking “escape” have remained on that dead-end street. But the true seekers of mind expansion have swung away from LSD and other chemical compounds. Many have beat a path to the practices of wiser men.

Recently, a man walked into the office of a hypnotist. "Can you turn me on?" he asked.

"It depends what you mean," replied the cautious practitioner.

"I want to feel moments of heightened awareness through every fiber of my mind and body."

"Have you ever experienced this before?"

"Yes."

"Tell me about it."

There followed a poetic experience in every detail: a hypnosis-susceptibility test; a brief hypnosis session with suggestions to aid subsequent self-hypnosis by the subject; instructions on how the subject could give himself the suggestions that would enable him to relive safely what he had already experienced with dangerous drugs. How did this hypnotic "turn on" compare with LSD? "It felt more natural. I was the master, focusing my senses wherever I wished instead of them focusing me. I could turn on my 'turned on' state and turn it off at will. While in it, I could ponder and wonder and think."

Good modern hypnotists use mind-expansion and time-distortion techniques to help with a variety of human problems from allergies to childbirth. People who want to "turn on" without narcotics are able to rely safely on experienced hypnotists.

The clinical hypnotist produces the distortion of sound, the magnification of color, the apparent unending moment in time, the feeling of love and oneness that characterizes the psychedelic experience. Furthermore, when he has done it for the subject once, he can do it instantly again and again, even over the telephone, through a simple technique known as post-hypnotic suggestion. Or he can, through teaching self-hypnosis, permit the subject to do it for himself.

The dividends of expanded consciousness are described, by exponents of "transcendental" meditation, as greater intelligence, energy, and happiness. As the body relaxes and the mind expands, tensions and frustrations float away. It is far more effective and certainly safer without drugs.

And the effects of hypnosis are strikingly similar. A state of hypnosis is induced by suggestions of relaxation and deep sleep. The state arrived at is one of being awake in dormancy, wherein awareness is maintained without as much conscious participation as usual—there's less evaluation, injection of personal likes or dislikes or judgment.

In this state the hypnotist can suggest that there will be no pain in, say, the left hand—and a pin prick will not be felt. He can suggest to a maternity patient that periods of painful contractions will pass like instants while the restful periods in between will take longer—and birth without drugs becomes a relatively painless process. He can suggest to an ex-LSD user that the same psychedelic experiences previously enjoyed will occur on command—and they will.

To “turn on” a subject in the way that a particular drug does, the hypnotist must know the phenomena caused by the drug—how it opens the senses, induces them to blend (colors are often measured by their sound) and permits them to register at intense levels.

He does not have to take LSD to be able to recreate the hallucinations. He merely has to have reasonably vivid descriptions from people who have had them. These can then be used equally well for people who have not had them. Color reinforcement or other sense magnification can be accomplished and blended to fit the desires of the occasion, safely. The dangerous changes that can occur with LSD in the physical body, and in the rational intellect, are avoided this way. For instance:

The ego can be blown up to gigantic proportions hypnotically just as it is under the drugs.

The superconscious can be brought closer to the perception of the conscious.

The creative spark can be fanned into a flame.

Many movements and centers devoted to meditation and other forms of concentration and mind exercises are using forms of hypnotism without calling them that. By direct use of hypnotic techniques, spiritual exercises can take people giant steps forward for a closer view of an ideal life. The controlled power of self-suggestion is one of the means used by yogis to reach levels of trance and reality—this goes beyond what we call “suggestion” in hypnosis. A way to these levels is through experiencing how hypnosis works in our lives every day without our knowing it.

Tonight, as the hypnotist of yourself, you can write your own travel ticket for a “trip” to the recesses of lost memories, to a land of hypersensitivity, to a rainbow of vibrant colors, to a wellspring of ideas, to the profundity of time dislocation or to heights of spiritual ecstasy.

Procedure

Step 1 Participants take turns reading the above introduction and also the entire text of Evening No. 7, Part II, if the group has not experienced that Evening.

Step 2 Each participant decides what he would like to accomplish in a brief period of autosuggestion. He writes down instructions to himself that he will use as the suggestion when relaxation has been reached. See the typical suggestions below, after Step 4. This is read to the group and evaluated from the criteria provided in Evening No. 7, Part II. Group members may suggest modifications if it's deemed appropriate. If anyone present has not been through Evening No. 5, Part I, where deep relaxation was induced by a monologue, he may exclude himself, or the group may refresh its mental picture of this relaxation by turning to page 32 and going through that monologue together once more. Once a deep state of relaxation is attained, each gives himself the suggestion he has written out. A volunteer will ring a bell after thirty minutes. Anyone who has not concluded his "trip" by then agrees that he will end at the "One, two, three!" command of the group in unison. The relaxation begins.

Step 3 The end of the thirty minutes is noted by the bell. Anyone still under the influence of self-hypnosis is "assisted" back by the group counting "One, two, three!"

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Each member describes his experience.

Typical Psychedelic Autosuggestions

When I open my eyes now, colors will appear in their fullest intensity, sounds will be reduced to their most harmonious vibrations, scents will be magnified, and I will be aware of the universe as one magnificent symphony of the senses. I see it all in my mind's eye even now before I begin.

When I open my eyes now, I will sit in silent communion with the very soul of the universe. We will be as one. I will feel the love and bliss that comes only with divine oneness. I begin to feel it now even before I open my eyes.

When I open my eyes now I will enjoy thirty minutes of creative recharging. Ideas will flow through me that

will be meaningful and productive in reaching my goals. I can picture even now the fertile areas I can tap.

Evening No. 5

“Introducing Psychometry”

“What is psychometry?”

The question was asked by a young woman at a recent workshop on psychic phenomena. One man who was assisting with the workshop volunteered to explain.

“Physical objects ‘talk’ to us in a way. If we can develop the sensitivity to pick up what they are saying or radiating, we are able to perform psychometry. Actually, we gain, from the object, an impression about its owner or about the object itself. Although I have never actually tried it, hand me your ring and I’ll go through the motions so you understand what I mean.”

The girl gave him her ring. The man held it and closed his eyes. “That’s funny,” he said, handing the ring back. “I saw an image on the inside of my eyelids when I closed my eyes. It was a single eye—perhaps a reminder to me that I was getting into the area of the all-knowing.”

“That’s amazing!” exclaimed the girl. “I bought this last year in Europe from a man with a patch over one eye.”

From that day on, the man realized, and proved over and over again, that he could gain information from objects. Many of us are doing this now, unconsciously. When brought into the scope of the conscious mind, this ability can be developed and can lead to the discovery of other sensitivities we never knew we had.

This evening we will create a climate for psychometry. Everybody’s antennae should be extended another notch. For some the experience can provide the added sensitivity needed to move an important step beyond routine life.

Procedure

Step 1 A simple object in the room, such as a vase or

an ash tray, is passed around from person to person. The first to hold it tells as many things about that object as he can see to describe. When he has totally exhausted all the facts he has noticed about it, he passes it on to the next person who adds to what has already been said by noting additional things about it. Perhaps it has some insignia on the base, or perhaps there are some flaws in the glass, scratches on the metal, etc. Maybe another person can add additional information about the refractive index of the glass, its thickness, or details of the manufacturing process.

After all have had their chances, and presumably there is nothing more to say about the object, it is given back to the person who started, and he is asked to say something more about it. Now additional information begins to flow. What one person has said may have touched off other ideas about the object. Also, totally new relevancies may occur to people. After everybody, for the second time, has come to the conclusion that there is absolutely nothing more to be said about that object, it is handed back for a third go around. It is usually found that there is still a great deal more to cover. This should be done with a second, more stimulating object if the conversation was considered thorough on the first.

Step 2 If you took a microscope and looked at the surface of any object, you could see a lot more about the object than with the naked eye. Now the idea is to develop—not a “zoom lens,” but a “zoom mind” which will zoom in on something apparently simple and blow it up so that it becomes an experience. If we look at common water through the amplifying lenses of the microscope, we find that, in the water we drink, there’s a whole universe of living microorganisms that we never knew existed. The same sort of thing can be found with all sorts of matter, such as glass.

When we begin to get into the nature of material, we find that it’s not even solid; that molecules and atoms are vibrating at a tremendous rate; and that the tones and harmonies which make up molecular substances are quanta of electricity—discontinuous entities, atoms with their own brand of consciousness of being atoms, molecules with a compulsion to interact with each other through the bond which is essential to their nature. In this way we can enter into an object and find that it is made of pure electricity, like our own bodies, and that by changing the instrument of perception, we have also, in a sense, changed the

nature of the object observed. A volunteer attempts a description of an object in the above terms. Others, who wish to, add to it.

Step 3 A tablecloth is placed on a table. Each participant places an object under the cloth in such a way that it cannot be glimpsed in the process by anybody in the group. This object can be a watch, a ring, a tie clasp, a pen, etc. One minute of relaxed silence is enjoyed by the group. The objects under the cloth can be the subject of meditation in the silence, or a participant may prefer to seek attunement with the universe in his own way.

Step 4 At the conclusion of the meditation the tablecloth is removed and each person in turn, or in groups of two or three, approaches the table and writes out a list of the objects on it, then individually attempts to identify the owner by the "feel" or emanations of the object. People who recognize an object from previous association with it should disqualify themselves on that particular object. When all lists have been completed, the owners retrieve their objects, identifying them to the group, and scores are tallied. Assuming that objects could not possibly have been identified by other means, anything more than one or two "hits" per person in a group of ten to fifteen people *can* be considered psychometry in action.

Step 5 The person with the greatest number of hits tries his hand at telling something more about the objects or owners by once again holding them.

Step 6 Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 6

"I Have a Secret"

There are two schools of thought in investigations into mental telepathy. The physical school believes it to be an intensification of the five senses to the point where they can attain supernormal levels of sensitivity. The psychical school believes mental telepathy to be another kind of

manifestation, like clairvoyance or the ability to see into the future, and explainable only by a totally new, psychic look at the universe. Telepathy can be distinguished from clairvoyance in that it works from mind to mind, whereas clairvoyance involves perceiving distant scenes or objects not within the range of normal perception.

This evening we will probably find evidence in support of both theories. We will also find some participants to be good senders and others to be better receivers, and that these capabilities can shift depending on whether physical or psychical tests of telepathy are being conducted.

We have all experienced flashes of telepathy. A phone rings when we have just thought of the person calling. A poker player gets the right hunch or has "card sense." Sometimes there is precognition of impending trouble minutes or hours before it happens, or we have a feeling that all is not right with a friend or a member of the family, and this turns out to be true.

Many skeptics have tried to show that demonstrations of telepathy are explainable by standard scientific means, or else to prove them "phony," and have wound up convinced that not only is there something to telepathy, but that they themselves have that *something*. An engineer who participated in one group and was the only one who scoffed at the "Symbol-in-the-Envelope Game" was also the only one in the group to "hit" eight out of eight correctly, an event which he only too well understood to be totally outside the laws of chance.

When we experience telepathy, our horizons widen and we begin to feel ourselves less limited by our skin and five senses. We expand as individuals. And, what is equally important, we begin to take that "new look at the universe."

Procedure

Step 1 The group divides into two teams—A and B. These can consist of men against women or be divided according to the way people are naturally seated, or according to any other desired division. For those who have seen the television program *What's My Line* or *I Have a Secret*, the procedure is largely the same. The first person on Team A confides a secret to his teammates. Team B must guess what that secret is by asking questions, in turn, to which the person on Team A can reply either yes or no. A count is kept of the total questions asked, until the secret is basically

known. A limit of twenty questions is set. The first person on Team B then shares a secret with his teammates, and members of Team A ask questions in turn. When all have had a chance with a secret, the team scores are tallied, and the winning team is the one which had to ask the fewest number of questions. Members of the winning team must take the roles of receivers in the actions that follow, while members of the other team take the roles of senders.

Step 2 A receiver leaves the room. An object previously agreed on—a pen or paper clip or coin, etc.—is hidden by the group. The receiver is called back. A sender moves around the room as the receiver holds his arm or shoulder. The sender concentrates on the location of the object as he moves in the direction he is told to go, and gives no conscious movement that could give away the location of the object. A timekeeper calls “time” after five minutes if the object is not found. When the object is found, a record is kept of the time that took. Other senders and receivers try until all have had a chance.

Step 3 The exercise is repeated without a physical link. That is, there is no physical sender, just a telepathic one. The receivers attempt to find the objects as before. Their new times are compared with those in Step 2.

Step 4 In laboratory—and gamelike—tests of ESP a very important element is missing: emotional voltage. Because these special tests are out of the context of real life, we do not give them the seriousness of purpose that is involved in the *real* things we do. Everyday evidence of ESP takes place more often with people who are close to us, and it involves events that are meaningful to us. In the final game tonight we’ll add the missing element of seriousness of purpose. Everybody is given three minutes to ponder the question: If you were to be granted one wish in life, what would it be? All are reminded that holding that wish pictorially in their imaginations is the first step to manifesting it in reality, so the wish must be soberly considered and wisely and seriously selected. Senders visualize their wishes. Receivers write down all wish impressions that they get, and, if possible, the sender’s names. After several minutes, the receivers read off their impressions. When this is completed, each sender states what his wish was. The number of “hits” are tallied. Now senders and receivers may reverse sides and repeat the procedure. Does a comparison of the scores confirm the senders as senders?

Or has the change of wave length between Step 1 and Step 4 caused a change in skills?

Step 5 Refreshments and discussion.

Evening No. 7

“Right Actions”

Every game or exercise experienced by the group in its many meetings together has served to create a group consciousness. Besides the expansion of individual consciousness and awareness, there has been group development.

If this group exchanged half of its members with another group that had experienced the same kinds of Evenings, the result would be an Evening with far less harmony, less rapport and probably less enjoyment and accomplishment.

The group now has a functioning ego of its own with a goal to pursue. It has a rich storehouse of experiences shared that provides memories to link the participants, just as college days are always remembered or the birth of a baby is an important family experience.

In a previous exercise (Part I, Evening 6) the group cohesiveness permitted the application of individual criticism and evaluation without the disastrous divisiveness that this would ordinarily cause. The object was *honesty in discussing right thinking*. Tonight we look into right actions.

In right thinking, the test is how far we are prepared to go in “leveling” with other people. It is easy to talk about our feelings about war and killing, how far we are prepared to go in hating or injuring an enemy to restrain him from killing. In fact, talking about our thinking on such a subject can be a catharsis. However, we found that discussing our personal vanities was a far greater test of full honesty and right thinking. The same would be true were we to discuss sensuality and nonsensuality, our ap-

petites, the desires of our materialistic and sensual natures.

Right actions can easily induce secretive thinking if we do not have full confidence in the love and unity of purpose of the group. We will reassure ourselves of that unity and love by repeating the "group support" exercises performed on the very first Evening (Part I, Evening No. 1, Step 6). We will ask ourselves five questions, having to do with our social lives. This will be, in effect, delving into a second layer of consciousness that controls our behavior in relation to shaping our lives with our fellow man.

Through this exploration we will discuss openly matters that we may never have discussed before. Because this is within the group, it can be done with relative ease and confidence and frankness. It should be an absorbing Evening yet a cathartic one. We should emerge with a feeling of enlightenment and gratification; knowing that we have taken another giant step in individual and group consciousness.

Procedure

Step 1 The group spends the first few minutes performing the falling exercise, wherein a circle is formed and each member in turn is prevented from falling. See Part I Evening 1, Step 6.

Step 2 Five questions will be discussed tonight. The first relates to cleanliness. How clean do we like our homes to be? How often do we vacuum them, dust, etc.? How do we behave in other people's houses? Do we drop ashes on the floor, put glasses on piano tops, track dirt when we enter or create trouble for the hostess in other ways? How about our cleanliness of body? Do we prefer showers, tubs? How often? And cleanliness of mind. Do we get some satisfaction out of political intrigue, business "sharpness," confidence-game tactics, pornographic literature, weasel-wording? Each person takes the witness stand in turn without leaving his or her chair. The witness may volunteer a discourse on the question as related to his personal habits or may await questions from the others.

Step 3 The same procedure is followed for the second question: Are you content in our society? Each person is both an individual and a product of society. Much contentment or discontent can come as a result of being a member of society. Are we content with ourselves and our contribution to this society or do we live entirely in our space-time bubble, selfishly from the social point of

view? Do we limit our generosity to our own flesh and blood?

Step 4 The group pauses to comment on the way each member is handling himself as a witness. Does any participant challenge anything said by any witness in Step 2 and Step 3? Feelings should not be hurt. Every valid challenge is a gold nugget to the individuals involved and the group as a whole. If there is no obvious weak link in the "testimony," how about digging further into an area that was covered by somebody a little too quickly. The challenging should be according to a sense of right action.

Step 5 The third question posed is: How strong are we in standing up for what we are convinced is right and the truth? Do we critically examine the information that comes to us through these narrow apertures we call eyes, ears, nose, mouth, etc.? Or are we too conditioned by society and by the kind of authorities we are willing to accept? How much are we willing to go against mass opinion or community sentiment to express our personal conviction of what is right? This time the challenging process is combined with the testifying. Each person answers the question as he sees it, then reacts to requests for additional information and then to the challenges of others.

Step 6 The fourth question is: Are we interested in the study of ourselves and of society? Do we include both the physical and metaphysical approaches? Questions or challenges.

Step 7 The final question: Do we in our behavior follow only our personal will, or do we also consider a universal will? For some this may mean—do I have a concept of God? For others it may mean—do I turn my mind, self and body to the universe? In either case, it means a kind of self-surrender, either partially or totally, to the ultimate laws of the universe. Do we invite the cosmic plan to work through us? If we don't, we are permitting our wills to have the exclusive say; we try to get what we can out of the world. If we do have a consciousness of playing a part in the universal plan, we are more likely to set high ideals and turn to prayer or meditation for help in moving in this direction. This time there are no questions, no challenges, so that the Evening ends on a positive note. Instead, there is a one-minute period of relaxed meditation.

Step 8 Refreshments. No discussion.

Evening No. 8

“Body Perception”

This is an Evening in which a potpourri of awareness tests and exercises should be enjoyed. There is no sense of competition. Rather the tests provide us with further insights as to our own strengths.

The cooperation of the host is needed to the extent of his supplying several ingredients from the kitchen, but other than that, the group is self-sufficient in its conduct of a freewheeling Evening.

Step 1 Everybody sits on the floor, coming as close as he or she can to assuming the traditional half-lotus position of the yogi. This is done as follows: Sit with legs extended in front of you. Bend your left leg, grasping your left foot and pulling it toward you so that the sole can be placed inside the right thigh. If the left knee rises, ease it down gently toward the floor. Now bend your right leg at the knee and lift your right foot with your hands so that you can place it on top of the left leg. The right toes should be positioned at the underside of the left knee. Don't strain to attain this perfectly the first time. The position limbers up ankle and leg muscles, relieving tension and permitting a relaxed and balanced posture. It is a posture favored for meditation because it tends to relax the entire nervous system and the mind. Its benefits will be lost in tonight's exercise if perfection is sought. Come only as close to this position as you can comfortably do so.

A one minute period of relaxed meditation is enjoyed with all participants listening to the “silence.” It is ended with the chanting of the universal sound, “OM.” It is sounded three times, and then all rise and seat themselves in their chairs.

Step 2 The host prepares for Step 3, as this Step is being implemented. All now describe what sounds were heard during meditation. There may have been some ob-

vious and strong intrusions such as traffic, a dog barking, a plane, children, coughing, a clock. Or the silence may have had only very subtle intruders such as human breathing, digestion, the shifting of bodies, distant sounds, curtains on the breeze, or other weather or outdoor noises. How about the sounds of our body? Did anybody "hear" in extra-auditory areas?

Step 3 The host passes around one item to be identified by smell. It is a flavoring or an unrecognizable sample or raw vegetable or some other material with a subtle odor. The host also passes around two items to be identified by taste. Each person's eyes are closed as he smells the one object and takes a pinch of each of the other two items for applications to the tongue. In preparing the latter taste items, the host may use one, two or three ingredients, separately or combined. These might include sugar and salt, cinnamon and pepper, etc. Nobody does any identifying until all have had their smell and taste experiences. Then each is asked to identify all three in turn by the host, who finally divulges the nature of the ingredients.

Step 4 Body control is the subject of the next exercise. The group pairs off. Each person has a partner to administer the exercises. He then in turn administers them to his partner. All pairs may work simultaneously.

First, one member of each couple stands with his back to a wall. Each partner pretends to thrust his hands (clasped in prayer fashion) into the face of each standee, but his hands part at the critical moment and slap against the wall. How many times must this be done before a natural blink—the reaction of the autonomous nervous system—can be controlled?

Second, each partner first instructs each standee to stand with his right side to the wall and his right wrist pressing outward to the wall. This strongly exerted pressure is maintained for 60 seconds. A second command is then given: "Face me, and stand at attention." Was the standee aware that his right arm had a tendency to float upward and was he able to correct this quickly?

Third, each partner faces his standee and requests him to stand stationary. Each partner leans left, right and backwards, maintaining a stiff body to enhance the illusion. Does each standee waver?

Fourth, each partner asks his standee to stand on one foot for as long as he can without losing his balance.

This is now repeated with the eyes tightly closed. Did this make only a slight difference or a decided difference? The partners change roles and the exercises are repeated.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. Step 4 results are compared. Other ideas for similar tests of body perception are suggested and tried. . . . Several guests are to be invited to join the group for the next session. The purpose is to experience an interaction which the group will find valuable. This is explained in more detail on the next page. However, the group needs to decide now who will be invited and who will do the inviting. It is preferable that there be some basic differences between the guests' backgrounds and the group's—educational, socio-economic, age, etc. Aim at from three to six guests, but no more than the group itself totals. They can be friends, another group in another part of town or in a nearby town, members of a P.T.A., a "Y" or church-affiliated group, etc. Drawing materials and musical selections will be needed.

Evening No. 9

"The Feelings of Strangers"

The greatest problems that have confronted man can be traced to difficulties in communication. Today communications gaps, generation gaps and credibility gaps are featured in many discussions.

Expanded awareness helps to close gaps. More information is received by an aware person, less separateness and greater oneness is felt by an aware person and, from this oneness, love and understanding come to an aware person.

Tonight our guests will be able to observe, participate if they wish and react to what they see. The group may

obtain some valuable information about itself in the process.

Procedure

Step 1 When all have arrived and been seated, the guests are introduced, everybody in the circle, guests and participants alike, giving their names and occupations. Then the guests are asked if they have any idea at all what the purposes of the group are, just what activities the group engages in. Each guest is permitted to comment, with probably widely differing concepts of awareness, sensitivity and creativity. The members then describe the activities that have taken place and some of the more remarkable or memorable events and happenings.

Step 2 The host explains to the guests that the group would like to get some feedback from them on its sensitivity to strangers. They are asked to be judges as to the accuracy of the idea which members have of the real state of their inner worlds.

The participants are properly blindfolded, so that they cannot even see down the sides of their noses, and then told to pretend that they are blind men who can judge character only from the sound and inflections of voices. Each guest goes into a separate corner, or preferably a different room to "hold court." One by one, the blindfolded participants are led by the host or leader to approach the guests, without knowing which guest they are confronting. The leader leaves each participant with a guest, to ask for help, or to ask a question which will require a revealing answer in the tone of voice. "Do you have children? Are you married? Do you like gardening?" "Can you help me to find a seat in this room? Can you explain where things are in this house?" Participants have to listen carefully to the vibrations and timbre of the replies as if they were music; as if they were keys to self. Can each detect a yearning for communication? Gentleness? Sexual virility? Is there compassion and understanding in that music? How does the music of the voice affect each participant?

From the tone of voice, each participant tells each guest with whom he's communicating what he feels in the voice. He might say, "I think you are a warm-hearted person; I sense emotional feeling"; or, "You are a controlled person"; or, "I feel that you are generous"; or, "you are distant and remote; conservative and hard to

know"; or, "you are soft and sensitive"; or, "hard and businesslike; toughminded," or "weak; you like to help; you are embarrassed"; or, "you are shy and introverted; outgoing; musical; harsh in judgment of others"; or, "forgiving; you are profound and deep"; etc.

The guests are asked to keep a scorepad and, without divulging it to anyone, to give a mark from 1 to 5 for accuracy, depending on how close they think the statement is to their inner world. A 5 is for all direct hits; a 1 is for almost nothing correct; 2 is for one or two hits; 3 is for about 50 per cent accuracy; 4 is for about 75 per cent correct.

After two minutes, each participant is taken to another guest in another room and the same assessments of the voice vibrations, and the accuracy of the statements, are made. This is repeated until all the guests have "judged" all participants' ability to sense their inner selves.

Step 3 A circle is formed and the scores are totaled by each guest's reading out his scores when the name of each participant is called out. The one with the highest score may be considered, at least temporarily, the most sensitive to inner worlds revealed by voice patterns and auditory stimuli.

Step 4 The host plays part of a musical recording in which a definite mood is created. Participants sit quietly, reflecting on the inner feelings generated by the music. After five to ten minutes, the host walks around and silently gives each person a flower to hold; the music is stopped and all comment on their feelings. A second and contrasting selection is played and the discussion is repeated. Has there been a readier flow of feeling this time? More to tell about? What effect did the flower produce?

Step 5 A large sheet of drawing paper is created by taping together a number of smaller sheets. This time, when the music is played, each participant gets up and draws a small part of what will eventually be a group drawing. Each person, including the guests, adds a little to what has been done before. When all have added their contributions, a halt is called to discuss whether the piece of art is complete or still needs work. If it does, then another round is started. If at any time one participant feels it is complete and the next in turn agrees, then the group effort is ended. Overworking the painting should be avoided. The work is discussed from the point of view of the effect of the music, the meaning of the work itself,

and the difference between individual members' contributions.

Step 6 A group story is told. One member starts with a sentence or two, stopping in the middle of an uncompleted thought or sentence, and the next person in the circle continues the story. The action is fast. The story is somewhat disjointed. Everyone tries to keep the story from ending with himself. It ends only when it seems appropriate or after it has made the rounds three times.

Step 7 Refreshments are served. The group discusses any significance in the story, various directions it may have taken and why. The host thanks the guests for coming and invites them to join in a minute of relaxed silence with the group. Members meditate on love and radiate a feeling of oneness toward the visitors. The Evening ends. . . . The group art is brought to the next meeting.

Evening No. 10

"We Predict"

The presence of guests at the last Evening will be a factor in this Evening's exercises. The experience will be analyzed from several directions, and a follow-up event that may occur as a result will be described and predicted.

To do this one must understand how the group is in itself a social phenomenon of the times and part of a national trend in the United States with the advent of the 1970s. We are witnessing a newly motivated surge in the quest for a fuller life. Motivated in past decades largely by a desire for material betterment, the quest today is motivated by an additional desire for betterment in a non-material sense.

What is nonmaterial betterment? To some it is a spiritual betterment. To others it is integration of the personality. Still others seek an expanded consciousness and to activate more of their human potential.

This search for nonmaterial betterment certainly existed before the 1970s. We saw it in organized religions and in psychotherapy. We also saw it, if we looked hard enough, in the interest in psychedelic drugs. There was a scattered interest in yoga and in Eastern religions that encouraged identification with a superconsciousness which transcended the self and materiality.

Today, organized religions are struggling against growing apathy and disinterest. Psychotherapy is awakening to a new dimension and encompassing metaphysical areas once considered a professional no-man's-land. LSD users are re-turning-on to what they have found to be a one-way street to nowhere. And the scattered interest in the transcendental experiences of Eastern religions has become a new way of life.

Encounter groups, "T" groups, sensitivity workshops and awareness sessions being held all over the country start out with limited goals, but almost always extend these goals once the fruits have been tasted. These diversified quests move closer and closer to a mainstream of searching for spiritual truths, for an understanding of life beyond our present ability in the language and methods of science, and for the application of that understanding to daily life.

That is where we are tonight, and, as we reach the halfway point in these sensory and extrasensory Evenings, we should find it an appropriate moment to examine the group's place in this unfolding scene within man's everlasting search for truth.

Procedure

Step 1 The group reexamines the cooperative piece of art created at the last meeting. Can each member identify the portions he contributed? Can the parts that were contributed by the guests be identified? Is there any noticeable difference in the nature of their contribution? How about the cooperative story—was their participation spontaneous? Did it show more or less continuity than the members' contributions? Did the guests understand that music can affect the central nervous system to create moods and that art can offer the artist new awareness of himself? The group discusses individual feelings about the presence of the guests. What impression did each have of the relative interest in and acceptance of themselves by

the guests? Was there any telepathic radiation of fear or hostility? Of love and unity?

Step 2 Volunteers assume the role of each of the guests. They move their chairs to the center of the room. There is a moment of silence as each meditates on the personality role he is about to play. Then the volunteers enact a theoretical discussion between the guests about the group experience. The discussion lasts from five to ten minutes, with each "guest" explaining his reactions and impressions to the others. The group then analyzes any new aspects of the guests' presence brought out in this presentation.

Step 3 If the guests symbolized all of society, what aspirations would the group have for them? The answers would, of course, depend on the specific situation, but it would be valid for members to suggest such aspirations as greater ease in being with others, a feeling of oneness, an improved self-image, a more motivated effort for growth, greater acceptance of nonconventional paths to growth, a more spiritually-directed search, etc.

Step 4 To which of the suggested aspirations would the guests be most receptive? The group can now support the guests in their progress toward such an aspiration. A deep relaxation session is conducted by a member of the group, going from toes to neck in his suggestions for muscle release and heaviness. Once all are in as deep a state of total relaxation as possible, the leader suggests that each visualize the guests in a group activity aimed in the direction discussed (greater ease in being with others, etc.). Vivid visualization of serenity, success, good health and spiritual growth surrounds the image. The leader ends the session in a minute or two with suggestions of personal regeneration and well-being for members of the group and the usual count of one, two, three!

Step 5 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on what visualization actually does. What action or event might be predicted as a result of this visualization? Inquiries about forming a group, or for more information about a particular activity, or . . . ? Also discussed: Does the group wish for itself what it wishes for the rest of mankind, via the guest symbolism? . . . Materials to color the room lighting are needed for next time—transparent colored plastic from arts and crafts shops, or any translucent materials. An overhead projector would facilitate things.

Evening No. 11

“Chromatic Awareness”

Color has been described as not only a wave length of light but a wave length of life itself. Whether we are bathed in sunshine or a mile deep in the blackness of a coal mine, we are surrounded by color, for life itself is a source of chromatic radiation.

Color therapy—healing by exposure to certain colors—has been practiced successfully for many years. We all react to colors in different ways, depending on our personality and needs. Introverts usually seek neutral shades of blue and green or cool inconspicuous grays, while their extroverted colleagues may favor bright reds, oranges, and yellows. In between are individuals who contain both tendencies and combine their color preferences in many ways.

The clothes we wear, the houses we live in, the furnishings we enjoy, even the food we consume, attract us and affect us by the chromatic light they reflect. The color of the toothbrush we use, of the car we drive, and of the hair of the person that we are attracted to, tells us something about ourselves. However, few people know the language of color and its sensory implications.

If three beams of theatrical lighting—red-orange, green and blue—are thrown upon a screen, they combine to make a white light. These are the light primaries. They work, when combined, toward a lighter color than their components.

The pigment primaries used by artists are crimson-red, yellow and blue. When these are superimposed on one another they produce black (or a neutral black-green-gray).

The eye is constantly interpreting color to the mind. Its ability to discern color nuances varies with individuals.

Just as some individuals are unable to detect major color differences and are said to be color-blind, other individuals are especially sensitive to color. Often the color-blind never realize what they are missing, and the color-sensitive never realize what it is they are sensitive to.

This evening we will live with color and focus our awareness on its psychic and physiological effects.

Procedure

Step 1 Take two white cards. On one draw a large green elephant. On the second, place a small black dot. Each person looks at his green elephant for thirty seconds, and then immediately stares at the dot on the other card; the elephant then reappears there—but this time it is pink. This effect is called the afterimage. Why does this afterimage appear in a complementary, or opposite, color of the spectrum?

Step 2 Everybody gathers at one end of the room. At the other end are placed two red objects (ping-pong balls, or paper wads), exactly the same distance from the group and about a foot apart. Then a volunteer moves one an inch forward or back, hiding his action. He steps aside and asks how many discern a change and what that change was. The number of correct answers is noted. Then a similar blue object is substituted for one of the red objects. Again the distance is altered and correct answers noted. More people should be able to judge the juxtaposition of objects of the same color, but a color with more luminosity, like red in this case, usually *appears* larger and, therefore, closer.

Step 3 A bathroom or closet is used for this next activity. This small room is lighted with color by placing a translucent colored material over the light fixture. A projector can also be used. Do not use colored eye coverings as the entire face, neck and hands should be exposed to the color. As many as possible of the following colors are used: red, orange, yellow, green, blue and violet. Participants enter the room one at a time and stand in silence for up to thirty seconds, noting and analyzing the effect on their emotions. Is it stimulating, or depressing? They return and make notes on their reactions. The procedure is repeated for each color. When this is completed, each participant describes the effect of the colors on him, referring to the notes made. These are then compared to

the data supplied in Part II, Evening No. 13, if that evening was experienced by the group.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Discussion.

Evening No. 12

"The Power of Touch"

Self-made prisons in present-day society confine millions of hands. Don't-touch-this and don't-touch-that restrictions are placed on us even before we can understand the words.

Fear of breaking, fear of burning, fear of touching what we are not supposed to touch continues in adulthood and shuts us off from a world of touch experiences. In fact, people leave this world never knowing the feel of a rose petal, of long flowing hair, of feathers, of cork.

At an elementary school in a New York City suburb, a portion of the wall where students lined up waiting to be served in a cafeteria became constantly soiled and scratched by impatient hands. Instead of putting up a "don't" sign, the school principal had a bulletin board erected with a number of differently textured materials attached to it. It was a "Touch Me" board.

Tonight will be a "Touch Me" Evening.

Procedure

Step 1 Enough clothing is removed to permit each individual the contact of his hands with his own body as freely as possible, while still leaving him feeling comfortable. Allow about fifteen to thirty seconds for each of the following, for all participants:

Place both hands over your face, closing your eyes and feeling the skin of your face. Deliberately sense the looseness of the folds and tightness of the cheekbones and nose.

Place both hands over the face of the person next to you, in turn. Feel the face, feel the *feel* of the hands.

Place both hands on your own neck. Feel the contours of the neck.

Slap your left forearm a number of times with your right hand. Now slap your right forearm with your left hand.

Feel the hardness or softness of the forearm. Feel the tingle caused by the slapping.

Slap your left thigh and then your right thigh.

Turn to another person. Gently slap the back of his neck, slap the shoulders repeatedly, the back, working down the buttocks and the backs of the legs. Then turn and let yourself be slapped this way.

Now both face each other and "frisk" each other as if looking for hidden objects.

This should be done between men and women as well as between members of the same sex. The motivation is for a higher level of sensory awareness, and should be understood as such by all participants.

Step 2 Participants circulate and feel each other breathing. The hands become stethoscopes, as each partner breathes deeply and slowly. Feel the rib cage expand; feel the stomach movement; feel the back.

Step 3 Participants are seated. A volunteer stands facing the wall. He waits until he can feel the approach of two hands. He says "Now!" He tries to determine how far the fingers are from his body, and whose fingers they are.

Step 4 Participants replace their clothing. All are instructed to go outside and feel five different things—three with their hands, two in some other way. All return and describe what they felt. How hard was the hardest material? What was the most nonmaterial feeling of touch experienced? The wind? The night?

Step 5 All are blindfolded. The host brings out two garments, a dress and a shirt, say, both with color, perhaps with a design. The garments are passed for each to feel and try to sense what they are—the materials, the colors and whether they're of solid colors or of particular designs. The garments are removed. Participants remove blindfolds. Each describes what he felt. The garments are then returned for participants to see.

Step 6 Participants line up and hold their hands out palm up. A leader walks along the line and holds his hands about two inches over each pair of hands, palms down. Can anything be felt moving or radiating between the hands besides heat? Does one person's hands tingle? The person at the end of the line then follows the leader

down the line, and then the next person, until all have experienced in turn the sensations which emanate from different hands.

Step 7 Refreshments. Discussion centers on the exhilaration felt through touch and touching. Is there an energy in hands? Might one person transmit energy to another by "the laying on of hands"? Does one person emit more energy from the hands than another?

Evening No. 13

"In Touch with the Future"

Great men throughout history have used prophets and astrologers as advisors in times of decision. Today, in America, names such as Jeane Dixon and Irene Hughes have become bywords; their predictions are read each year in books and newspaper columns. The late Edgar Cayce's hundreds of predictions covering the rest of this century have made him the Nostradamus of our time. In Europe and elsewhere around the world, prophecy is even more common.

These psychics are the first to insist that we all have this ability. Like anything else, it needs to be used to be developed. Irene Hughes has used hers since the age of four when she found she "knew" certain things were going to happen. She was willing to continue to explore this challenge rather than to relinquish her extrasensory ability for sensory conformity. Edgar Cayce fell asleep on his school textbook when he should have been studying. To the astonishment of his angry father, who then tested him, young Edgar could repeat verbatim any random page from the book.

The psychic prophet is not necessarily an astrologist. He may ask for a birth date, but this can be merely to relate

better to a person he is "reading." A rapport is helpful in tuning in to a person's karma or future.

Another tool of importance to the psychic can be some object that will help divert the conscious mind so that its thoughts do not block out the delicate message picked up by the superconscious mind. The so-called crystal ball can be anything but crystal and far from a ball. A famous psychic on Long Island, known as the Egg Lady, uses the white of an egg. Many tea-leaf readers are not familiar with the meanings of the leaf patterns but use them as diverters of the conscious mind.

Some psychics are not able to divert their conscious mind this easily. They must go into a deep trancelike state before their psychic messages can be seen or heard. Edgar Cayce's trances, which he could enter instantly, gave him the appellation, "The Sleeping Prophet."

This trance is, of course, a state of self-hypnosis; we can all induce it to one degree or another, quickly and safely.

This evening we'll all become prophets—to some extent. At least, we will be expanding our awareness in the direction of that universal storehouse of information which it is believed we all have the ability to tap.

Procedure

Step 1 "Tomorrow" is a magical word. It brims with promise. The group discusses tomorrow. What will happen in the lives of participants when they go home after this Evening, and wake up tomorrow morning? First, each person describes what tomorrow will probably have in store for him. What will he eat for breakfast, what will happen at work, or at home, etc? Instructions for Step 2 should be read before beginning this.

Step 2 As each person listens to the others, he is aware of mental images in his own mind created by the speaker. Do these images include any details not mentioned by the speaker? If so, jot them down. When all the speakers have concluded, each person tells of his "glimpses." Tomorrow he will check those that actually take place and report back at the next meeting. Did one participant really lose three golf balls? Did another actually meet a long lost friend? Did a dish actually break? And so forth.

Step 3 Sensitivity is further sharpened by the "Magnetized Water" test. Ten numbered glasses of water are placed in a row a few inches apart on the dining-room

or kitchen table. A volunteer remains behind as all leave. The volunteer "magnetizes" one of the glasses by placing both hands over and around it. Everybody returns and tries to sense what glass has been "magnetized." Each person writes down the name of the volunteer and the number of the glass. All leave again. The volunteer changes the water in the glass he magnetized. He rejoins the group. A second volunteer goes through the same procedure. When a number of volunteers have done this and the group has attempted to detect the results, the participants report on their findings and the volunteers disclose the correct numbers of the glasses they "magnetized." Correct "hits" are tallied. The odds are less than even for each person to have one "hit," providing there have been fewer than ten volunteers. Mathematical odds for the group as a whole can be computed as follows: Total number of "hits" likely = number of participants $\times$ number of volunteers $\div$ 10.

Step 4 The above exercise is repeated with several changes. Participants in another room visualize, in advance, the glasses and the volunteers going in one by one to "magnetize" a particular glass. Each person writes down the number of the glass he "predicts" will be magnetized by each volunteer. There is a minute of silence to permit this visualization to be accomplished. The volunteers then go in singly to magnetize one glass each. The participants do not follow them. The volunteers reveal the right answers. Again a tally is made of "hits." Are these seriously down from Step 3? Are they still above the laws of probability?

Step 5 A group member who has been relatively successful in reaching a deep state of relaxation, and in autosuggestion, volunteers to answer questions from other members while he is in a state of self-hypnosis. He sits in the center of the room. It may be helpful for him to fix his attention on one of the water glasses just used but freshly filled. He relaxes. He suggests to himself that "the veils of time are lifted." He announces to the group when he is "ready." Members ask specific questions about problems or decisions facing them. He answers automatically, whatever thoughts come, even if they do not make sense or are already understood. It is best to limit this to ten minutes as it can be tiring. The self-hypnotist ends the session with suggestions of renewed energy and well-being, and a count of one, two, three!

Step 6 Refreshments. The members discuss the answers supplied by the self-hypnotized subject. Do they appear to have elements in them that go beyond the apparent knowledge of the subject? Was symbolism used? If so, what was the meaning to the member concerned?

Evening No. 14

"Manners and Mannerisms"

Increased awareness brings with it some pains as well as pleasure. In effect, these are growing pains, and as such are well worth having in the long run.

What loss is it, really, if one no longer enjoys short-order cooking, when the enjoyment of well-prepared food is enhanced manyfold? What loss is it to be more aware of other people's shortcomings, if we are also more aware of their motivations and levels of development?

This evening we will experience these growing pains through the milieu of psychodrama. To relieve them will be to relieve them. It is not helpful to awareness and growth to harbor resentment toward our fellow men for that which grates against our sensitivities. It is more healthful to air these sources of friction; this should eliminate not only the harboring but very likely the source also.

The results of tonight's experiences will be to readjust to our growing sensitivities and to "clear the air" for an even more harmonious climate in group activities.

Procedure

Step 1 Manners reveal how sensitive we are to our fellow man. The way we eat reveals something about the level of consciousness we have attained. If we could see ourselves on a closed-circuit TV, we would probably be mortified. The group will now perform for a "closed-circuit TV" by simulating a dinner.

Half the group gathers around the dining table. The host puts out knives, forks and spoons, salt and pepper,

platters simulating food and any other "props" that will aid the psychodrama. The other half watches the performance, being careful to note all of the fractures to social propriety that are enacted. Those "on camera" begin with soup. Time is not accelerated. Go through the main course and a beverage. Carry on a discussion about other matters. But be sure to expose such common violations as:

Elbows pointed at a neighbor's ribs;

Using a fork as a shovel;

Blowing smoke in another's face;

Sucking soup;

Holding one's fork like an ice pick;

Chewing with one's mouth open;

Talking while chewing;

Eating with one's fingers;

Belching;

Reaching across someone's plate;

Monopolizing the conversation;

Speaking loudly;

Blowing one's nose at the table;

and any other social ineptitudes. No attempt is made to pin anything on anybody. If the shoe fits, somebody will wear it. The psychodrama is interrupted by members of the audience when they see a violation. They correct the violation verbally or approach the table and demonstrate the right way to perform whatever was mishandled.

Step 2 All return to their seats. Before a discussion of Step 1 begins, each person decides to impersonate another member secretly. He sits in the same posture, talks in the same way, says the kinds of things he thinks that person might say. The discussion centers on the acting in Step 1. Were any obvious violations omitted? How did the character so-and-so played affect me ("me" being the person imitated in this new psychodrama)? After five to ten minutes of this new psychodrama, everybody rises and holds hands. A group handshake takes place, by all moving forward with hands reaching to the center until all can touch hands.

Step 3 Refreshments are served. A discussion follows in a positive vein. Who has noticed what about whom in the way of exceptional consideration, good taste and demeanor in their social behavior? Let compliments fly, even between husbands and wives!

Step 4 Did any predictions come true since the last meeting? Descriptions and remarks.

Evening No. 15

“Love and Affection”

Love is a universal principle not yet fully understood by man. In fact, love is an enigma. We see the love principle behind the procreation of life, yet life can be procreated by lust and by artificial insemination. The same love can be bestial in humans and beautiful in beasts.

We see this love principle in reverse when anger and hate chronically experienced build up toxins that can end life in the hater. Yet, many people who appear cold and loveless live to a ripe old age.

Experiments have shown that children denied their share of parental love and affection can be severely stunted in their growth to the point of dwarfism despite a full and balanced diet.

Plants are now thought to respond to love. (A controlled experiment on this will be conducted in Part IV.)

Many people find it difficult to express love and affection effectively. They are the ones who keep a certain amount of “distance” between themselves and others. They are hard to know. Or else, if they do mingle, theirs is a superficial way, a shallow friendship that masks their actual inner separation.

Why do people often find it difficult to express love? Some have been deprived of love themselves and cannot express it to others until it is expressed to them. This can lead to an increasing cycle of nonlove. Some do not love themselves and cannot demonstrate affection to others until they attain a more acceptable self-image. Some find expressions of love and affection to be synonymous with a sexual approach, therefore laying themselves open to misunderstandings with members of the same sex, and guilt with members of the opposite sex. Some think it to be a

sign of weakness to express love and affection, a feminine trait rather than a masculine one. Still, to love and to be loved is a dominant desire in every human. Although the emotion is usually expressed by the one word "love," traditionally there are three distinct meanings. In Part IV we will discuss seven different kinds of love, but tonight we'll stick to simpler interpretations. The Greeks had separate words for three kinds of love.

Eros. This is the love expressed through passion and sexual union. It is a universal love, but demonstrated by sensual means. The words "erotic" and "eroticism" refer to this sexual appetite as a manifestation of this love.

Phileo. This is a brotherly type of love. It is a deep affection or attachment for another person such as parent has for child. It can also be a fondness for an animal or for a pursuit (philosophy = love of wisdom, philanthropy = love of man). Filial affection is not only for brothers.

Agape. This is a spiritual love. It is free of personal and emotional entanglements. It flows through all life. It is a kinship exemplified by respect and esteem. It is manifested in human relations by mutual cooperation and understanding. It is the love we direct to the universal source of being, by whatever name we call it, and which is returned to us in a surge of peace and well-being that transcends all known bliss and passes all understanding.

Tonight we love.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, a man and a woman volunteer to express erotic love to each other by kissing and embracing. An engaged or married couple, or a couple who are dating demonstrate their love and affection in the context of *eros*.

Step 2 The group now demonstrates its brotherly love. All rise and mingle and embrace in the European fashion with whomever they wish. This is a hug with heads together, first touching one cheek and then the other. The Muslims have an even greater filial bear-hug where the arms encircle the other person, sometimes with mutual back-slapping. All return to their seats after several minutes of this demonstration.

Step 3 The group will now perform a variation of the falling exercise. Instead of the person in the center falling backwards, being caught and merely returned to an up-

right position, the person who is caught is passed around the circle once, then lifted to a horizontal position by several people before being returned to an upright position. It is advised that the circle be tighter as this is done; then, when the person is lifted, the circle breaks to allow space for that. Three or four people should be involved in the lifting so as to spread the burden; one person should support the neck and head gently. They may want to avoid the awkward task of placing the person back on his feet and instead carry the person to an open carpet or a couch and place him down gently in a horizontal position. The circle is then formed again, and each has a turn at giving himself or herself to the group.

Step 4 This is an optional step, depending on whether there is a house pet available such as a dog, cat or bird. The group relaxes and concentrates on the pet, which should be observable in the room. The group then feels love toward the pet: that is, love as for an equal entity of life. This love contains no "looking down"; it is full of admiration and respect. How does the dog, cat or bird react to this?

Step 5 Each person takes a turn at standing in the center of the room. He is blindfolded. Participants come up one at a time and express their love in any way that they wish. This can be by a kind word, a caress, a kiss, a hug or any other demonstration of affection and esteem that they feel like expressing at the moment.

Step 6 On completion of this, there is a minute or two of relaxed, meditative silence, in which all members express love, in their thoughtfulness and *agape* for the group, and for being alive, directing this at the universal source of being.

Step 7 Refreshments are served in silence. There is no talking between members as the vibrations of love continue until all silently depart.

Evening No. 16

“The Human Aura”

Life gives out radiations. Man's brain waves can be measured a number of feet away. Sensitive cameras can “see in the dark” and photograph “the past” in the form of a man even after he has left the room. Infrared detectors are being used to locate underground springs, to take ghostly photos of planes an hour after they have left the runway and to detect trouble areas in the human body.

Animals can often detect human emanations of which most of us are not aware. They sense a person's love or fear. An intuitive person can also sense these vibrations in another. Children respond to a person's magnetic personality or atmosphere.

Some sensitive people can actually see another person's emanations. They see them as an aura of light surrounding the person. The brain of a sensitive person like this has the capacity to transform these emanations of energy to a visible color range. Many who do not know they have this capacity are able to develop it to where they can at least begin to see auras. Master painters developed this “sight” and often surrounded subjects with a halo, the most luminous portion of the total body aura.

This now-famous story is told of a person who could always see auras. One afternoon this individual was waiting for an elevator after an appointment in an office building. When the door opened, the person looked at the people inside and could see no auras. The individual was too shocked to enter; the door closed, and the elevator crashed, killing the occupants.

One of the present authors, who trains others to see auras, always knows when someone is about to die because his or her aura will change to a dark gray several days beforehand.

The intensity of a person's aura depends on the intensity of his attitudes, thoughts and emotions. The color of a person's aura depends on the quality of those attitudes, thoughts and emotions. Clues to the meanings of various colors can be obtained from the descriptions supplied in Part II, Evening 13.

The colors of the aura are rarely still. Rather, they present an ever-changing pattern of colors as the emotions change and the physical condition of the body is affected. Usually, however, there is one dominant background of color that indicates basic character or level of growth.

Possibly one or two will begin to see auras tonight. All of us will try. For those who continue to try, rewards will come later. We must be careful not to try too hard, as straining to see them with our physical eyes will not help. Auras, like colors, are seen by the mind, not the eye.

Procedure

Step 1 A fur piece or wool coat is brought out by the hostess or a participant. Everyone agrees on its dominant color. Then a second look is taken. Is there a cast to the dominant color? A blue fox is naturally dark brown, but many can also see a bluish cast. Wild mink are more valuable if they have this bluish cast. Ranch mink are bred to enhance these casts. Hence, the many colorful names to describe mink with only slight color gradations. Wool, too, has a cast—a secondary color expression that comes to the eyes after a few moments of looking. Don't focus on a single point of the garment but allow the eye to encompass the whole garment by looking just a little beyond it.

Step 2 The lights are turned out. All shades are drawn. Reflected light is shut out. The room is made as dark as possible. Eyes are permitted to grow accustomed to the darkness. Each then attempts to see the other in the dark. Even if the darkness is close to total, *something* is seen. What is it? Can you see an area where a person is? If you look at the area, it can become an aura. Again, do not focus the eyes at a particular point, but encompass the whole body visually by looking slightly past it. Those who see something should describe it to the others.

Step 3 The lighting is restored to half of its normal intensity. One or two indirect sources can provide a dim light. Again the group looks at each other, or rather past

each other. Are the same areas or casts visible now? Describe what you see to the group.

Step 4 Full lighting is restored and the exercise repeated. Expect to see a cast. What color is the cast and what person has it? Does anyone else see the same hue on that person?

Step 5 Seeing auras is less a manifestation of an extra-sensitive eye than it is a manifestation of an extra-sensitive person. This overall sensitivity can come much more surely through periods of meditative attunement than through the exercises in Steps 1 through 4. The group now conducts the longest period of meditation yet tried—five full minutes of quiet listening and resonating to universal vibrations. A leader begins it and ends it with an agreed signal.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. The group discusses the colors that may have been seen and how these may relate to what they already know about the people associated now with these colors, using the color principles outlined in Part II, Evening 13.

Evening No. 17

“Personality Radar”

When our antennae are up to receive impressions about people, we consciously or unconsciously use many sources of information. Facial expressions, vocabulary, intonation, stance, posture, mannerisms are but a few.

Today, radar is a source of vital information for pilots when other sources, such as direct line of sight, are not practical. Radar bounces energy off distant objects and detects its return.

This same principle can be a valuable asset in understanding people. If we permit a person to bounce his thoughts off an object, we can find out things about that person. We must be aware of what returns.

This evening's exercise has a dual purpose: first, it per-

mits us to identify ourselves more readily with an object or a person—to be able to get out of ourselves and into some other thing or body; second, it permits us to strengthen the mind in order to penetrate the inner worlds of others.

Procedure

Step 1 A cup of steaming-hot black coffee is placed on a small table or directly on the floor in the middle of the group. Each person in turn tells how he feels about that cup of coffee. He expresses *one* idea. That idea might have to do with the relaxation it brings and how that relaxation permits him to converse more freely. To another it may provide a stimulating feeling or may be a psychological prop like a cigarette in the hand, or a knocking-off from work. There are all sorts of possible reactions to a simple cup of coffee. It can be enlightening for the group to find out how the internal consciousness of other people identifies with such a simple object. When all have expressed their thoughts about the cup of coffee, the group analyzes these thoughts. What similarities are there among the personalities of the participants who expressed similar thoughts? Does a unique thought provide any insight into the personality or internal consciousness of its originator? What do people really mean when they say, "Would you like to have a cup of coffee?" (Perhaps this is merely an opening gambit for more communication, as when a mother asks a child, "How was school today?" She really seeks to learn more about him.)

Step 2 The exercise is repeated with a dictionary. How does each participant identify with that dictionary in the center of the room? For some the dictionary enshrines all the thoughts of men throughout history who have coined words in order to describe human experience. For others it is a settler of arguments on the meaning of words, or a symbol of authority, or a storehouse of knowledge, concepts and ideas. After an analysis of individual reactions, the group can discuss the relative merits of books per se. Do they take up where conversation and the spoken word end, or should they be a prerequisite to conversation?

In Ecclesiastes it is stated that knowledge which can be put in books is vanity. Yet, to others a book is the ultimate in communication; until words are put into action, via books, they have no life. Then again, Jesus never

wrote a book, yet there have been millions influenced by books on his life. This can lead into Step 3.

Step 3 A Bible is placed in the center of the room. Each reacts. How do the reactions to this "object" compare with those to the coffee? Is there greater depth of penetration into the object? Greater insight into the inner worlds of participants? The group may decide to bounce its thoughts off other objects.

Step 4 A volunteer becomes an object. He or she sits in the middle of the room on the floor or in a chair as the others seek to get inside his inner world and report what they find, and what it means to each personally. It will be natural for a volunteer to feel an impulse to put up a defensive shield (crossed legs and folded arms may signal this self-protective attitude). Full love and trust in the group must be attempted by the volunteer. This enhances the ability of all to identify psychically as well as intellectually, and is essential to the drawing of a meaningful experience from the exercise. If, after several volunteers have offered themselves, the group cannot obtain enough penetration to identify truly with a volunteer, it might help to repeat the "giving" exercise described in Step 3, Evening 15, Part III.

Step 5 The host gets an object which he places in a paper bag to conceal its form and nature. Participants close their eyes as he carries it in and places it on the floor in the center of the room, thus avoiding gaining clues from how he handles it. The above exercise is conducted again as all attempt to enter the object. Even if they cannot identify it, they describe what it means to them.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Does anybody comment on how much more aware they are of the texture and taste of cake, say, or the "feeling" of the cup of coffee?

*Evening No. 18***“ESP Game Night”**

This is strictly a night for fun wherein participants will have a choice of playing a number of typical party games. In all of the games that are suggested below, an element of guessing is present. This opens the door to the use of sensory and extrasensory awareness, and participants who have played all these games before the group started its Evenings together should be on the lookout for evidence of expertise beyond the normal.

Procedure

The participants decide whether all will play the same game at one time or whether different games will be set up and players will rotate. This will depend largely on the amount of equipment available. Refreshments are served whenever the host wishes. Before adjourning for the individual games to be played, the group relates any instances of exceptional “luck,” intuitive discernment, or just plain ESP which it can cite. Notes are made of the winners.

The games:

Chess

Checkers

Dominoes

Bridge

Charades

Hangman (See explanation below)

Battleships (See explanation below)

(Hangman is played by two people who take turns guessing a word that the other has in mind. The person **thinking** of the word writes down short blank lines for each letter, indicating the number of letters in the word. A record is kept of each letter guessed. A rightly guessed letter is inserted, by the person thinking of the

word, in its proper position. A wrong letter permits the person thinking of the word to draw a portion of the guesser's anatomy at the end of a simulated noose. The parts of the body correspond to the number of letters missed: if the guesser is correct before his body is hung, he wins.)

(Battleships is played on graph paper with opponents seated back to back. Each creates a game area 12 squares in each direction. The vertical rows are identified by letters across the top from left to right, A through L. The horizontal rows are identified by numbers down the left side 1 through 12. Each player is permitted a submarine (S), a destroyer (D) and a battleship (B). He places these letters in scattered areas of his diagram. Each of these vessels can shoot into an adjoining square. That is, if an S is located in C2, it could shoot into B1, B2, B3, C1, C3, D1, D2 or D3. An S, D, or B may move either N (up), S (down), E (right) or W (left) before or after they shoot. They may shoot before moving or after moving, but they must shoot every turn. They may stand still. A submarine moves only one square at a time. A destroyer must move two squares, and a battleship must move three squares. The object of the game is to hit all three of the opponents boats before he hits yours. Once a boat is hit it is out of the game. The one who moves first says, for instance, "I shoot with my submarine into D3 and move one to the north." He may or may not hit one of his opponent's boats, but his opponent now has a fix on one of his vessels. Each party draws a line on his own chart indicating where his own vessels move to.)

The next step is for the group to come together again in a circle and examine their results and scores. Significant results and consistent successes are discussed. . . . Participants are to review the past eighteen Evenings and devise an Evening each, similar to those they enjoyed the most and which they found to be most rewarding. These should be written down and brought to the next Evening. Originality, fun and reward are the key criteria. . . . Before going home one member is appointed to telephone each member of the group during the week to see how they are getting on with their own game and whether or not they need any help in getting it down on paper. The reason for this, the host explains, is not to check up on

them, but because, for many people, ideas begin to flow when they talk about them. Not everyone can create an awareness game out of the air. The caller's job is to get all to write down ideas which they think are significantly original before coming to the next meeting. The caller is not allowed to tell anyone the ideas of another member of the group, but if two members have exactly the same idea he should tell them both to invent a variant of it.

Evening No. 19

"Your Own Thing"

Much of the far-out look of young people today reveals a genuine attempt to express their inner personalities without society-imposed restrictions or inhibitions. On the other hand, much of it reveals an effort to look weird just to attract attention, or to rebel for rebellion's sake.

Self-expression leads to growth and expanded awareness. Those who stifle themselves for fear of criticism "pay the piper" in dis-ease and the stunted growth of personality and psyche. Those who express themselves unfold in health, beauty and human potential. They become unblocked channels through which creativity, intuition and inspiration can flow.

This evening we'll "do our own thing." We'll express the new, the untried, the original—events designed by participants of previous Evenings and aimed at expanding sensory and extrasensory awareness by means of ideas that have come to them as a result of these Evenings.

As a group, we know whether a game or exercise is right for us. We know intuitively whether or not it is aimed at the highest goals, with no thought of black magic or disrespect for human dignity or nonattunement to universal law.

Many activist sit-ins are inspired by feelings of impotence or ineffectiveness in creating changes. The demonstrator is often intent on the changing of others, and so

escapes the effort of changing himself. The sit-in can be a substitute ritual means of getting self-esteem without the necessity of the demonstrator working regularly on himself. Change is a human need which must be acknowledged. In these games, the group responsibility for change is encouraged without the individual smug self-righteousness which can result from interfering with the rights and lives of others. Society can only be effectively changed by groups from within, whose members seek valid experiences designed to melt barriers and hang-ups, and to reinforce self-esteem by confrontation with the self. Confrontation with the self is *the* ultimate radicalism.

These are the experiences that accelerate our powers and that men everywhere are hungry to enjoy in their search for truth and self-mastery. You can share this Evening's successes by appointing a recorder to write a brief account of what transpires and send this along with the written description prepared by the originator to the authors for further testing and possible use in future publications.

Procedure

Step 1 Each participant reads his description of a proposed game or event. The group asks questions, to clarify the goal of any games that are not totally understood.

Step 2 Each person votes for first, second and third choice in the games submitted. He may vote for his own. The ballots are counted by rating 3 for first, 2 for second and 1 for third. The highest scored game is played first, and so on down the line for as much time as there is available.

Step 3 Refreshments are served. . . . Plans for a picnic or covered-dish supper are discussed pursuant to the description on the next page.

Evening No. 20

“Sensing Nature’s Vibrations”

Man is all important to himself. In the everyday routine of job and home, he thinks of little else. Yet he is a relatively insignificant portion of the pulsating life on earth and of even less significance in the universe.

Awareness of the life around man and consciousness of the immensity of the universe is necessary to the overall concept of oneness. Preoccupation with the self emphasizes separateness and cuts one off in consciousness from the mainstream of energy and creative flow that the concept of oneness brings.

Consciousness of nature and its miracles places one in the universal mainstream and attracts all that is needed. Emerson put it this way: “A deep man believes in miracles, waits for them, believes in magic, believes that the evil eye can wither, that the heart’s blessing can heal; that love can exalt talent; can overcome all odds. From a great heart secret magnetisms flow incessantly to draw great events.”

Attunement with nature is the greatest awareness exercise ever devised by man. The goal of science centuries ago was to extend man’s senses inward and outward that he might commune more intimately with nature. But instead we have used science to separate us from nature and to consume her. Those who return to nature, at least in thoughts and consciousness, receive nature’s bounty instantly in return: peace, bliss, security, wisdom and love.

There’s a story of a poor man, who was walking down the street wondering where his next meal was coming from, when he saw a pile of rubbish. Thinking it might contain some scraps to ease his hunger, he searched

through it; seeing an old key he put it in his pocket, thinking it might be worth something some day. He continued to walk the streets looking for something to eat, little realizing he had the key to a large warehouse stocked with food.

We are like that poor man in that we still look for happiness in pointless ways because of our anxieties and fears and petty concerns. In reality, we have the key in our pocket. Nature holds enormous undiscovered powers waiting to be tapped by the ingenuity and imagination of man.

This evening, when we walk out into the great outdoors, we'll hold a different type of confrontation session. It is not between person and person. It is between person and nature. Each will make his own peace with nature. Each will listen and see and feel the extension of himself that envelopes the trees and the ground and the clouds and that reaches to the stars.

Procedure

Step 1 This is a picnic. Plans have been made since the last meeting as to where and how it would be held. If the weather is such as to make eating out of doors impractical, then perhaps arrangements can be made to eat indoors, and to go out to a local park or to the country later. Wherever the group dines, the same procedure outlined in Part I, Evening 20, Steps 1 through 4, should be followed.

Step 2 Outdoors. The group sits quietly together, listening to the silence and to the sounds of nature, taking in the sights and scents and touching the ground.

Step 3 Pairs walk off in various directions. The couples walk in silence, communicating nonverbally to each other when a desire to share is felt. They touch leaves and trees, stop to feel running water, look for patterns in stones and reflected light, examine a flower to know it inwardly, and experience the joy of attunement with it all. They return in fifteen to twenty minutes.

Step 4 The group members share their experiences verbally, describing what they have seen and felt. Some will be bursting to share in words; others will feel that all words seem inadequate.

Step 5 There is a final three minutes of silent meditation in a standing position. The group permits its combined consciousness to dwell on all mankind. Members see the

group as a symbol of man's search for a way toward nature in his own evolution. The group feels support for man in this effort. The session ends with a feeling of love for the universe, and the intoning three times of the universal O-O-O-M-M-M. (Pronounced Aa-ah-ooh-uuh-mmmn all in one sound, by saying the sound Aa-ah in the back of the throat continuously and slowly shaping the mouth into a pencil-point opening until the lips close firmly and the sound changes naturally by itself. The sound Aa-ah will continue in the throat itself as an ooom.)

PART IV

Metaphysical Games

INTRODUCTION: Metaphysical Awareness

In this Part are concentrated some of the most powerful life-changing activities known to man. They have come down through the ages in many forms and have recently enjoyed a resurgence of study and interest by college students and the more adventuresome seekers of wisdom in all segments of society.

The forces that are being tapped by these activities are the unnamed, indescribable forces that defy time and distance; they pass through walls, bodies and supposedly impenetrable barriers and avoid detection by scales, meters and other measuring devices.

Yet these forces are there, and they are responsive to human thought. They affect matter. They change circumstances.

Man feels more comfortable when what he cannot see is given a name. This has become a world of the "virus," the "-ology," and "charisma." These unseen forces and energies are called by many names. One can take his pick: the life force, spirit, God, unusual energy, mind power, vibrations, the source of being, oneness, the infinite, the omnipresent.

At a recent seminar held at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, a discussion on Asian philosophy went from meditation to yoga, to Zen, to tantras, mantras and chakras, to astrology and parapsychology, to auras, to witchcraft, to the *I Ching* and finally to psychokinesis. In a way, this discussion stayed right on target. These were all aspects of metaphysics—beyond the realm of physics.

It is impossible to *be* beyond the realm of metaphysics. It goes as far as *being* and further. It is impossible to *be* out of its reach or scope in any conceivable way. The exercises in Parts I, II, and III, although aimed in specific directions, still use the metaphysical as well as the physical.

Psychology is metaphysical. The sensory and extrasensory powers of the mind are metaphysical. And anything we do to awaken the life force within us is metaphysical.

The difference between Part IV and what has gone before is that these twenty Evenings that lie ahead address themselves directly to this life force, to the extent that they reach beyond the known and into the unknown. They are largely spiritual experiences.

Yet these spiritual experiences can have very real and material results. They can bring participants greater wealth. They can transform personalities. They can produce "miraculous" cures. They can lead to the development of uncanny abilities, both physical and mental.

Those who have gone before you into these activities directed at the metaphysical find that motivation plays a vital role in the results. In fact, it *determines* the results. If the motive is just curiosity, the results are reflected by that motive and return in curious and meaningless forms. If the motive is disrespectful and in disbelief, the results will be negative, so as to reinforce that disrespect and disbelief. If the motive is greed rather than need, the results may appear bountiful but real inner needs will go unsatisfied and unfulfilled.

This is like the man who wanted to catch a mouse. He did not have any cheese so he clipped a picture of cheese and baited the mousetrap with it. In the morning he found the picture of a mouse.

When the motive is valid the results are valid. For you who seek wisdom, for you who seek to be a more effective channel through which the forces of creation may work, for you who dare to dream an "impossible" dream and accelerate the evolutionary process of the very atoms within yourself—prepare to experience a power beyond understanding and a brilliance beyond light.

Evening No. 1

“Healing Power”

Centuries ago, healing was an activity of the church. In areas of the world insulated from western ideas, healing is still in the domain of gurus, medicine men, kahunas and tribal chiefs.

There is evidence in the United States that healing may be welcomed back into some churches. The work of the Worrells of Baltimore, Oral Roberts, and other faith healers is becoming more accepted by the churchgoing public, and healing prayer groups are being formed everywhere.

The concept behind spiritual healing is difficult to accept for many people. That is partly because it often requires one to acknowledge that he is the cause of his own physical problem—that the virus, germ or “bug” is there because he attracted it or at least offered no resistance to it. Nobody likes to be blamed for anything.

The air is teeming with all varieties of these tiny creatures, whether we are healthy or sick. When we lower our resistance to them it is little wonder that they accept the invitation.

What is this resistance? Actually, it can be regarded as a naturally healthy state. Lessen this healthy state in any area of the body and it becomes a potential breeding ground for these bacteriological “vultures.”

The trick is to maintain a naturally healthy state. The key here is that it is natural to be healthy, unnatural to be sick. Nature would have us healthy. Nature is constantly renewing, regenerating and rejuvenating. “Let nature take its course” is behind much of the medical advice we get, and true physicians are the first to give credit to nature’s healing powers.

But we interfere with nature. We subject our bodies to the gastric acids induced by worry that ulcerate the stomach lining. We burden our vital organs with the tenseness

and stiffness of fear, anxiety and insecurity. We undermine our body chemistry and cell growth with unnatural attitudes and negative thoughts.

Medicine is skilled at treating symptoms of disease. Relief and cure are almost always obtainable. But if the cause persists, the symptoms usually return. That is why "take a trip" or "get away for a while," is good medical advice. It leads to a renewal in the attitudes and thoughts of the person. That is often where the causes lie.

Fear of illness is one of the major causes of illness. Not only does the fear cause the tenseness and disease we are talking about, but, by our using our visual imaginations—our strongest creative energies—we tend to attract what we fear, if we think negatively. Lurid descriptions of diseases by well-meaning health and welfare organizations can impress suggestible people and cause them to misuse their imaginations in a way that can contribute to those very diseases.

Think health. Think vitality. Visualize yourself "the picture of" good health, brimming with vitality, and you contribute to *that* picture.

This evening we will try to take important steps to counteract the effects of the circumstances of daily living that underlie negative thoughts and feelings, that obstruct nature's healing powers. We'll attempt to permit the latter to flow more freely through us.

This will entail an admission to ourselves that we are usually the cause of our own poor health. It will entail a willingness to give up that cause. We must be willing to relinquish indignation, resentment and frustration, jealousy, envy and hatred. We must be willing to insulate ourselves from concern over what others will think of us. We must be willing to substitute patience and confidence for anxiety.

The reward for these "sacrifices" may well be a longer and healthier life.

Procedure

Step 1 The introduction to Part IV is read with the above. Participants discuss typical psychosomatic diseases and their probable causes, getting some clues from such popular remarks as, "He gives me a pain in the neck" . . . "Oh, my aching back" . . . "That galls me" . . . "I haven't got the heart to" . . . "I can't stomach him." . . .

Step 2 Participants discuss, freely and without self-

recrimination, any personal health problems they may have, offering their own ideas about possible causes. It is important at this time not to offer any comments on another's problems.

Step 3 A game of "Doctor" is played. Half of the participants are "patients," half "doctors." A patient and a doctor pair up. The patient goes off to a corner or private spot with the doctor and tells the doctor his troubles. These are not only health troubles, but other types of social, family or business troubles. This is a serious confidential chat. The doctor lends a sympathetic ear, making polite and friendly comments but offering no specific remedies. This is called nondirective counseling and is therapeutic in that it permits a person to "get it off his chest." The doctors and patients reverse roles and the process is repeated; however, different people are coupled together this time.

Step 4 An advanced relaxation exercise is enjoyed by the group with a leader reading the monologue that follows. A lighted candle is needed on the floor or table in the center of the room. At the end of the monologue each person holds a single image for a full thirty seconds. It is the image of himself completely healthy. If he has any health problem, there is no sign of it in this image. He sees himself going about his usual activities in tip-top health. He *knows* that holding this image in his mind can make it come to pass. Even if he enjoys good health now, it reinforces that good health. He ends the relaxation with joy and confidence. . . . Here is the advanced monologue for deep relaxation leading to a state of auto-suggestibility:

I fix my eyes on the candle. I concentrate on the moving flame. As I watch it, my eyelids become heavier. I begin to feel that my eyes must close. I visualize them closing. Now it is almost impossible to keep them open. I let them close gently. Now I am able to relax fully. I feel the muscles relaxing in my toes, my ankles, my legs, my thighs, my buttocks, my back, my abdomen, my shoulders, my arms, my neck and my face. I note that I am breathing slowly and rhythmically. Every time I exhale I go deeper and deeper. I am letting go. I am now in a very deep state of blissful relaxation, yet with every breath I take I go deeper and deeper. Deeper and deeper. Deeper and deeper. I now visualize myself. I see myself entirely free of health problems. There is absolutely no sign of any health problem I may now

have. I see myself looking in radiant health. I now end my relaxation knowing this image to be activated. I will now feel full of energy and wide awake. One, two, three!

Step 5 Refreshments are served. The group discusses the topic "Health and Growth are Nature's Will and Purpose."

Step 6 A minute of instant relaxation and silent meditation is held, with a bell or noise sounded to begin and to end it. The meditation is one focusing on love for nature and for the group. . . . The participants are each asked to bring two flowerpots with soil and seeds for planting. The seeds may be for wheat or any other fast-sprouting plant that can grow at this time of the year, indoors if not out. Also needed is yogurt culture, usually obtainable at health-food stores. Participants leave in silence.

Evening No. 2

"Controlling Cell Growth"

Just as injuries to health can be caused by mental combativeness, health and growth are spurred in a climate of love and concord. This applies not only to human life but to all life. It can be physically demonstrated for plant life by means of the planting materials brought this evening.

The human body is said to be completely renewed about once a year. A complete renewal of hair, skin and nail cells is rounded out in a few weeks. The stomach and other internal organs are overhauled in a matter of months, while the bones take about a year.

Experiments have shown that this continuous cell growth is affected by the state of mind of the grower. The new cells appear to take on the characteristics of the mental climate into which they are born. The weaker or

more negative and destructive that climate, the weaker is each cell. The more wholesome, positive and creative that climate, the more robust and vital is each cell. Like the chameleon, each cell takes on the color and nature of its environmental consciousness.

This is a valuable truth to know, providing we could control our consciousness. But what good is it to know that healthy attitudes produce healthy cells, if we "flip our lids" when we meet sadness, adversity or aggressiveness, or if we are irritated by the people we meet and the events that occur.

Let's face the fact that we cannot suppress these destructive emotions. We have to express them when we feel them. To hide them is merely to keep them inside, where they remain longer and do even greater damage.

But we do not *have* to feel them in the first place. We can control our attitudes. This is done through knowledge and understanding. If we understand that something is "bugging" the other person, then we are less likely to rise up in defense and react emotionally to an offense from him. If we also understand that we ourselves often project something onto the other person that might not be there in the first place, then we are less likely to "have a chip on our shoulder" and more likely to be at ease.

We may say, "This is an uncomfortable chair." We often project our state onto the chair. Actually, many times, it is we who are uncomfortable. The chair may feel quite comfortable to somebody else.

A "comfortable" attitude toward our fellow man and the world at large is not a climate for dis-ease. This attitude control is not comfortable smugness; it is tantamount to cell control, and tonight we will begin a demonstration of the control of cellular growth through consciousness.

Later in Part IV we will attempt to carry this one step further. We may actually begin to alter the nucleus of the atoms within the molecules of those cells—again through the control of consciousness. We can then take part in the evolution of man toward his next higher level in nature's plan.

Meanwhile—the cell.

Procedure

Step 1 The introduction is read. Each prepares his two flowerpots with identical soil, seeds and water. Each

chooses one of his plants to love as a baby, and considers the other as an intruder and unwanted. The two plants are placed in the same growing area but kept separate and identified, so that the one may be loved and the other unloved, whenever given identical care and watering. Development will be watched in future weeks. Eventually, the vegetable material in both pots will be washed and weighed. Some participants may want to take home their two pots. This will not make for as scientifically controlled an experiment, but is permissible. A recorder is appointed by the group to keep tabs on the experiment, and to report back in five weeks or more to the group on the results.

Step 2 Do plants have emotions? The group discusses the work of Cleve Backster whose Backster Research Foundation of New York City has been uncovering positive evidence of this possibility through the use on plants of polygraph or lie-detector equipment. Sharp electrochemical reactions were recorded on the equipment when plants were threatened (at the moment of the threatening thought), and when, for another instance, a dog was disturbed in an adjoining room. What are the implications of this? How is this pertinent to the work of George Washington Carver who said he talked to plants (the peanut plants, he said, revealed their secrets to him and helped him discover scores of uses) or to the "green thumbers" in suburbia who have a knack with plants. How is this pertinent to the growth of our cells?

Step 3 Into three bottles of warmed whole milk (110° F.) is placed yogurt culture. One bottle is labeled A, the others B and C. A is placed in a warm place and cursed. C is placed alongside A as a control, B is placed in the center of the room and the group conducts a meditation in universal love. (If the group has not experienced Part III, then the introduction to Evening 15 there is read prior to meditation.) Love is directed at B in this meditation and the beneficial bacteria in the yogurt and milk thus given support in their work. B is set in the same warm place beside A and C. The host reports to the group at the next session on his test twenty-four hours later, for taste and consistency in A, B and C. He may invite participants to join in that taste test.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Discussion.

Evening No. 3

“The Many Paths of Yoga”

Most people picture yoga as involving sitting cross-legged or in some other weird position. They have little, if any, comprehension of its purpose, and about as much understanding of how it works. Yet in the past three decades millions of Americans have found renewal in the practice of one kind of yoga—hatha-yoga—those pretzel-like physical exercises.

The renewal came in the form of the release of tension and anxiety, better physical fitness and an emotional stability born of the peace of mind. This is quite a dividend for just a few minutes a day of what appears to be contortions; yet these people were just tapping the surface of the world of yoga and receiving only token gifts from its storehouse of rewards.

The great violinist Yehudi Menuhin inscribed a watch to his yoga teacher, B. K. S. Iyengar, “To my best violin teacher.” Gloria Swanson credits yoga for her health and beauty. Other beauties—Greta Garbo, Jennifer Jones, Olivia de Havilland, to name just a few—have been its devotees. Iyengar’s methods are taught three times a week to sixty people at a time at the authors’ center in London.

What is the full promise of yoga? Practiced in all its forms, yoga brings about a molecular change in the body. Tastes and habits change. The life force within becomes magnified. Thoughts are quickened, senses are heightened and the powers of the mind expanded. The three divisions of man—physical, emotional and mental—accustomed to pulling him in different directions, begin to work together in harmony. The energies that were wasted in this internal

conflict now send man soaring to new heights of ability, happiness and spiritual well-being.

Few men in history have attained the full promise of yoga. One was probably Jesus Christ, who practiced all of the separate yogas at the same time, it is thought, as did Krishna and Buddha of India. These yogas were well-established disciplines 2000 years before Jesus, and we can find direct reference to these yogas in the Gospels.

This Evening we will each spend a few minutes on eight different yogas. It should be a powerful Evening, bringing us all closer to oneness with each other and the universe around us.

Procedure

Step 1 A volunteer reads the above introduction and then describes the eight yogas briefly, as below. He asks those present who have a knowledge of the Gospels or the New Testament to try to identify references therein to each yoga.

- 1) *Bhakti-yoga*: The way of love; the aspirant selects a self-chosen and ideal manifestation of God or the universal mind which goes to the heart of the aspirant so he sees it in everything.

(Mark 12:30)

- 2) *Karma-yoga*: The way of right action; the finding of some enlightening work which recognizes the action needed to defend the world against division and awaken mankind to discover righteousness.

(John 16:8-13; Mark 10:43-45)

- 3) *Jnana-yoga*: The way of knowledge. To know by philosophical reflection or wisdom. Spiritual knowledge of the highest selfhood through the scriptures, prophets and sages. Probing the power of the cosmic intelligence as the source of all thoughts and ideas.

(Matt. 7:1-5; Matt. 21:23; Matt. 22:30)

- 4) *Raja-yoga*: Penetrating the seven levels of consciousness and the eighth domain of being. Awareness of the material and spiritual universe with its cosmic, psychic and healing energies. Contacting the life force and cosmic intelligence and the understanding of eternal time and karma.

(Matt. 6:1-34; John 14:2-4)

- 5) *Sanyasa-yoga*: The way of renunciation. Liberation is achieved by letting go of action in the world. When obligatory duties are abandoned out of ignorance or fear of trouble or painfulness, then this is not true sanyasa. Surrender is done with the trust and helplessness of a son approaching a father for his blessing. Difficult to attain without karma-yoga and dhyana-yoga.

(Matt. 8; Matt. 19:29-30;
Matt. 26:36-42)

- 6) *Dhyana-yoga*: The way of prayer/meditation and concentration of the imaging faculty. Trance states which achieve serenity and contact with the power to dispel darkness within and transmit the power of *medha*, which is Sanskrit for "truth" or "wisdom" and forms the basis of the word "meditation."

(Mark 11:22-26)

- 7) *Mantra-yoga*: Repetition of a hallowed name or chanting a structured sound; a deep sigh or groan like the OM sound, which acts as a carrier wave for thoughts. *Man* (thought) *tra* (transfers protection); manifests a positive transformation of psychic electricity into cosmic vibration in man by means of OM.

(Mark 7:34; John 11:43)

- 8) *Guna-yoga*: The controlling of the creative energy in man and the world around him and the absorption of vital forces and light.

(Mark 5:30; Mark 9:2-3)

Step 2 There are many ways to divide yoga. Hatha-yoga, not listed among these eight, is the one a student usually begins with—the strengthening of the body and attainment of physical well-being. It can be said to be part of raja-yoga, or it can be said to be an introduction or preparation for all the yogas. It begins with total relaxation. . . . The participants lie on the floor. If there is not enough room, divide into groups or use the hallway or another carpeted room. The following instructions are read:

Lie on your back. Extend your arms outward, feet rolled out. Palms are up. Breathe in through nostrils then out forcefully through mouth. With this exhalation comes a total release of all muscles and a feeling of the nearness of your entire body to the floor. This breathing exercise is repeated three times. The second and third times you "let go" even more and feel that re-

laxed nearness more deeply. Maintain this relaxed, prone posture for two minutes. Keep the mind from roving. Concentrate the mind on the nearness of the relaxed body.

Now sit in the half lotus position for three minutes (see instructions on page 147). Again keep the mind from wandering. Concentrate the mind on love for the group and for the universe.

Step 3 There was a yoga exercise within a yoga exercise in Step 2. Who can identify it, and name one of the eight yogas of which it is part? (Answer: Holding the mind on love for others and the universe—bhakti-yoga.) Each participant suggests what he or she may be doing in life or expects to do which can be considered within the scope of karma-yoga.

Step 4 What books have participants read which might be said to put them on the path of jnana-yoga? What other books come to mind that might be as valuable as having a guru (wise man) teaching one in person? Of all those mentioned in this Step, can the group agree on what one or two books would be the most valuable in this day?

Step 5 To which of the eight yogas do the exercises and games of this book most closely lie? (Answer: raja.) Who will suggest what renunciation means in practical everyday life? What can each participant let go of, in the way of an activity or pleasure, as at least a one-time demonstration of sanyasa-yoga? Did anybody eliminate himself from tonight's experimenting?

Step 6 The candle—relaxation—meditation described on pages 45-47 is now performed. A volunteer reads the monologue as each follows in his mind's imagery.

Step 7 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on how the Step 6 experience differed tonight from the first time it was performed by the group in Part I, Evening 9. The discussion might also center on what aspects of Step 6 were dhyana-yoga, mantra-yoga or guna-yoga.

Evening No. 4

“Calling on Hidden Resources”

Of what value is it to activate more of our potential as individuals if we never have to call on these resources? This Evening is devoted to overcoming a challenge by calling on hidden resources.

It is an Evening of wisdom and intuition rather than knowledge and know-how. When you try to do something which you have not learned to do, you draw on creative ingenuity. This is something outside your storehouse of facts and techniques.

Those who ponder the activities that confront them tonight will be at a disadvantage. They will be drawing on the same intellectual energy that they are in the habit of using. They will be looking for applicable bits of knowledge and know-how, and in so doing they will be blocking the flow of inspiration that they are now more open to receive.

A true test of whether you are tapping a larger source of intelligence than your own is spontaneity. You invent a way on the spur of the moment. It just comes through you and out. You don't have to think about it.

Civilized man has lost certain faculties that primitive peoples still retain to this day—the ability to communicate with the universe, to tune in on cosmic intelligence. Civilized man will approach the universe with the tools of knowledge. That is, he will use mathematics to analyze the moon-earth system and to calculate the phases of the moon. Primitive man cannot put himself in space outside of the ethno-system. He has never had this kind of experience and has not practiced this kind of thought imagery. His

usual way is to feel himself as part of the "whole," including any problem.

Western man has not lost his ability to communicate with the wholeness in things, even though he does exclude himself from the wholeness of things, and even though he regards himself as a separated ego, something apart from what is going on in the universe. This ability is within him, unused—a "hidden" resource.

The primitive in the jungle rarely hears music. But he hears the sounds of nature much better; when he hears the slightest snap of a twig, immediately that gives him the whole picture of where he is, because he has a 360-degree consciousness in the jungle. In the wilderness it is very necessary to have a 360-degree consciousness, but in civilization you have to have a tubular consciousness. You have to be looking through one tube or another, in a sense, all the time, because if you allow all the extraneous information to come in, as from newspapers, radio, advertising, this, that and the other, you can be thoroughly distracted. One-thing-at-a-time consciousness.

Civilized man is *particle* and primitive man is *whole* in consciousness. Civilized man has trouble existing in the jungle for very long because of this. When primitive man comes into society he is completely useless—completely mystified by the whole thing. He doesn't know what's going on. He has lost his orientation. Of course, he is the center of the universe in the open. He *is* the center. Everything has meaning. When he comes here, he has to learn to be divorced from his center.

There are still some remote areas in Mexico, for instance, where the natives will not have anything to do with modern civilization because they think it means *more* work. For instance, in some of the lake country, the traditional pattern has been to go out in a boat, lie in the boat with a fishhook and get all the fish you need in the morning. Then you row back a mile, go back with the fish, you eat it and have a siesta; you have just enough food for the day with no excess. You go back the next morning and do the same thing. Everything is very peaceful and the lake is very quiet. All you have to do is row that mile and fish. Then the Westerner comes along and says, "No. Have an outboard motor and you'll do that mile in a few minutes, with no rowing." So, the native thinks, if I had an outboard motor I would have to spend time repairing it, and this would mean a journey of fifty

miles and back for spare parts. Lots of work. "I don't want an outboard motor," he answers. "But you must have an outboard motor—this is more efficient," civilized man says. "It isn't more efficient; it disturbs the peace and has an adverse effect on my friends and myself—the smell of those things disturbs our whole situation, and I wouldn't be happy with it, so I don't want an outboard motor."

The wisest medical man does not understand how the human body ultimately hooks up to the rest of the universe. Yet many "medicine men" and spiritual chieftains do, in a very real sense.

Tonight we will give ourselves a chance to tap this dormant ability within ourselves.

Procedure

Step 1 A number of unusual assignments are made. They should not be considered in the same way as, say, club or fraternity initiations, even though some of them may smack of this type of thing. Instead, they should be considered as serious tests of one's ability to be guided to spontaneous conclusions. Each person may select an assignment to his or her liking. Or it may be the wish of the group to draw lots, or to use some other means of selecting who does what. A number of assignments are listed below. The group can alter them, or invent more. More than one person can be given the same assignment. However, all will work separately. The time limit on completing each assignment is one hour. Here are some assignments.

Men

You are taken blindfolded and penniless in a car about two or three miles away to some out-of-the-way, off-the-beaten-track spot and left there to return to the group "on your own."

You are to leave and return with a book you have borrowed from somebody—friend or stranger, but not related to you—which deals with a subject that bears on the universe and the nature of man.

You are to learn to knit by yourself. Knitting needles and wool are supplied to you and you're to knit a ring or bracelet.

You are to leave and return with three varieties of

edible fresh fruit and growing material that is non-edible.

Women

You are to prepare this evening's refreshments with your right hand tied behind your back.

You are to bake cookies in your hostess' kitchen without asking any questions and finding all materials and facilities yourself.

You are to weave a small mat using whatever grasses are available.

You are to disassemble and reassemble a small appliance like a hand mower or a waffle iron.

Step 2 All who remain in the house on inside assignments may observe others in the house with them, and note any "resourceful" behavior, or its opposite. They may also assist a person on an outside assignment by visualizing a fortuitous outcome. This visualization should be selective, with only one image directed at one particular participant.

Step 3 Participants return from their assignments and recount their successes or failures. How did the solutions represent the nonlogical, intuitional, spontaneous approach? Was the support projected by other participants "felt"?

Step 4 Refreshments are served—including the cookies.

Evening No. 5

"Know Yourself"

The senses have come to dominate our consciousness. As civilization has provided us with more and more sensory input, the stream of human consciousness has been polluted by this input to the extent that the intelligence it brings with it from its universal source is no longer easily detectable.

What would life be like if we could turn these senses off, one, two or three at a time? Suppose we could banish

the sense of touch, as on our hands and legs, and try to imagine life without it.

Suppose, in addition, we could banish the sense of hearing and live life as a deaf person for one year. What would it be like? The disadvantages are obvious, but what advantages might there be? We could not, for instance, be troubled then by what other people said about us. We could hear no good or evil about ourselves.

What would happen inside our stream of consciousness if we banished the sense of sight? Would anything flow in that stream in place of the vast optical input we receive? What is it like to be blind?

What would happen if we banished sexual impulses and had these organs numb for a year? We wouldn't get into any trouble. Nobody would call any of us a swinger. What would a life of continence be like for a year with nothing to "contain"?

The answers to these questions can only come through that above-mentioned consciousness. We must try to experience our consciousness without those senses. Then perhaps we'll know!

We can test what we find out by comparing it with the experiences of others, and with the experiences of the great men who have written the scriptures of the world. When these three come together—our own experiences, the experiences of our contemporaries and the experiences of others who have gone before us, we know we are closer to the living truth.

The advantage of knowing our own pure stream of consciousness is that this helps us to understand all people better. If we know the anatomy of one human being, the 206 major bones, the various muscles, etc., then we know the anatomy of all people. If we can know the conscious in-dwelling life force in ourselves, it becomes our model for other people.

Procedure

Step 1 After the foregoing is read, the group sits in silence, looking at one another as a volunteer signals the turning off of a sense, such as "Hearing" or "Taste." There is a two to three minute interim as this sensory input is imagined to be eliminated from the total input. These sensory eliminations are cumulative: the last one to be called is sight; as the eyes close, there is imagined to be no sensory input (including sex) through touch, hearing,

taste, smell or sight. When this is experienced in the imagination for two to three minutes, the group "restores" its senses and discusses the experience.

Step 2 Read both Step 2 and Step 3 instructions at this time. Now the senses will be actually locked up. Plugs are fashioned out of moistened paper for the ears, and for the nose. Gloves are provided for the hands, or else they are swathed in towels. (Genitals are symbolically sealed off with "chastity belts" of toilet tissue.) Blindfolds are given to all. Even the taste buds will be deadened by having a dish of salt ready to be used just before refreshments. Again, a volunteer signals the turning off of a sense and the participants comply by applying the appropriate masking agent. The ears come first. When the ear plugs are in, participants begin to circulate and "communicate" with each other. This can be verbal or non-verbal. There is lip-reading, touching, looking into eyes. Next the gloves go on. More communicating. The nose plugs go in. Participants continue to pair off, communicate and circulate. Communication is on matters of the consciousness. It is heart to heart. No intellectual issues of the day. Perhaps for the first time, the question "How are you?" is taken seriously.

Refreshments are served before the blindfolds go on. However, each participant holds a teaspoon of salt in his mouth for as long as he can before rejecting it. Refreshments are "enjoyed" sans taste. Participants react. Finally, blindfolds go on. There is a final few minutes of interaction.

Step 3 Before the senses are restored, the group returns to their seats. There is a deep relaxation and two or three minutes of silence in which each is able to concentrate on the stream of consciousness. Light is visualized through the blindfolds as filling the room with a white brilliance. It is one and the same as love. As it grows in brilliance so does love well up to overwhelming proportions—love for self, for the group, for the universe. The meditation ends.

Step 4 The senses are restored. Each person talks of his or her experience. . . . A set of tarot cards and a tarot instruction book are needed for the next meeting. These can be obtained at large book shops, but may have to be ordered. An effort should be made to get an authentic ancient version rather than one of the modern sets.

Evening No. 6

“Tarot Cards”

The universal stream of consciousness, which we glimpsed last week by holding back the sense obstructions along its bank, has no beginning and no end. It flows from the cosmos, through us, and back out to the cosmos.

While it's passing through us, we give the stream a past, a present and a future. However, out in the cosmos, time does not employ these divisions. Try and conceive the logic or sense of this and you throw your hands up. Still, parapsychological research into extrasensory perception repeatedly demonstrates precognition—the prediction of random future events, the occurrence of which cannot be inferred from the present knowledge of the subject. It comes into our stream of consciousness from “out there.”

This would imply that if you could “fish” in the pure waters of the cosmic stream of consciousness, you might conceivably catch some of the future. For centuries fortune-tellers have been claiming that they can do this. Many are devoid of any ability, and merely sponge on human gullibility. However, there are genuine and sincere people who can “fish” successfully for glimpses of the future.

Some use tea leaves, reading symbols in random patterns. This assumes the same principle of the ancient Chinese: that every happening of the moment, no matter how apparently superficial or meaningless, has relevancy. (See Evening 16, Part II, on the *I Ching*.)

Some use playing, or tarot, cards.

Outwardly the tarot is just another pack of cards. But it has psychological and philosophical content if one is willing to look. In fact, so deeply do the tarot cards delve into philosophical truths, that it would be impossible for the illiterate Gypsies of the fourteenth century to have created them, as some historians believe. It is more likely

that they originated from the hieroglyphic tablets of ancient Egypt, and represent the symbolism of those days.

Basically, the cards provide the user with psychological exercises that draw on ideas that are impossible to put into words—like the noumenal (opposite to phenomenal, unseen or objective) world, or like God. P. D. Ouspensky has likened them to “a kind of philosophical abacus.”

This Evening we'll explore the mysterious links connecting man to God or the universe—specifically the men and women gathered here.

Procedure

Step 1 A volunteer, or the person who obtained the tarot cards for tonight, exhibits the cards to participants and explains briefly what they include. (Fifty-two ordinary playing cards, plus one additional picture card in each suit, and 22 numbered cards with symbols—Juggler, High Priestess, Empress, etc.)

Step 2 The 22 cards known as the Major Arcana are placed face down before the participants. These cards have both a numerical meaning and an intricate symbolic meaning. Each person takes a card off the top of the pack, keeping the card face down, until his turn comes to read it. The host or a volunteer leader turns over his card and immediately states the first thought which comes into his mind on seeing it. The idea is to catch the first clairvoyant or telepathic image that comes to you, and to try to say what the card or the picture on it means to you. The next person in the circle does the same, until all have indicated their feelings about the meaning of the cards in front of them. A volunteer then reads the meaning of each card as described in the instruction book, keeping the opposites together. (1. “The Juggler” is everyman or mankind as a whole, a link between heaven and earth. Its opposite is “The Fool,” card zero, a small weak man. 2. “The High Priestess” is hidden knowledge. Its opposite is “The World,” card No. 21 or the object of knowledge, etc.)

Step 3 Is the card picked appropriate to the person? The group evaluates this, one by one.

Step 4 The cards are used to “tell futures.” Two people use them at a time, according to the instructions, as best they can. Meanwhile, the others can direct questions at a pendulum (see Evening 13, Part I) or the *I Ching*.

Step 5 Refreshments are served.

Evening No. 7

“Mining for Wisdom in Fables and Parables”

Much of the wisdom recorded by man is enshrouded in intricate terminology and esoteric parables. Apparently, those who capture truths from the cosmos do not feel it should come directly into the hands of those who are not ready for it. Indeed, this may itself be a cosmic truth. Jesus advised not to cast your pearls before swine or they would turn and “rend thee.”

A Hawaiian author who had access to the long-kept secrets of the kahunas (spiritual chiefs) was recently putting them into book form. When it was almost ready for the publisher, the handwritten manuscript was chewed to shreds by a dog. He wrote it again only to have a flood ruin the manuscript for the second time. As he began his third attempt, he suffered a mild stroke on the right side.

Storytelling has been a means used through the ages to perpetuate wisdom in indirect or disguised form. Our literary heritage is replete with myths, legends, fables, allegories, parables, fairy tales and epics that contain seeds of wisdom beneath their beauty and diversion.

These have been thoroughly scrutinized by historians, scholars and anthropologists for the knowledge they impart about man in history. Now psychologists are using the analytical process to make modern sense out of the symbolic images of folk literature.

The problem is that there are any number of interpretations that are valid. One person, a psychologist or not, can feel strongly that his is the interpretation with the strongest validity. Another person can feel just as strongly about *his* interpretation. It appears that the sages constructed their allegories in layers. For those who can delve

deeper, there is always another layer of hidden meaning. One stops only when the "shoe fits."

Many fairy tales have come down through the ages changing in semantics but carrying the original seeds of wisdom. Cinderella, Beauty and the Beast, the Princess and the Pea contain these seeds, as do many more like them.

Myths and legends, traced back to their origins by anthropologists, sociologists, linguists and other specialists, appear to have been born in very real periods in the history of man. However, only philosophers have dared to believe that the myths were not, in fact, stories at all, but that they really happened. Recent discoveries in England that appear to validate the legends of King Arthur and his Round Table may bear out their beliefs.

Many myths, such as flood stories in which life is saved by an ark and a sacred mountain, have their counterparts on opposite sides of the world and in totally separated cultures. Only the names of the heroes and places are changed. Even these names can often bear striking similarities.

Through the centuries, writers have borrowed from this ancient material, revising, romanticizing and updating, making it easier for people of their times to relate to the stories. Certainly this can be said of Cervantes' *Don Quixote*, Aesop's Fables, Harris' Brer Rabbit, and many nursery rhymes (many of the latter, like "Mary, Mary Quite Contrary," were born of politics and limited their meanings to the issues of the day).

Most great teachers have said that people go through life with their eyes open and seeing nothing, or that they have their ears open and understand nothing of what they hear. The only secrets that are hidden in the universe are hidden under our own skulls, in dormant powers of perception; in consciousness itself.

In Luke 8:10 we find, "And he said, Unto you it is given to know the mysteries of the Kingdom of God: but to others in parables; that seeing they might not see, and hearing they might not understand."

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, the participants discuss one or two fairy tales such as Sleeping Beauty or the Emperor's New Clothes. A meaning is offered. If other meanings are seen, they too are offered.

Step 2 Each person makes up a short story in a sort of mythological form. The hero is real and known to them. It may be a member of the group, or a well-known figure in the town or in politics. The story may use such characters as Bugs Bunny or Pinnochio or astronauts or flying saucers. Each should contain some message cloaked in symbolic terms. When each brief story is concluded, the other participants attempt to identify the main character and reveal the message or messages.

Step 3 Mental activity is sometimes blocked by tension. An effective and quick method of release is a type of "seventh-inning stretch." We'll do it now by not only rising and stretching, but by intoning, groaning, singing, shrieking, dancing, rolling on the floor and letting go, or by giving vent to our tensions in any way that "comes naturally." The important thing here is to forget the next guy and "let go."

Step 4 The group returns to their seats and holds hands in a circle. There is a two-minute period of relaxed silence. The meditation is on the meaning of the group.

Step 5 One person starts a group allegory or fairy tale in the spirit of "Once upon a time . . ." The next person takes over to continue the tale. And so on, until the story is finished. Is there meaning to it with reference to the goals of the group?

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Step 5 is discussed further. . . . At the next meeting, several sets of dice are needed, and a few waxed straws.

Evening No. 8

"Personal Magnetism"

The life force within us is unique. It evades the very instruments that it has, through us, invented to measure energy and force. It is somewhat like an eye not being able to see itself.

It is nevertheless a very real force. Thought concen-

tration, when exercised not in experimentation but in emotion-charged reality, shows up in unexplained ways. One man was physically moved to turn right instead of left on his way home from work, and found a fellow-worker's arm sticking up from a trench cave-in, just in time to save his life. A woman "saw" her daughter a thousand miles away lying sick and reaching for the phone just before her call arrived. A man can concentrate on a cumulus cloud in the sky and disintegrate it, doing it at will for newspapermen and others, always at their selection and with a control cloud that remains intact.*

Can this force be demonstrated, if not measured? The answer is yes. It will probably be demonstrated this evening. There are always a few people in a group of ten or so who can demonstrate the effects of mind over matter. Just as with mental skills, wherein a person can be good in math, say, and poor in history, so it is with psychic skills. Success or failure in psychokinesis does not reflect on psychic skills in other areas. The greater the ability to concentrate, the more likely it is that there will be positive results. The more emotionally "involved" one is, the better. The more attuned to a feeling of oneness with all "things" in the universe, the better.

To be aware of this power is to know yourself and others better. To use it for material gain or personal power invites circumstances befitting such use. To use it in concordance with natural forces is to be, in effect, a "co-author" of the universal plan.

Procedure

Step 1 The above is read. . . . Take a waxed paper straw (usually found at soda fountains), and pass a needle through its exact middle. Press the other end of the needle into a flat cork and set it down on a level surface. Check to see if the straw rotates at the slightest touch. Now each participant in turn places his fingers so that they are nearly touching one end of the straw. It will move right or left. The vigor of the motion is a measure of what is often called electrostatic force that builds up in our bodies.

Step 2 If this is strictly an electrostatic force, then it cannot be controlled. If, on the other hand, it can be built up by the mind at will, it must be something else.

*Reported in *Creative Realism*, N. Y.: Pageant Press, 1959. Dr. Rolf Alexander, September 12, 1954, Orillia, Ontario, Canada.

Using another cork, place the fingertips of both hands on either side of it, nearly touching it. Wait until you feel a distinct tingling sensation in the ends of the fingers. This may eventually extend to the elbows or even to the shoulders. This is a manifestation of the life force. You can "will" it into the fingertips and you can actually see it. . . . Place your fingertips a short distance apart in front of a black background. Now "will" the force to enter your fingertips. When a tingling is felt, gradually draw the fingers apart. You can clearly see a whiteness or white "stuff" between them. This is often called the arc of threads. Once you have seen it, it is more credible and one is better able to build it up and to use it.

Step 3 Several participants who have had the best results in Steps 1 and 2 may want to practice an exercise to build up this arc of threads. The way to do this is to hold the fingertips of both hands a short distance (a fraction of an inch) from the cork. Concentrate on willing the life force into your fingertips. Now, see the arc of threads in your imagination. Visualize the white "stuff," or psychic rays, passing from the fingers and supporting the cork. Hold this image for a few moments before making any physical motion. Then slowly raise the fingers and see if the cork is willing to follow the upward direction of the fingers. If it does, you have, of course, succeeded in physical "mediumship." Some people find that, instead of following the fingers, the cork is repelled. Also, where the "mediumship" cannot be demonstrated in this way, some people are strikingly successful in demonstrating it in other ways, opportunities for which will be provided in subsequent Evenings.

Step 4 Everybody has had some experience with "winning streaks." A classic example is the dice thrower who gets "hot" and has a number of successful throws, defying all the odds and the law of averages. Can this be reenacted now? A participant who feels "lucky" volunteers. He must have a sense of sureness and confidence. A proper place to roll the dice is created for him. This should be a flat surface like a card table. It is covered with a smooth tablecloth, or blanket, and pushed into a corner. Six dice are placed in a small cardboard container. Avoid metal. The thrower of the dice then calls out a number from one to six. Visualizing the number and *knowing* his life force is at work on the dice, he shakes the container and bounces the dice off the corner walls. When they come to rest, one

correct die out of the six is to be expected from the law of averages. Everything over this number is possible evidence of psychokinesis. Repeat the roll four times, changing the called number each time. Statistically, a likely average total is four, for the four rolls. However, a total of seven would have odds of 100 to 1 against its happening normally, and can be attributed, at least partially, to PK (psychokinesis). Others take turns, trying their luck or PK. There are no side bets. But it often helps increase the emotional voltage to offer a prize to the best performer.

Step 5 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on whether there are valid uses of "willing" this life force. In what ways can it be misused?

Evening No. 9

"Man's Quest for Identity"

"Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains." Rousseau's rebuke of two centuries ago, is still largely true. We live in a prison of our own making—called conformity. We spend half our lives keeping in step with everyone else and the other half convincing ourselves it was all our own idea.

The recent attraction for psychedelic experience is an attempt to break out of this prison. To "blow your mind" means to some to burst through the comfortable status quo of consciousness into totally new mental territory. Here the personality, free of the mold that restricts it, may find an individual identity, one that is unique, expressive of the fact that it is the only one of its kind.

Conformity is the enemy of awareness. It stifles the expansion of consciousness and chokes off the growth of personality.

However, the shock treatment of psychedelia is not the

only way out of the prison, as we have found in the many Evenings that the group has "lived" together. And being weird is not necessarily having identity.

Tonight, our identities will be further revealed. This is possible because of the group rapport and because we have at least partially emerged from the prison of our own making. Can you imagine introducing your identity fully at the first get-together—or even the twenty-first? We would not have known where to begin because there were so many "portable" identities we were carrying with us to fit various occasions.

A child is riding in a car. A radio is playing music. The mother notices that big wet tears are rolling down the cheek of her three-year-old boy. She asks why he is crying. He replies, "The music is doing it." A few minutes later the same boy remarks, "Mother, can we take the clouds home with us? They look so lonely and they are following us."

The boy is certainly making his identity known. It comes through loud and clear. It is not found in his name. It is not found in his address, in his genealogy or in his looks. It is found in how he interprets the universe to himself.

That is the mirror which we will use in this Evening's identity revelations.

Procedure

Step 1 The very first activity of the group is repeated. Participants express their philosophy of life in a "What I Believe" recital around the circle.

Step 2 Paper is distributed. This time participants express their life goals in writing. In one or two sentences they state what they hope to accomplish or to become.

Step 3 A deep meditation is held. A volunteer conducts it with the monologue of light used in Evening No. 9, Part I.

Step 4 The paper is reversed and a personal life goal is once more expressed. Each reads what he wrote before and after the meditation. Any changes are noted and the effects of the meditation are discussed.

Step 5 Each participant writes a short poem. It can be in rhyme or blank verse. There is silence as each works to express a feeling he derives from the universe. This can be done by reflecting macroscopically or microscopically. Each will be putting together words or ideas that have

never been put together in just that way before. After about fifteen minutes the poems are collected, mixed and distributed. The first person reads one; the others attempt to identify the poet. Then the next is read and so on until all have been read and identified.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Discussion centers on doing "one's own thing." Is it enough to be nice? A dog is nice, a pig is nice. What can we point to before we die and say, "I've done this" or "I've been this" with the pride of having expressed our unique identity? . . . At the next session, a Polaroid camera is needed together with photographic film and paper, and developing chemicals for both the film and the paper. A dark area should be ready for use, such as a closet or basement.

Evening No. 10

"The Transmutation of Energy— Life Energy to Light Energy"

The more aware we become, the more we feel ourselves to be a part of something bigger than all of us. We reach beyond our skin and tune in on an intelligence that appears to fill space. Communication can take place with a total disregard for distance. Perhaps the intelligence in space senses our needs, and a "fortuitous coincidence" takes place, or our "prayers are answered," or everything "works itself out."

All of this operates whether we know, understand and accept it or not. However, if we are conscious of being part of an intelligence filling space, we can tap it and harness it with a greater degree of success, and we can actually be less separated and more a part of it. Simultaneously, our bodies become less subject to the stresses we impose on them, with our consciousness of separateness,

and more the natural mechanisms that less conscious creatures enjoy.

Man stands in his own light and wonders why it is dark.

How can we become more conscious of our identification with the intelligence that fills space? Those who sit in quiet meditation are, in fact, attuning themselves to this intelligence. Every time they spend a few minutes in quiet attunement with the cosmos, they are helping to undo the restricting attitude of separateness and permitting nature to flow more easily through them.

There are those among us for whom only seeing is believing. For them, evidential experiences are essential to a change in understanding of the universe. They want to see the *unseen* manifest itself in the *seen* world.

Fortunately, there are areas where the two meet—the seen and the unseen—and where sensitive or gifted individuals with psychic skills can produce this evidential “proof.”

Ted Serios was studied for many years by psychiatrists and physicists, as he impressed Polaroid films with images from his own *mind*. (See *The World of Ted Serios* by Dr. Jules Eisenbud.) Nobody else has been known to have Serios’ ability to project an image onto film, with the kind of detail of, say, a Gothic cathedral. But many of us—certainly one or more in the group—can affect photo-sensitive materials with the life force of the “unseen” world.

To do this is just a pleasant activity. Nothing will be changed. It is all there operating, whether we “discover” it or not. So, prepare for some fun.

Procedure

Step 1 A volunteer reads the above and calls for a male volunteer with good vocal projection to conduct this Step. All stand and face him with their arms stretched forward palms down. He activates the “hearing” of their palms by intoning the universal sound “OM” in a long drawn out chant: O-O-O-M-M-M. He repeats this until most can feel the tingling in their palms as the skin picks up auditory vibrations.

Step 2 This volunteer then projects another type of energy by extending his palms toward them and trying to project a life force to them in the same way as was experienced two meetings ago through the fingertips. He visualizes the life force passing through his fingers to the

fingertips of those facing him. A tingling sensation should be felt by 90 per cent of those present. Some may describe it as pins and needles in the fingertips; others, as electrical vibrations. It is necessary for the person who is projecting this energy to visualize it and to try to impregnate it with vibrations as he does so. In other words, to "see" it emanating from his fingertips, modulated as radio waves are with vibrations of sound, but in this case carrying vibrations that he can impose on it and which group members can feel. Others can try projecting this force to the group, until the tingling feeling is unmistakable.

Step 3 If the members of the group fail to do this individually, they can connect themselves together like batteries and multiply the voltage of this life energy. They form a circle, joining hands, and send this energy to one person who stands in the center of the circle. They focus on that person as he or she turns slowly inside the circle and relates any feeling. Now all extend their arms inward and place their hands in contact with the arms of the person in the center. They "think energy" flowing from the group to the person. They "see" white threads passing from themselves to that person. Now hands are moved so that the person can feel energy applied at the back of his neck, then on his forehead, then on his solar plexus. Where is the feeling most intense?

Step 4 A leaf or blade of grass and photographic film is used in this Step. The action takes place in a dark room. The leaf is placed on a table and a photographic film or plate is placed over it. A subject holds his hand over the emulsion negative and adopts an attitude of complete willingness to project his own vital magnetism or energy so as to impregnate the film. There can be no feeling of "will this work?" Reservations must be abandoned and the full power of expectation and belief must be permitted to dominate. (It has been found that by placing the leaf or other natural object in a position with consideration for its critical rotation enhances the results of this game. Rotate the leaf freely on a pin and find out where it tends to stop in relation to due north. Then stick it down with cellophane tape in this position.) When the subject has completed the energy projection, he must develop it himself immediately in the dark, switching on a red light in a few seconds so that he can take it out of the developer as soon as he sees the image come up, and stopping it by placing it in the fixing bath.

Step 5 All try roughly the same exercise. Some continue to use film or a photographic plate. Others switch to photosensitive paper. The reason that a growing thing, such as a leaf, is used is because it has its own life energy that can be activated by human energy.

Step 6 A Polaroid camera and film, if available, are now used for direct impregnation by the human life force. A subject extends his fingers toward the camera lens and looks intently at it as he gathers his life energy into his fingertips and projects it at the film behind the lens. If this can be done in a photographic dark room, the assistance of somebody to "click" the camera at the appropriate moment can be helpful. However, do not expose the film this way under any other conditions. Proceed with the camera's developing operation and check the results. Let others try.

Step 7 Refreshments are served and the results are discussed.

Evening No. 11

"The Transmutation of Energy— Light Energy to Life Energy"

"If Thine eye be single, the whole body shall be filled with light." This Biblical quotation is too often interpreted to mean that concentration brings intellectual enlightenment. But try this one on for size: If you know only of the power of good and do not recognize any power of evil, your body will be more receptive to cosmic illumination.

While physicists continue to probe the nature of light, spiritual teachers and others with a "single eye" are able to harness light's energies in a metaphysical way. What kind of light is this cosmic light?

Jesus and Mohammed experienced light in tremendous

intensity. The poet Walt Whitman and "The Man who Tapped the Secrets of the Universe," the late Walter Russell, saw light in its fullest cosmic intensity. The worldwide Subud movement is a result of Indonesia's Muhammad Subud having been enveloped in flashes of cosmic light for thirty nights.

Any number of meditation centers throughout the world teach the visualization of light as a means to attract this transformative power. There are techniques to change light energy into life energy—the reverse of the process that was used the previous Evening. Is this light real energy or metaphorical?

Ever since mankind began there has been a concept of duality and a struggle between the so-called force of good and evil. Zoroaster, the Persian prophet, presented these two aspects of the one God as Ahura-Mazda, Lord of Light, and Ahriman, Prince of Darkness. The Lord of Light personified a supreme glory, omnipotent and all-knowing. The Prince of Darkness personified evil, the devil, destruction and malevolence. The wars they waged against each other personified the conflict that is still fought within man. The battlefield is in the hearts and minds of men, while the energy used is all the same.

Science reveals no power in darkness, only in light. The Bible states that God is light and in Him there is no darkness. That which man calls darkness is the absence of light, or the existence of only a small degree of light. Similarly, what man calls evil is only a small degree of good.

Franklin D. Roosevelt said, "We have nothing to fear except fear itself." He knew that we attract that which we fear. We attract circumstances of little good if we dwell on them, or hold them in our powerful visual imaginations, just as easily as we attract circumstances of tremendous good by dwelling on them.

Once we comprehend the singleness of good and of light, we have "a single eye," and we are ready to open our consciousness to it. Those who go only part way and feel, say, that 75 per cent of the power in the universe is good, and that 25 per cent is evil will cancel themselves out in part, and net less cosmic illumination and enlightenment than the person who knows the 100 per cent singular nature of good and of light.

This Evening may seem irrelevant to the above at first,

but if your eye is truly single, nothing will remain outside the scope of light, and good.

Procedure

Step 1 The above is read. An issue of the day is discussed. The topic selected is one that generates a great deal of controversy. It could be whether industry should be all moved into an area that is now largely residential, whether a current speed limit should be reduced, whether a road should be widened or a stop sign installed at a certain corner. Repeal of abortion laws, sex education in elementary schools, fluoridation of water supplies, the draft, or demonstrations versus law and order are other possibilities. The criterion is local interest; the topic should hold a high potential for polarization within the group. Each person states where he stands, and two sides take opposing positions in the room. Approximately fifteen minutes are devoted to an unstructured "free-for-all" debate on the issue, with anyone speaking his mind who is moved to do so.

Step 2 The participants change seats. The "pros" are now the "cons," and vice versa. Each now attempts to see and express the good in the other's point of view. After ten to fifteen minutes of this depolarization, the members go back to their original seats.

Step 3 The same instrument created at the last meeting, out of a waxed straw and a pin, is made again. When it is perfectly balanced, each participant tries his hand at causing the straw to move by his electrostatic life force (the same force which he later attempted to use on light-sensitive film or paper). This will now be used as a makeshift meter for this life force. A participant is selected for Step 4 who caused only a small movement in the straw. Avoid choosing anyone who is not able to cause any perceptible movement at this time.

Step 4 The participant selected takes a place in the center of the group. All members relax deeply, including the recipient. A two-minute meditation is held in which all visualize a brilliant light surrounding the head and body of the recipient. At the conclusion of this, he again approaches the straw, and the movement is compared with that of before. Others may wish to try out the "light" seat. If the group holds hands in the meditation, are the results improved?

Step 5 Refreshments are served and the results are

discussed. . . . Also discussed is the selection of a classical play for use the following week. Shakespeare's works are admirable choices. Participants need to know the general drift of the theme of the play and the characters involved. Each participant selects a role in that play. There is no memorization of lines. All that is needed is willingness to dress for a part and participate in a freewheeling, spontaneous production inspired by the play. How about *A Midsummer Night's Dream*?

Step 6 A final one or two minutes of relaxed meditation is held with each participant visualizing himself or herself bathed in a brilliant cosmic light. All leave with quiet, whispered goodnights.

Evening No. 12

"The Play's the Thing"

The formal structure of the Evenings in this book is pretty much dictated by the requirements of the usual home environment. When the authors conduct awareness sessions, either in the United States or England, many aspects of the local environment are brought into the action.

For instance, if your group had access to a boat, it would be of immense value to enjoy a few hours aboard together. Participants would have new experiences, and different facets of each person would be uncovered in a variety of interpersonal relations inspired by the changed environment.

We saw this new energy emerge when the group participated in the dinner Evening, the masquerade or the picnic, all scheduled in previous Parts.

Tonight's event is an attempt to transform the living room into a totally different place and to draw out the exuberance of each complete person in an environment freed from the usual four walls and a ceiling.

So, the walls are dissolved, time is erased. The place is changed.

The Evening is real. You are real. But you are transplanted to a new setting where experiences with added dimensions are permitted to unfold.

To begin, the host refers back to the play chosen at the end of last week's session and makes sure that everyone knows the general story and has a part to play in the drama.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, all participants introduce themselves, stating the name of their role and explaining who they are and what their relationship is to the other characters and the plot.

Step 2 The person who elucidates the best, thereby exhibiting the most detailed knowledge of the play, is selected as the director. His function is to start the action by choosing a point in the play as the "now" for all and discussing with each participant just what his feelings and position in the plot are to be.

Step 3 The play begins at the point selected. However, the participants are not restricted to the play. They'll make the Evening come alive, not the play. They do what may derive from the play's starting point, but which is in essence their own behavior from then on. They change the plot as they see fit. They permit themselves to eclipse the playwright's work and to mold the whole evening into a drama that is part fantasy and yet part real. For instance, we might find we have a Hamlet who not only doesn't believe in ghosts but doesn't want to talk about them and prefers to discuss the psychological aspects of some of his problems. Or we might find a Hamlet who understands entities on the other side so well that he decides to hypnotize a person to become a medium and "converse" with his father. When the sky is the limit, instructions are out of place.

Step 4 The "play" is ended. All interaction is stopped and the participants are reminded that it has really been just a performance. It is stated that the performance has been watched by a group of very advanced souls. They are saints and prophets, gurus and others of great philosophical and spiritual stature. Each participant now becomes one of these great wise ones. They discuss the significance of what they have just seen: awareness seekers dressed as

characters in a play and doing their own thing. As observers from the new lofty points of vantage, what were the levels of growth displayed, what facets of whose personality were unveiled, what great future is sensed as in store for each participant? What is the road or the way to these new advanced levels?

Step 5 Refreshments are served. Everybody is himself. . . . To the next meeting, each brings materials for enjoying his favorite creative outlet; for painting, sketching, woodworking, sculpting, sewing, knitting, weaving, playing a musical instrument, reading music to sing by, or acting in a play, etc. Also needed: a recording of "Aquarius/Let the Sunshine In." Substitutes could be "Dream the Impossible Dream," "I Believe" or another visionary type of vocal music. Somebody should also bring incense and colored bulbs or other means for providing color in room lighting.

Evening No. 13

"Tapping Creativity"

Science looks at space as a void—a vacuum filled by matter through which passes a number of measureable types of energy vibrations, from the lower frequency hertzian waves to the higher frequency light waves and cosmic radiation.

The universe could not exist without space. In fact, space had to exist before the first suns and planets were created in space. Science is hard put to conceive the moment of creation, because science attributes mainly nothingness to space. Even the concept of "ether," popular a century ago, has yielded to this absolute "void."

Many metaphysicians and philosophers, on the other hand, hold the concept that space is a continuum of consciousness, intelligence and energy; that it is the very fabric of scientific laws through which atomic energy, gravita-

tion and other physical phenomena operate; and that it is "the stuff" in which all life has its being.

Each person, as a life entity, can both absorb energy and intelligence from space and radiate energy and intelligence back into space. We are in this sense like radio transmitter-receiver sets. And how we are tuned dictates both what we send to others in the form of sound, light, thought and psychic vibrations through space, and what we receive from space.

If you consider that space is the prime source and background of creation itself, it is only natural to look to space as the source of all creative inspiration and originality. Yet this is quite difficult, if not impossible, for us to do, except on a very space-limited basis.

We box ourselves in. We sit in corners, live in rooms, and have our beings in houses. When we emerge from houses we travel in boxes on wheels and go to offices located in boxes. Even when we die we box ourselves in.

We have conditioned ourselves to a consciousness of limited boxed-in space. We are therefore attuned to only small amounts of space—and, therefore, to limited creative originality. One of the great dividends to men of the present space age will be a dispelling of these walls and boxes and the broadening of creative consciousness.

This Evening we will enjoy the satisfaction of expressing creativity, and then we will observe how this enjoyment can be sent soaring skyward when the "boxes" collapse and the "walls" come tumbling down.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, each participant gets to his favorite medium of creativity—a musical instrument, a painting or a sketch, sculpting, woodworking, writing, composing, dancing to music, drama—and proceeds to enjoy a twenty to thirty minute period of working with this medium, alone and so located as not to interfere with the others.

Step 2 All return for five to ten minutes of prearranged psychedelia. An appropriate selection of visionary music such as "Aquarius/Let the Sunshine In," "Dream the Impossible Dream" or "I Believe" is played two or three times as loudly as possible. The lights are flashed on and off. Colored lights play around the room. Incense fills the air. Participants rise as they feel the need to move around the room, look into each other's eyes, touch and embrace.

Step 3 At the end of the music the lights are normalized but the incense continues to burn. In single file the participants move from one room to another, each with his hands on the shoulders of the person before him. The line snakes its way in and out of the rooms or porches, around the house, blessing the house and weaving a thread of protective light, as all journey finally to a secluded spot outside (pausing to don coats if necessary), such as the back yard or rear of the building. There the participants, still standing, form a circle and conduct a meditation of three minutes or longer under the sky. The meditation is divided into two parts: the first involves a feeling of great light and love that surges outward from all present to all spaces; this gives way to each wooing, as a lover, and expecting to be filled with light and love from, universal space.

Step 4 Each leaves when he feels his meditation is complete and returns to the medium of creativity he used in Step 1 where he begins anew to create, or to start a new creation.

Step 5 Each moves to another medium of creativity that is entirely new to him. A harmonica player tries his hand at a recorder; a poet tries painting; a writer puts a violin under his chin.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. Participants reveal their experiences. Were the "boxes" and "walls" perceptively removed? Did creativity flow more freely toward the end? . . . Each participant is instructed to conduct at least one activity on his own directed at expanding awareness. The activity may be a meditation, yoga, a nature walk, a creative effort, a change in habit or any new experience or experiences enjoyed in past group Evenings.

Evening No. 14

"The Group As a Cell in the Body of Mankind"

Within groups lie the key to the future of man. An individual can, with superhuman effort, improve his attitudes and control his emotions to a point where a healthy climate for his growth is restored. Some men working as individuals might even be able to effect changes in the nuclei of their own atoms, through resonance with light obtained by uniting their creative faculties with the whole of creation. But just as there was a limit to which one cell could go in the past evolutions of life, so there is a limit to which one man can go. Cells found that they had to unite with organisms in order to progress further. So will man.

Whenever three or more people get together, they can form a corporation. The law recognizes three people to be a corporate form as opposed to a corporal form. Committees, councils and other juries of men have long combined energies and wisdom to assure action and judgment.

Sometimes a group gets too large and bogs down because of its size. We find some obsolete dinosaurs, among the institutions of man, that can neither achieve action nor render judgment.

However, small groups of men can focus their conscious energies and their metaphysical powers to transform themselves into nuclei of being with immense power for good in the world. Jesus talked of group power; greater success in prayer was promised "When two or three are gathered together in My name."

By combining, men increase their individual faculties toward larger group awareness. This can permit extra-terrestrial, cosmic intelligence to find a larger cerebral

instrument through which to enter; by this means, hopefully, man may better survive the crisis he now faces. Some day a world-wide group of individuals could act as a world sensorium (not unlike H. G. Wells' envisioned World Brain.)

Your group, and many other groups working today, are fortunate in having found participants who are dedicated to increasing their awareness, sensitivity and creativity through joint effort. Groups are crystallizing around other books similar to this one, around various institutional activities and around the activities of individual leaders. This quiet revaluation by a "silent minority" is gathering momentum.

Coauthor Christopher Hills, as part of his work as director of the Commission for Research into the Creative Faculties of Man, stimulates centers all over the world and supervises a group activity in London called "Center." A group of young composers, artists, industrial designers, writers, psychologists, craftsmen, specialists and professionals occupy a six-story building where they live and work together as a community of creative people. Besides doing their regular work, they engage in group activities similar to what your group has experienced, but on a permanent basis. In addition, they give concerts, hold design workshops, publish materials for the young, perform research in microbiology (especially with algae and growing food from the sun's light) and assist other groups that convene at this Center to meditate and regenerate their own creative energies.

Each group has its own approach.

This Evening your group will take a look at itself. How far has it come? How far will its potential take it? How big can the parts become, how big is the sum of the parts?

Procedure

Step 1 Participants listen to the above introduction and then discuss what each has done in the way of expanded awareness activities since the last meeting. Interest centers not only on the details of the activities but on the inner experiences of the individuals. Has each individual been conducting similar activities on his own in previous weeks? What similar activities is the individual planning for the future?

Step 2 The group discusses the highlights of its history together. What types of Evenings stand out as the most

enjoyable? As the most productive of growth and progress for participants? As the most promising for future group meetings?

Step 3 Dance music is played and the floor cleared for three types of dancing. For the first number, individuals will dance alone. . . . In the East, there are spiritual dances of ecstasy. The dervishes in North Africa, Turkey and Afghanistan expand consciousness by tuning their muscles and nerves to cosmic rhythms, like snakes responding to music. The aim is to charm the snake within us, in our own spinal columns and brains, by swaying to the pulse. In India, the cobra symbolizes this rhythmic movement in deep meditation. Suitable music is chosen with heartbeat-like rhythms. All participate simultaneously, but there is no pairing of men with women. Each man dances alone. Each woman dances alone.

For the second number, the music is changed and participants pair up for a few moments at a time. A volunteer "caller" repeats, every fifteen seconds, "All change." Each participant dances with the participant nearest to him at the moment, preferably with someone with whom he has not yet been paired. When a man is paired with a man, or a woman with a woman, the hands may be on each others' shoulders. Men and women dance in Continental fashion.

For the third selection, participants conduct a group dance. It can start with a circle formed, all holding hands and facing the center. The circle can sway rhythmically together; it can move slowly around in one direction and then another. It can face outward and repeat these movements. It can face inward again and form a tighter circle with arms placed around waists. In this smaller circle, polka-type steps can be demonstrated by one participant and picked up by the whole circle. Others lead the circle in a step they feel like doing as the mood moves them.

Step 4 Group singing. All join in, with accompaniment if possible, in the song fest. The emphasis is on harmony, and on alternating a soft and then a powerful projection of all voices.

Step 5 There is a two or three minute meditation. All are conscious of the group's strength as the concept of light and love is called on to permeate the entire room, the building, the community, the country and the world.

Step 6 Refreshments are served. There is a group dis-

cussion. . . . A stringed musical instrument, preferably a piano, is needed at the next session.

Evening No. 15

“Psychic Resonance”

Scientists have found that the earth is enveloped by a highly energized field of positive ions and protons. This repels negative electrons and sends them raining down on us.

This positive field that surrounds the earth is created by cascades of cosmic rays from the sun and other more intense stars. When these cosmic rays or particles collide with the nucleus of an atmospheric atom, the charge is released.

The rain of cosmic wave particles on living tissue affects the electrical nature of all cells. It leaves a positive charge of bio-electricity at the nucleus of cells, and a negative charge at their surfaces.

Now it has been found that the nucleus of a living cell has, through its natural “consciousness,” the ability to create a surplus positive charge, thereby negating its negative surface charge and attracting more free electrons. In the process, the cells of the body repel each other and the space between them is expanded; this is particularly so with the bloodcells. Bloodcells coagulate when they lose their positive charge.

The resulting electrical force field, created by this movement of electrons, permeates our entire bodies, which are in themselves bundles of vibrations, and affects the frequency and amplitude of those vibrations.

Two people with similar states of consciousness are attracted to one another because they “resonate.” They feel a rapport rather than a clash. Their electromagnetic fields have similar rates or frequencies of vibration.

This Evening we will use sound vibrations bounced off our bodies (in a way similar to that by which we pre-

viously used light waves to detect basic drives), to obtain clues to resonance or rapport.

Tuning forks would, of course, be ideal to have. In their absence, the vibrations of a piano, or violin strings, will do—or, for that matter, any stringed instrument, including the human voice box itself.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, the notes of the scale are sounded on, say, the piano. Each person observes his own reaction to determine which note most refreshes him. He hums the note to capture it and identify with it.

Step 2 A five-minute meditation is held. During this meditation, the volunteer tuner directs the group to the sound OM, the noise of the universe, three times. Each participant sounds it with his own note as previously identified.

Step 3 Participants are arranged in a straight line. A volunteer is blindfolded. Participants change their seats so that the subject does not know the seating order. The subject stands about eight feet away from the first person who rises to face him. The subject tones his own note. He tries to sense an "echo." He does the same with the next person, until he feels a resonance with some person facing him. These two then pair off for a one-to-one discussion. Another subject then repeats the process. When the line is diminished to four people, the process is halted temporarily until a pair or two complete their discussion.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. Pairs disclose what mutual interests they discussed and whether they are indeed compatible or "combatible."

Evening No. 16

“Paying Our Last Respects to Fear”

It is natural and normal for man to experience fear. It's a signal of danger; man has fear to thank for his survival.

However, in man's early days he was able to give vent to his fear by flight toward safety. Today, respiration increases, perspiration flows to lower body heat and other biological “memories” ready the man for flight, but there is no flight and the biological preparations cause instead bodily imbalances.

Fear not only erodes us physically but interferes with the growth of consciousness and awareness. An insidious aspect of many of our fears is that we reject them with our critical judgment, acknowledging that they just do not make any sense, but still they terrorize us.

Radio commentators have been known to give up their profession because of the gnawing fear that they would fluff a line. Business executives have been known to walk up ten flights of stairs, or more, a day rather than ride in an elevator. Others have missed out on business, say, because of their fear of planes.

These persistent phobias dwell in the subconscious. Fear of speaking in public, of heights, of water, of animals and of the dark are examples of conditionings that have never been counteracted.

Now they can be. Each participant has the ability to recondition his subconscious and to dispel fears and phobias. Relaxation and visualization are all one needs to reprogram the subconscious. This evening we will begin the process of cleansing the subconscious of these anchors.

A man may practice silent meditation and attune him-

self to the infinite through the superconscious. He may expand and improve his conscious mind to a point at which the circumstances of his life are vastly improved. Yet, unless the subconscious mind is also brought into complete accord with the superconscious, the individual cannot be enlightened.

That is why we need to do some autoconditioning from time to time, whenever we detect remnants of past conditioning in feelings of fear that are orientated to insecurity, loneliness, guilt, poor sex, rejection and other negative factors in human activities and relationships.

We will *not* be exposing our fears to one another tonight. Fear is an emotion no one is proud of; we all prefer to keep it to ourselves. But each will be exposing those fear-darkened recesses of his subconscious to the brilliance of a dispelling light, whatever his fears may be; and they may be automatically canceled.

Just as we have been hypnotized by past experiences into a state of fear as a habit, we'll now try to hypnotize ourselves out of this state. We'll each do this by injecting our subconscious minds with a massive dose of what we already have in our conscious minds—a philosophical understanding of the infinite intelligence that orders the universe, a brimming confidence in ourselves as channels for that intelligence and a feeling of oneness with nature and all life.

Procedure

Step 1 After all the participants have arrived and the above is read, the lights are turned off and the shades drawn so as to make the room as dark as possible. Each member in turn has a fantasy about what he or she would fear most as a child in this circumstance. What fears did the dark bring on? Spiders? Bad men? Mice? Spooks? The discussion is in the present tense. "Something is moving in the dark over there. What is it?"

Step 2 One lamp is lit. It lights the room dimly. The group seeks deep relaxation, using the heaviness technique combined with rhythm breathing. This is prolonged so that the participants may enjoy a deep, blissful state of relaxation. Eyes are gently closed. Those who wish to may go still deeper by now visualizing themselves, say, in a mine-shaft elevator going down one level deeper, two levels deeper, and so on, to ten levels deeper. They will return by the same method, counting in reverse. When thorough-

ly relaxed, each person visualizes himself in the situation he most feared. This is not a giant step in that direction, but just an initial step in dehypnotizing. For instance, if the fear was of going into deep water, each sees himself going into deeper water than he would ordinarily brave. Or, climbing a little higher on a ladder if that was the fear. Speaking before a few people, not a large audience. Driving in a little traffic, not a lot. Next, each sees himself doing this same exercise at home in the week to follow, with the steps progressing toward the ultimate goal. Each mental image is in color, if possible, and in vivid sharpness, just as if it were true. And in each of these mental picturizations the subject is erect, self-confident, the epitome of self-mastery. As the mental imagery comes to a conclusion (miners come up their shafts), a volunteer gives the closing suggestion: "When I count three, I will end my session feeling wide awake, energetic, self-confident and wonderfully well. One, two, three!"

Step 3 All of the lights are turned on. The group performs the falling exercise of Part I, Evening I, with each taking a turn at falling backwards in the circle and being supported by the others.

Step 4 There is a group discussion on the following topic: If space is replete with infinite intelligence, why is there apparent injustice in the world? Halfway through the available time, refreshments are served and the group then reexamines the above question, assuming two hypotheses: personal life is eternal and composed of successive lives through reincarnation; and every thought or action bears the seeds of its own fruition and compensation.

Evening No. 17

"Memory Expansion"

We have all read those ads that say you can build a memory "so powerful that it is beyond your wildest dreams

today." These ads sell courses that promise you a memory for names and faces that will never fail you, the ability to memorize the editorial content of an entire magazine at a single sitting, to keep a telephone "book" of over 100 numbers in your head, etc.

The fact is: it's all true.

And then some.

Visual imaging can etch information into the memory in a quantity and at a pace beyond ordinary belief. But what the memory courses do not teach is the ability to reinforce this memory with an awareness which we can all develop further—that "second sight" we call extrasensory perception.

At the last meeting, we helped to bring the subconscious more in alignment with the conscious and the super-conscious. This evening we will see how all three can work together in a few pleasant memory games.

Awareness can be said to be another name for the consciousness that permeates infinite space. It is there to be tapped by anyone whose antenna is up. A photographic memory can be said to be another name for the etching in one's subconscious of what one really sees. It is within the ability of anyone who can relax away the protective folds of the conscious mind. Combine the two and you'll begin to open new doors of perception and to approach the fullest potential of the human mind.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is read, a scorekeeper is appointed and a memory test is conducted in three parts, as follows: a) A subject is blindfolded. All of the other participants line up facing him. (This assumes there are more than eight in the line: see below.) The blindfold is removed for as many seconds as there are participants and then immediately returned. The subject then recites the names from left to right. (If there are less than eight, participants change position after the first "appearance" and the subject must then recite, in succession, both orders.) b) The line is reformed. The subject stands blindfolded four feet in front of the new first person in the line and attempts to make an identification. He then tries to identify the others. There is no outside confirmation of right or wrong until he has faced each person and attempted identification. c) Now the first two parts are roughly combined. The subject views the line-up for a

limited number of seconds and then recites the names as he moves down the line blindfolded, tapping each person he's tried to memorize, and now tries to identify, on the shoulder. The score in b) is hardly ever as good as in a), but c) should top both. If the skill of the subject is such as to get a perfect score in a), then the difficulty must be increased by doubling up on the order, in two stages now—or more, for a smaller group. Let several subjects try this.

Step 2 A subject browses through the shelves of books in the room for one minute. He then returns to his seat and recites as many titles as he can remember. Next he returns to the shelves and sections off an area containing twice the number of books he just scored on the memory test. This time he affixes his eyes to the entire group of books in a relaxed semitrance state. Again in one minute he returns to his seat and again recites as many titles as he can. The second score should be considerably better than the first. Several participants try this.

Step 3 The skin is actually a sensory organ as is an eye, except that an eye has become specialized. Can bingo be played with the skin instead of the eye? Maybe not as well, but depending on skin awareness, it is possible. Make a type of bingo card using four numbers across and four down. Put the same numbers on separate pieces of cardboard, the size of the squares on the card. The subject sees the card for a few seconds. Then it is covered with a towel and the numbers are placed on it from memory. Note the score. Now the towel is removed and the subject is blindfolded so that he cannot see the numbers now placed randomly in his hand. He attempts to feel the numbers and to sense a resonance when the numbers match as he places them on the card. In matching the sixteen numbers, any score better than 1 is better than chance.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. The photographic memory is practiced in other ways. Discuss "sleep learning." . . . Needed next evening are colored chips or paper as used in Evening No. 13, Part II.

Evening No. 18

“Applied Awareness”

Everybody expresses his awareness and his attunement in his daily life. The aware person is calm, helpful, sympathetic, wise and diplomatic. He is aware of the thoughts he thinks, the words he uses and the motives behind his own actions. He begins to feel like a smoothly functioning instrument in a universal symphony. He challenges himself before challenging others; but an aware person, just by being aware, does not need to compete with others. He is at peace with himself.

The aware group is a closely knit circle of friends, bound by much more than material availability as babysitters or as emergency sources for a cup of sugar or half a lemon. They have experienced more of life together, in many ways, than have soldiers in a war or colleagues in an office. Life challenges the group to move on.

Aware groups around the world form a network of nuclei that are providing energy for man's awakening to a new level of relationships and a new step in the evolution of life on earth.

Yet it all stems from the individual and his everyday awareness. Without aware living on the part of the individual, the group and the network of groups are at a standstill. Evolutionary living is at the base of the life styles of many young people today.

In our daily lives, we constantly react to events and people. That reaction is the key to our awareness and our involvement. Is it derived from fear or from confidence? Is it from greed or a sense of service? Is it from ignorance or from wisdom? Is it from selfishness or selflessness? Are our life styles self-chosen or reactions to something else?

Groups who participated in Evening No. 13, Part II, learned how color preferences could be keys to personality levels and drives. That exercise is a prerequisite to the steps

in tonight's procedure. The introduction to that Evening should now be read and its Step 1 completed.

Procedure

Step 1 After the above is concluded, participants are provided with writing materials and asked to react, in fifty words or less, to each of the following hypothetical situations.

You open your front door one night all ready to go out for the evening. On the doorstep is a basket containing a tiny baby.

You are waiting for a train to take you away for a long weekend holiday. Just before it arrives you discover you have left one suitcase behind.

You are driving two young children to school when you come upon the scene of a serious automobile accident.

Step 2 Participants read their reaction to the first situation in the order of their color preferences, starting with reds and proceeding through oranges, yellows, greens, blues, indigos and violets. Then they do the same with the second situation and the third situation. Is there a noticeable thread of characteristics in the actions taken by a particular person in all three incidents? Is there a marked difference between the practical and the idealistic or impractical? The theoretical and emotional? The possessive and the imaginative? The socially or politically conscious and the intuitive? Is there a noticeable spectrum in the nature of these reactions progressing from the "red" participant or participants to the indigo or violet participant or participants?

Step 3 Now participants react to three more situations, this time orally. The order is the same as in Step 2.

You are sitting quietly in an ancient cathedral when you see a man rifling the collection box.

You are at a restaurant alone, when a member of the opposite sex walks up to you and asks if you believe in love at first sight.

You pass your neighbor's house, and find the man and his wife in a loud argument. As you approach he strikes her across the face.

Again the reactions are compared in the ways suggested in Step 2.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. A volunteer reads the color explanations provided in Steps 2 through 8 of Eve-

ning No. 13, Part II. . . . Participants are invited to prepare their own suggestions, in writing, for trial by the group next meeting. In lieu of these original games they may suggest portions of Evenings in Part II or Part III if these Parts were skipped by the group. . . . Participants who planted material in Evening No. 2, Part IV, are requested to bring both experimental and control flowerpots to the next meeting.

Evening No. 19

“Love Tips the Scales”

People all over the world are meditating, chanting, practicing yoga and using other techniques to break out of the barriers and boxes of daily life in an accelerating spiritual search.

They are also doing something else. They are writing a new definition for “spiritual.” They are stepping down the definition of the word from something too far out to have meaning for the man whose alarm clock goes off at 6:45 A.M. or the woman trying to make ends meet at the supermarket. They are placing that word within reach of everybody, by making it a living word—a word that now has just as much meaning *in* the physical, material world as it always had beyond.

Neurologist, physician and author, Dr. Andrija Puharich, describes this new awareness as beyond telepathy. “It is difficult to escape the conclusion” he says, “that mind at certain levels of operation is ubiquitous and can pass through barriers of the physical world around us. In fact, there are times when it literally transcends time as it leaps ahead to cognize physical events not yet born, or leaps backwards in time to reconstruct scenes long since perished from the physical realm.”*

*Andrija Puharich, *Beyond Telepathy*. Garden City, N. Y.: Doubleday, 1962.

Man is beginning to understand that within his consciousness is the link between the limited intelligence and capabilities of the physical world and the limitless intelligence and "miracles" of that world beyond.

He is beginning to understand that it is all his to use if he will but decide to, that no special techniques are needed, and that all he needs to do are things that come naturally, such as:

Recognize no power of evil, only of good;
 Feel oneness in the universe, not separateness;
 Understand space to be related to intelligence;
 Reattune himself constantly to the universal intelligence through meditation;
 Know that mental visualization is the fabric of things to come;
 Express love continuously as "the breath of life";
 Focus this love and intelligence consciously onto a vast global network of people who are making themselves sensitive to a world-wide evolutionary plan.

We all do these things to a degree; they are not new. What is new is the awareness that life returns success to us exactly in this same degree.

If the group has met once a week, then it was some seventeen weeks ago that an experiment was started to demonstrate how love is "the breath of life." This will now be concluded as an experiment, but hopefully continued in ever-increasing intensity and ever-widening circles.

Also this evening the participants will make their individual contributions to man's effort to expand his awareness and gain mastery over his physical-spiritual mind.

Procedure

Step 1 All the growing material from the control pots is washed and weighed. All the growing material from the specially "loved" pots is washed and weighed. Results are compared. This weighing can be eliminated if the results are obvious to the eyesight. The power of love is discussed.

Step 2 Each person reads the suggested original exercise which he proposes for tonight or a portion of an Evening from other Parts of this book not yet performed.

Step 3 By consensus, the group selects several of these and performs as many as time permits.

Step 4 Refreshments are served. A recorder is named to

forward to the authors those new games or exercises which participants feel were successfully experienced tonight and which may be of special interest or value to others. (See instructions on page 239.) Plans are made for a group dinner to be enjoyed at the next meeting. It can be Dutch treat at a restaurant, or a cooperative covered-dish supper at home.

Evening No. 20

"The Beginning"

As the group convenes this evening to enjoy together the fruits of the physical world, the same thing is happening in groups throughout the world. Never before in the history of man has there been such a widespread awakening of experiences that transcend and uplift.

This was once reserved for those who were willing to relinquish the established structure of their lives, or who had not yet created such a life structure. It was therefore largely an extreme theoretical pursuit because it was not being applied in normal daily life.

Today it belongs to everybody. It is being applied in a practical way by people in all walks of life. And it is changing their lives. Motivation for it is coming from books, from churches, from business firms, from professionals and from individuals directly.

It is as if man were on the threshold of a new age which he is largely creating for himself; and we all have a part in the action. A great enterprise is afoot.

If anything, the motivation here is almost too strong. Many, who do not temper their unbounded desire for growth with the patience for step-by-step progress that nature herself exhibits, can experience wasted time and wasted effort. Man is a complicated mechanism and if one part or personality department is to grow, all parts should be permitted to grow apace, in order that the whole may be kept in balance and synchronized.

The yogis found this out when they retired from the active life in order to pursue spiritual growth. The difference between the life of the yogi and the worldly life was so great that the sudden transition often produced a reaction that sent the aspirant flying back into his previous ways. So they recognized that a preparatory period of self-training was necessary, a period in which a gradual transition could take place and in which all facets of one's consciousness could assimilate the new direction.

In a way, this group has enjoyed such a period of preparation; implicitly behind these games and awareness training is a long tradition of yogic and Christian disciplines. Some will have discovered that there are many mansions in the great house of the spiritual universe. It is the end of the book, but only the beginning of the group's quest.

This Evening's dinner is enjoyed as a mutual milestone, reflecting gratitude for the past experiences shared, love in the present transcendental moment and the expectation of an unfolding enlightenment ahead.

Procedure

Step 1-4 Follow the same procedure as Step 1 through 4 in the Evening No. 20, Part I.

Step 5 The group decides whether it will proceed with Part II or Part III, if these have been by-passed, whether it will repeat certain Evenings or whether the participants will create original group agendas for the Evenings immediately ahead.

EPILOGUE

There are many different kinds of growth centers in the U.S.A. including groups based on high professional standards and some not so professionally based. It is impossible to generalize about them because they vary with the individual leaders and techniques involved. Here are some names of the various techniques:

Achievement Motivation	Directed Daydream
Aikido	Drawing & Movement
Alcoholics Anonymous	Dreams
Alexander Technique	Eidetic Perception
Analytical Psychology	Encounter Groups
Aurobindo	Encountertapes
Autoconditioning	Eurhythmy
Autogenic Training	Evolutionary Living
Aversion Therapy	Executive Power Seminars
Bio-Energetic Analysis	Explorations in Positive Living
Body Awareness	
Body Dynamics	
Breathing Therapy	Fasting
Chanting	Feedback Training
Christ-Yoga	Fixed-Role Therapy
Client-Centered Therapy	Focusing
Conditioned Reflex Therapy	Folk Dances
Cosmic Humanism	General Semantics
Creative Conflict	Gestalt Therapy
	Group Dynamics
Deep Relaxation & Symbolism	Gurdjieff
Desensitization, reciprocal inhibition	Hatha Yoga
	Health Foods & Diets

Hermetics	Psychocybernetics
Human Potential Groups	Psychodrama
Humanistic Psychology	Psychomotor Therapy
	Psychomat
I Ching	Psychosynthesis
Individual Psychology	
Initiated Symbol Projection	Radiesthesia
Integral Yoga	Relax and Rebound
Intentional Community	
Laban Movement	Self-Actualization Groups
Logotherapy	Self Analysis Groups
	Sensitivity Training
Mantra	Stanislavski Approach
Marathon	Structural Integration
Massage	Subud
Meditation	Sufis
Mesendieck Approach	Symbolic Visualization
Model Psychosis & Psychedelics	Symphysis
Montessori	Synanon
Movement & Environment	Synectics
Movement in Depth	Synergetics
Mudras	
Multiple Therapy	Tantra
	Tarot
Negative Practice	T-Groups
Nuclear Evolution	Theater Games
Nudity	Time Distortion Techniques
	Transpersonal Psychology
Operant Approach	
Optokinetic Perceptual Awareness Training	Unconventional Healing
	Vedanta
Peak Oriented Therapy	Will Therapy
Phenomenon of Man Pro- jects	Yoga
Poetry	Zen

Some participants report beautiful experiences and peace of mind, others may sometimes find advantages in personal encounter sessions, which can be harsh or shocking-to-the-system experiences. The preparatory games in this book are drawn from the above techniques but mainly lean toward "Creative Conflict," "Nuclear Evolution" and "Christ-Yoga" techniques. Creative Conflict is the resolu-

tion of hostility by the prior agreement of participants that each individual is constitutionally entitled to be as different as he can be original.

Nuclear Evolution is defined as a technique by which we can measure "degrees of wellness" by detecting the drives of people in certain sequences. Then we can formulate a method of classifying the inner worlds of people. Although science is unable to quantify wellness, the reactions of the basic drives to colors provide *qualitative* measures of wellness which can open up vast areas for social research on living patterns.

Christ-Yoga deals with working methods of governing our own lives as social beings in intentional communities, nonexclusive spiritual centers, growth centers, youth groups and new spiritual ventures. It is concerned with the creativity of constitution-making in which yogic awareness of the self is coupled with the awareness of group encounters. It can be defined as a method of spiritual exploration into the cosmic conscience by political man.

Both Nuclear Evolution and Christ-Yoga are more advanced techniques available to those who have mastered the Creative Conflict engendered by the encounter group situation. This book offers methods of conducting growth centers whereby you can enjoy just as rapid and gratifying progress in your own home, but with your own peers and within a longer period of time than a weekend or even a few weeks. It prescribes a way, or sadhana as they say in Sanskrit, for achieving a continuous progression in the development of individual awareness, and for the exploration of group consciousness; this cannot be compared to the occasional weekend spent with strangers in a temporary setting. Nor is any comparison intended by the authors, because they believe it is your own readiness that matters. If you are in a state of ripeness you will find a guru in your own child, or see Christ in the quiet power of a flower. This does not mean that we can dispense with highly skilled spiritual teachers who can show us the way out of selfrighteousness, or reveal the pits into which our ego can fall. These known, and unknown, teachers will suddenly appear when we are humble enough to learn the incredible facts about the universe and our own consciousness. Not everyone need travel far; there are those returning from long journeys who bring back the same knowledge of truth as others find outside their own doors.

However, you may wish to enlist the help of friends

and acquaintances who are psychiatrists, psychologists, psychiatric social workers, clergymen, psychoanalysts or other professionals. Many of them are willing to contribute their knowledge and ability as advisers in a dynamic life situation.

By returning the form enclosed with this book, these professionals can make themselves known to the authors, as can groups who seek help. In this way, the authors will be in turn helped in their dedication to help ignite the search for awareness and personal growth in homes everywhere.